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Tata Sons to take up top leadership, IPO issues on Sep 17



PM warns against weaponising tech, critical minerals

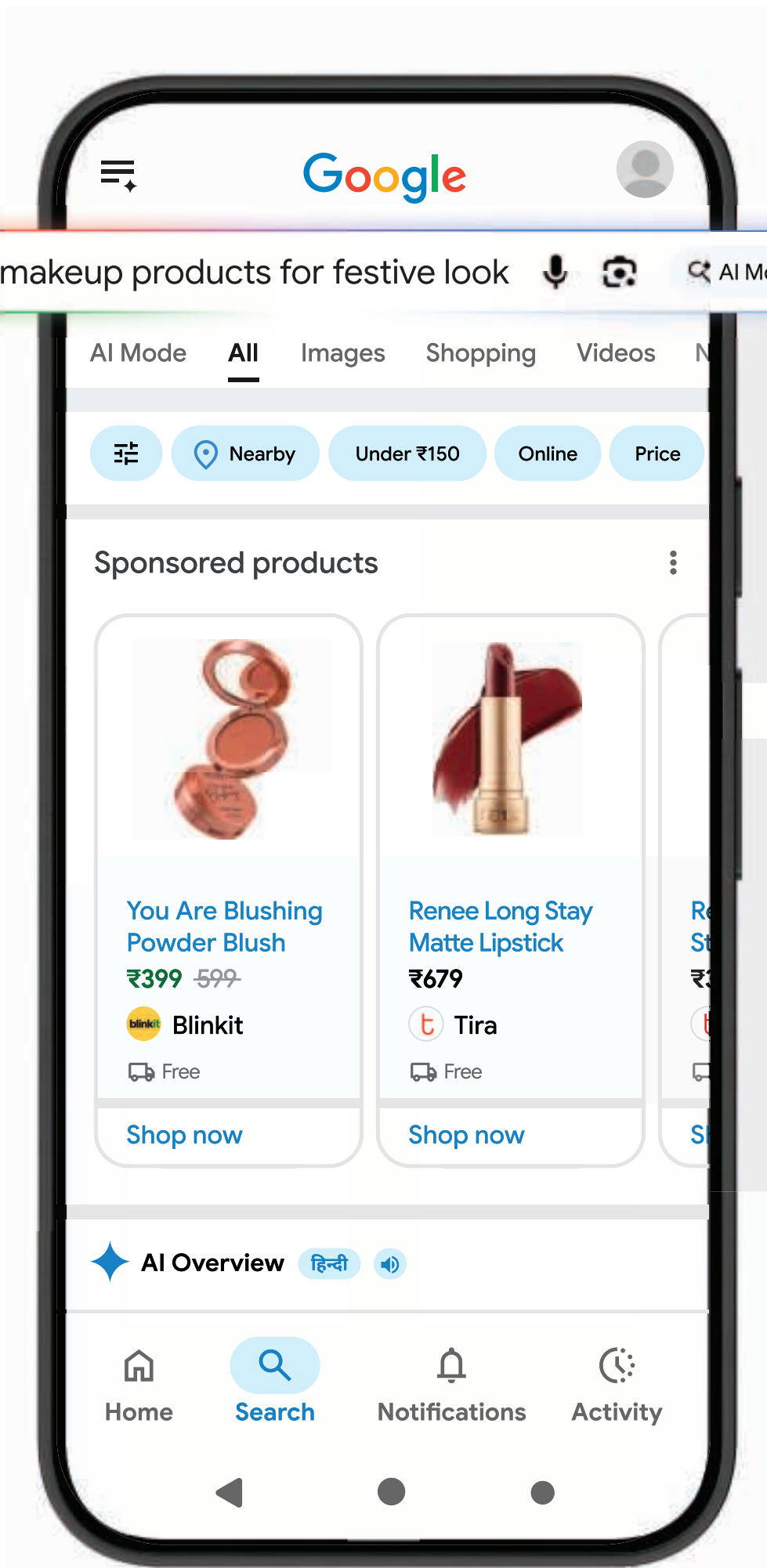


Wholesale changes have not happened in the civil services: M Veerappa Moily



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Sources:

- 1. Google commissioned Ipsos Global Consumer Journeys, Dec 2025
- 2. Commissioned Analytic Edge MMM Meta Analysis 2021-2025

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How markets performed last week				
	Sep 11	One-week	Local currency in US \$	% chg over Dec 31, '25
Sensex	74,782	-2.3	-12.2	-17.5
Nifty	23,398	-2.1	-10.5	-15.8
Dow Jones	52,573	-1.6	9.4	9.4
Nasdaq	26,333	-0.7	13.3	13.3
Hang Seng	24,806	-3.3	-3.2	-4.0
Nikkei	64,011	-1.6	27.2	29.7
FTSE	10,650	-1.7	7.2	7.6
DAX	25,569	-1.8	4.4	3.1
*Change (%) over previous week Source: Bloomberg				

IN BRIEF

Traders back CAS revamp, favour gradual move to blended VWAP

Feedback has begun streaming in from the trading community on Sebi's consultation paper on the Closing Auction Session (CAS). Most stakeholders acknowledge that the regulator has recognised the practical issues around the mechanism, even as opinions differ on some specific proposals. The regulator has floated two options for derivatives settlement — a blended volume weighted average price (VWAP) mechanism combining the last 30 minutes of continuous trading with CAS trades, or a continuation of the existing 30-minute CTS-only VWAP for at least a year before any transition. KHUSHBOO TIWARI reports

- Doomsday conversations snowball at AI firms P8 ▶
- Experts doubtful if 'slowdown' in model development can happen P3 ▶
- Businesses put up guard rails in deploying AI P14 ▶

BS SPECIAL ON MONDAY

BANKER'S TRUST Ban on flexi-loans: Should RBI be flexible?

The defining feature of a flexi-loan is amortisation. Instead of a blanket ban, the regulator may consider certain structural safeguards against evergreening, writes TAMAL BANDYOPADHYAY

MARKETS CLOSED TODAY

Stock, currency and commodities markets will remain closed on account of Ganesh Chaturthi.

NO EDITION

There will be no edition of the newspaper on Tuesday (September 15) as the offices of *Business Standard* will remain closed on Monday on account of Ganesh Chaturthi. The e-paper can be accessed at epaper.business-standard.com

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Wholesale changes have not happened in civil services: M Veerappa Moily

Q&A M Veerappa Moily was chief minister of Karnataka immediately after liberalisation. How did the states experience reforms? ■ Suddenly, it felt like we were liberated; we felt free. Until then, there were many restrictions on states, and we had to go to New Delhi for everything. P V Narasimha Rao was a very progressive Prime Minister. These days, chief ministers cannot constitute their council of ministers. They have to go to Delhi and sit with the high command, whether it is the

economic reforms were unleashed in 1991. He has held various ministerial roles at the central level, too, including in the ministries of corporate affairs, law, and petroleum. As the head of the Second Administrative Reforms Commission (ARC), set up in 2005, he also studied governance and administration closely, and recommended quite a few changes. Some were accepted, others not. In a virtual interview with Archis Mohan and Vikram Gopal, Moily talks about improving administration and governance. Edited excerpts:



Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) or the Congress or the Communist Party of India (Marxist). When I became chief minister, I asked Rao: "Do you want me to come to Delhi to clear the ministry or can I go ahead?" He said, "Moily, I have [only] one request. Can you make SM Krishna (who was then the Speaker of the Assembly) a minister?" I told him, "Why minister? I will make him a deputy chief minister and give him whatever portfolio he deserves." This is how chief

ministers are empowered. I could function as a free man.

Is the reform of the civil services the unfinished agenda of 1991?

■ Yes, it has remained unfinished. Even though we introduced some reforms in the periphery in accordance with my recommendations, wholesale changes were not undertaken. As a result, the most intelligent people are not able to make it through, and they shy away from entering the central services. I don't think the civil services should become relics. They should be alive, vibrant, and try to solve the problems of the country. Right now, there are very intelligent people, but in silos. Formerly, even those from the Indian Institutes of Technology used to vie for these posts. They shy away now because they know that the services have become a little corrupt and they would be at the mercy of ministers. I worked out a transparent system by which the best officers can be selected in the examinations. It



PHOTO: REUTERS FILE

“THERE IS A PRONOUNCED TENDENCY TO CENTRALISE NOW... CENTRALISATION WILL NOT TAKE THE COUNTRY FORWARD, EITHER SOCIALLY OR ECONOMICALLY”

M Veerappa Moily, former Union minister & Karnataka CM

can still be done if my recommendations are implemented, and we will have a new avatar of the services.

In the ARC reports, you had

highlighted how the Whitehall model has continued. Has there been any change since?

■ We looked at the models then prevalent in countries like France, England, and Australia.

We covered all aspects of the administration and governance. My philosophy in the ARC was one of creative destruction, that continuing the same system would not serve our purpose. Based on those suggestions, we did experiment to a certain extent. When Manmohan Singh was Prime Minister, we dismantled a lot of old systems and replaced them with new ones. We recommended that there should be decentralisation, that all ministries should be given absolute freedom.

Another of the ARC reports was on strengthening financial management systems. What are your views on the recent controversy over government data?

■ We had a certain system in our country to arrive at the GDP (gross domestic product) numbers. I think there is a lot of credibility gap at present.

The ARC had stressed on the principle of subsidiarity. Nearly

two decades later, states are still airing concerns over centralisation. Has devolution occurred to the extent you imagined?

■ There is a pronounced tendency to centralise now. My approach in the ARC was based on studying systems across the world. Centralisation will not take the country forward, either socially or economically. We have given up the Plan and Non-plan programmes. We have dismantled the Planning Commission because it was felt that it was increasing centralisation. We have decided that there is no need for planning. But we created the NITI Aayog. When we dismantled the Planning Commission, there was no scope for creating a parallel organisation that ultimately works as a Planning Commission. That's not going to help you. States should be given a lot of freedom since they have to ultimately deliver. The Centre cannot deliver. Turn to Page 13 ▶



Business Standard



COMPANIES 2 ▶

Citroën targets 75% India sales from smaller cities in 5 yrs



TECHNOLOGY 3 ▶

India is rising star for AI tools at SAP Labs: Sindhu Gangadharan



WORLD 8 ▶

Iran set to unveil Hormuz pact to Gulf nations today

AFTER RBI'S MISSIVE

Tata Sons to take up top leadership, IPO issues on Sep 17

NIVEDITA MOOKERJI
New Delhi, 13 September

The Reserve Bank of India's (RBI's) directive to Tata Sons, the holding company of the salt-to-software conglomerate, on mandatory stock exchange listing, has set the ball rolling at a fast speed on many fronts. Tata Sons, which could go for India's biggest initial public offering (IPO) so far, is learnt to be getting ready for a crucial board meeting on September 17.

The Tata Sons board — meeting for the first time since Chairman N Chandrasekaran's announcement that he would not offer himself for a third term — is expected to discuss two issues with far-reaching implications: Top leadership at Tata Sons and future of the holding company as a listed entity, according to sources.

Chandrasekaran's (Chandra as he's called) letter to the board members last month that he would not seek reappointment once his term as chairman comes to an end on February 20, 2027, could be one of the main subjects for deliberation, a source in the know said. Board members, including the nomination and remuneration committee (NRC), would possibly back a third term for Chandra, bringing the issue back on the table.

Plan of action



■ RBI directive to Tata Sons mandates immediate listing of the Tata group holding company

■ Tata Sons board meeting on Sep 17 may discuss the leadership question, and the holding company's future as a listed entity
■ Board members could back a third term for Tata Sons Chairman N Chandrasekaran. The support is believed to have been strengthened after the RBI directive
■ Estimated at over \$5bn, Tata Sons' IPO size could exceed that of Hyundai Motor India, LLC, and the upcoming RIL Jio listing

EDIT: REGULATORY CLARITY

9 ▶

More than six months ago, in February 2026, the discussion on Chandra's third term got stalled after Tata Trusts chairman Noel Tata red-flagged the financial performance of some group companies such as Air India and Tata Digital even as other board members supported the renewal of his tenure.

Chandra's letter of August 12, 2026, referred to "one board member" not supporting his reappointment though Tata Trusts, the largest shareholder of Tata Sons

with a 66 per cent stake, had passed a resolution last year recommending a third five-year term for him as executive chairman of the company.

The board's resolve to press for a third term for Chandra, 63, is believed to have been strengthened after the recent RBI directive to Tata Sons to go for an immediate listing. The RBI rejected the Tata Sons application of March 2024 seeking to deregister as a core investment company (CIC) to be able to continue as a privately-held entity. Turn to Page 13 ▶

Vi denies Airtel, Jio's charge of 'unfair' practice

Says actions within defined rules; top two telcos want Trai to probe

GULVEEN AULAKH
New Delhi, 13 September

Bharti Airtel and Reliance Jio say Vodafone Idea (Vi) has been indulging in malpractices to wean away their mobile phone customers, and want the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (Trai) to investigate the matter.

In multiple conversations and official communications to the regulator over the last few weeks, the country's leading carriers alleged specific unfair practices by the No 3 carrier, and asked the Trai to direct Vi to look into these instances, three people aware of the development said.

They said the telcos have

Portability hurdles

■ Jio, Airtel have alleged malpractices related to customer acquisitions during mobile number portability (MNP)

■ Callers allegedly representing Vi misled Jio, Airtel users by warning of price hikes, then coaxing them to port to Vi



■ Jio, Airtel allege that Vi was restricting SMS to 1900 for generation of unique porting code for MNP in several circles

■ Vi also allegedly circulating, promoting discounted postpaid tariff plans for phone users seeking to port from rival networks

shared evidence to support the claims.

However, Vodafone Idea said in response to queries sent by *Business Standard* that it was not undertaking any exercises or steps that violate exist-

ing rules or regulations.

The malpractices alleged by Jio and Airtel relate to customer acquisitions using mobile number portability (MNP) — where a customer can switch their network provider without

having to change the phone number. They are being levelled against Vodafone Idea and/or its sales associates and channel partners for violating directions issued by the Trai.

The top carriers say customers are called by people pretending to be executives from non-Vodafone telcos and told about imminent tariff hikes and changes to their existing plans.

These are then followed up by calls made by Vodafone executives to persuade the same customers to switch to Vi. This, the two companies said, violated Trai's 2021 directions for carriers not to take any steps for acquiring customers that may induce churn in a rival car-

rier's network.

The two telcos have also alleged that Vi was restricting SMSes, or text messages, that have to be mandatorily sent to 1900 for generating a unique porting code (UPC) for switching to another provider in several circles. Vi customers wanting to make a switch are being asked to contact Vi customer care or go to a physical store, and the restriction was being removed after customers were asked to wait for a few hours.

This, the telcos alleged, violates MNP 2009 norms, which specify issuance of UPC without delay by the network from where the customer is moving out. Turn to Page 13 ▶

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HDFC Bank's MD & CEO race likely between insider, outsider

A senior internal executive and an external candidate are in the race to become HDFC Bank's next MD & CEO, according to a person familiar with the matter. The board of India's largest private-sector lender has sent two names to the Reserve Bank of India for approval. SUBRATA PANDA reports

RBI proposes temporary debit holds on suspected money mule accounts

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has proposed a standard operating procedure (SOP) for banks to place temporary debit holds on amounts or accounts suspected to be linked to money-mule activity and cyber-enabled financial fraud. SUBRATA PANDA reports



IN BRIEF

Consumers deserve information on food packs: Orkla India

Leading packaged food firm Orkla India Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer Sanjay Sharma has supported the sectoral watchdog FSSAI’s proposed front-of-pack labelling norms, saying consumers have every right to know the nutritional details of the products they buy. Responding to *PTI* over a query on front-of-pack labelling (FOPL) initiatives, Sharma said the industry is aligned with the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India’s (FSSAI) intent to empower consumers to make informed choices as awareness levels continue to rise. Consumers deserve greater information about the products they consume, and the food industry is fully supportive of the food regulator FSSAI’s push in this direction, said Sharma, who is engaged with industry body CII on this issue. *PTI*

Hyderabad to add 50-70 GCCs in a year: Ficci-Anarock report

Hyderabad has around 515 Global Capability Centres (GCCs), and 50-70 more will be set up within a year, as the city offers a huge talent pool and cost advantage to foreign companies, according to a Ficci and Anarock report. Industry body Ficci and property consultant Anarock have come up with a joint report titled ‘Hyderabad: The Rise of a Global Capability Powerhouse’. The report highlighted that there were around 515 GCCs in Hyderabad as of March 2026, employing more than 300,000 people. Hyderabad accounts for around 20 per cent of the total GCCs in India, transforming the city from a cyber city to the GCC hub. The report noted that GCCs have become a key demand driver for Hyderabad’s office market. *PTI*

ITC targets ₹20,000 cr Aashirvaad consumer spending in 5 years

ITC expects consumer spending on its flagship food brand Aashirvaad to double to ₹20,000 crore over the next five years, from around ₹10,000 crore currently, as it expands into newer food categories and adjacent segments, a senior company official said. It is amplifying Aashirvaad’s play with a two-pronged strategy for the brand — strengthening its core *atta* business while expanding into adjacent categories such as ready-to-cook foods and frozen snacks, said Hemant Malik, Chief Executive Officer, Foods Division, and Executive Director, ITC Ltd. *PTI*

Maruti, TaMo, M&M find larger EU export window

Luxury car makers Merc, BMW say localisation would not be hit by FTA

SOHINI DAS
Mumbai, 13 September

European carmakers will get concessional access to the Indian market for up to 100,000 internal combustion engine (ICE) and hybrid cars in the first year of the India-European Union (EU) free trade agreement (FTA), which is nearly six times the 17,191 cars India imported from the bloc in 2025.

This would intensify competition for domestic automakers even as the deal opens a much larger export window for companies such as Maruti Suzuki, Tata Motors and Mahindra & Mahindra (M&M).

India’s quota for European ICE and non-plug-in hybrid cars will rise to 160,000 units by Year 10, with in-quota duties falling to 10 per cent by Year 5.

In return, the EU will give Indian-origin ICE and hybrid cars priced up to euro 50,000 a quota of 250,000 units in the first year, rising to 400,000 by Year 10, with the tariff falling to zero by Year 5. The quota is not a ceiling on European car imports: Vehicles can continue to enter India beyond it at the applicable out-of-quota duty, which also declines over time.

India can also cap a single model at 15 per cent of the aggregate passenger car completely-built unit (CBU) quota, subject to a maximum of 25,000 units a year. The competitive impact will, however, be uneven. India has kept ICE and hybrid cars priced below euro 15,000 outside the concessions, protecting the mass-market segment.

European electric vehicles (EVs) will get no concessional access for the first four years, with concessions beginning in Year 5 only for vehicles priced at euro 20,000 or more.

For European luxury carmakers, the FTA could improve access to imported models without changing their localisation strategies. Mercedes-Benz India, where more than 90 per cent of sales come from locally made models and only around 5 per cent from CBU imports from the EU, said it does not foresee any price reduction because of the FTA in the foreseeable future.

“The FTA would surely give us scope of higher allocations for the Indian market, hence more customers will benefit from higher access to our top-end vehicles, compared to the ear-



India gets 694,853 tonnes of steel quota annually for exports

India will get country-specific tariff-rate quotas (TRQs) totalling 1.64 million tonnes annually for exporting steel products to the European Union, of which 6,94,853 tonnes will be under the free trade agreement, according to the draft text of the pact released by the EU.

The total country-specific quota of 1,641,470 tonnes comprises 946,616 tonnes under the most

Taking a new road

EU cars into India: 100,000-unit preferential quota in Year 1 →160,000 by Year 10

Tariffs: In-quota ICE/hybrid duty →10% by Year 5

Mass market shielded: No concession for cars below €15,000

EV protection: No EU EV concessions for first 4 years; access starts Year 5

India gets bigger export window: EU quota: 250,000 Indian ICE/hybrid cars in Year 1 → 400,000 by Year 10; tariff → zero by Year 5

lier period,” said Santosh Iyer, managing director (MD) and chief executive officer (CEO), Mercedes-Benz India.

BMW Group India sees a broader opportunity for its imported portfolio. President and CEO Hardeep Singh Brar said the FTA does not fundamentally change BMW’s balanced mix of locally produced models and CBUs, but “certainly makes the CBU business more viable” and gives the company greater flexibility in shaping its portfolio. Brar, however, said localisation would remain the preferred route wherever volumes justified it. “We see the FTA and localisation as complementary and not competing strategies,” he said.

The agreement also offers a lower-duty route for European manufacturers assembling cars in India. The quota for ICE and hybrid completely knocked down (CKD) vehicles is 75,000 annually during the first five years, declining to 50,000 from Year 10. The

in-quota duty falls from 13.75 per cent in Year 1 to 8.25 per cent from Year 3.

For Indian automakers, the reciprocal concessions create a larger potential export opportunity.

Maruti Suzuki is particularly well placed to tap this, given its existing export scale and presence in Europe. It exported a record 447,774 vehicles in FY26 and already established India as the global production hub for the e VITARA. The company shipped more than 25,000 units of the electric SUV to 44 countries during FY26, including European markets.

For Tata Motors and M&M, the agreement creates a potential new export window for their India-made vehicles. The four-year delay in concessional access to European EVs also gives the two domestic EV makers more time to scale their home market.

More on business-standard.com

Citroën targets 75% sales from smaller cities in five years

DEEPAK PATEL
New Delhi, 13 September

Citroën expects three-fourths of its sales in India to come from Tier-II, Tier-III and smaller cities within five years, up from around 55 per cent currently, as the Stellantis-owned brand seeks to deepen its presence beyond India’s major urban centres.

“I think that is where (to smaller cities) the mass market of the car is going... That’s what we predict,” Shailesh Hazela, chief executive officer (CEO) and managing director (MD), Stellantis India, told *Business Standard* in an interview. Stellantis’s other brand, Jeep, would remain more focused on Tier-I and -II cities and metros, he added.

Citroën’s strategy will be backed by a retail network tailored to the potential of individual markets, rather than a uniform dealership model across the country. Stellantis currently has close to 300 touchpoints in India, including around 175 for Citroën, but Hazela said the company was more focused on reaching customers than simply increasing the number of outlets.

Under the model, Stellantis could start with a small showroom to test demand before investing in a larger facility. A market with a population of 100,000, for example, may not need a conventional six-car showroom. The company could instead deploy a one-car showroom and a smaller service facility, with the format changing according to sales potential and the local vehicle population.

The company has currently reached around 60



“I THINK THAT IS WHERE (TO SMALLER CITIES) THE MASS MARKET OF THE CAR IS GOING... THAT’S WHAT WE PREDICT”

Shailesh Hazela
CEO and MD, Stellantis India

per cent of its addressable customer population through its network and wants to take this to 75 per cent, he noted.

The smaller city push comes when Citroën’s volume sales are expected to grow at least 15-20 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) in the second half of the current financial year (FY27). This would be lower than approximately 60 per cent Y-o-Y growth it recorded in the year-to-date period because of the high base effect. In September 2025, the Indian government significantly reduced goods and services tax (GST) rates on automobiles, which increased their sales dramatically in the second half of last financial year. Hazela said Citroën’s sales have seen healthy growth till now in FY27, due to the product upgrades introduced last year.

However, Stellantis’s other brand Jeep is not performing that well. Therefore, Jeep was preparing for a product-led revival after what Hazela described as a period of limited activity. The brand’s existing prod-

ucts are towards the end of their lifecycle, he said, while its next phase is being developed under the Jeep 2.0 strategy announced earlier this year. Stellantis has around 90,000 existing Jeep customers in India who are waiting for the next generation of products, he said.

Stellantis’s wholesales — which is combined volume sales of Citroën and Jeep — in the April-July period stood at 2,920 units, a 64.4 per cent Y-o-Y growth, according to data from Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (Siam).

Hazela was also bullish on the broader Indian passenger vehicle market. He expected the industry to continue growing through 2030, helped by rising disposable income, better road infrastructure and easier access to financing. For the second half of the financial year, he expects the overall automobile industry to grow 5-7 per cent Y-o-Y, although the pace will vary across vehicle segments.

Stellantis is also preparing to increase exports of Citroën vehicles from India substantially. Hazela said the company has exported around 4,500 vehicles so far this year and plans to expand into several additional overseas markets. It currently exports to markets such as South Africa and Indonesia.

The company was using India as the starting point for products that can subsequently be sold in other markets. Hazela said Stellantis’ India operations are supported by five areas: engineering, software, manufacturing, suppliers and information and communications technology. Its localisation in India is above 90 per cent.

Lupin looks to bet big on biosimilar portfolio

SANKET KOUL
New Delhi, 13 September

Pharma major Lupin is stepping up its focus on biosimilars, with plans to expand its portfolio and presence across key global markets, Executive Director and Global Chief Financial Officer (CFO) Ramesh Swaminathan told *Business Standard* in an interaction.

The drugmaker, which only recently stepped up its biosimilars play, received its first approval from the United States Food and Drug Administration (USFDA) in December 2025 to market its biosimilar of cancer drug pegfilgrastim.

“Pegfilgrastim is set to enter the United States (US) market, while ophthalmic drug Ranibizumab is lined up for launches across the US, Europe and Japan,” Swaminathan said.

He added that the company expects turnover from biosimilars to be close to \$500 million over the next five years.

Lupin is also planning to bring biosimilars of cancer drugs Nivolumab, Dinuzumab and Pertuzumab to India, Swaminathan said. The firm already markets products such as a biosimilar of the autoimmune condition drug Etanercept in Europe and Japan through partnerships.

To support the expansion, it has invested about ₹300 crore in biosimilar



Ramesh Swaminathan , Lupin executive director and global CFO, said the company expects turnover from biosimilars to be close to \$500 million over the next five years

manufacturing capacity so far and plans to increase its total investment to around ₹700 crore.

“We currently have about 11,000 litres of mammalian and 100 litres of microbial capacity, both of which are being expanded,” he said.

Swaminathan added that Lupin does not have a fixed commercialisation model for the portfolio and plans to use a mix of partnerships, third-party distribution and its own sales force depending on the product and market.

The company previously partnered with US-based pharma company Via-

tris for the promotion of Etanercept in global markets. This mandate later shifted to Biocon Biologics after it acquired Viatri’s global biosimilar.

Lupin also partners with global pharma firms like Sandoz and Biogaran for distribution in the European Union (EU) market.

The biosimilars push comes as the company looks to build additional growth engines around its established generics business. Swaminathan said the company expects its India business to grow 25-30 per cent above the market rate in 2026-27 (FY27).

In the US, Lupin expects some near-term pressure from products such as its generic version of the bladder disorder drug Mirabegron, which was the subject of a patent dispute with its innovator company Astellas Pharma.

The company later agreed to a \$90 million settlement with Astellas, a move that allows it to continue selling the product in the US.

“We might actually see a little lowering of the turnover in America this year. However, new launches in the next year such as Apixaban are expected to support growth,” Swaminathan said.

The company sees scope for a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of around 10 per cent in the US over the next five years.

He added that while it has a presence in South Africa, it is looking at tie-

ups for various therapy areas in the African market. “We are already big in anti-tuberculosis and anti-rabies vaccines (ARVs), which are big markets for Africa,” Swaminathan said.

Separately, Lupin has started the process of raising external funding for Kaveri Therapeutics, its oncology-focused spin-off housing two specialised oncology programmes.

The move is aimed at bringing in outside capital for higher-risk drug development while allowing Lupin to conserve resources for its core pharmaceutical business.

“We believe in the potential of these molecules, but at the same time, we also recognise the risks associated with them,” Swaminathan said.

He added that Lupin will participate in the funding and intends to remain the majority shareholder in Kaveri. However, the eventual stake will depend on the amount raised and the company’s valuation.

The funding process has already begun, with a partner on board seeking to bring in additional investors. The company, however, does not yet have a timeline for a Series A round.

Swaminathan said it was too early to discuss a potential future listing of Kaveri. He added that it can be considered if the company eventually develops into a multi-billion-dollar business with multiple successful molecules.

Luminous Power plans ₹2,000 cr investment in solar manufacturing

NANDINI KESHARI
New Delhi, 13 September

Gurgaon-based Luminous Power Technologies is planning to invest around ₹2,000 crore over the next five years in solar manufacturing and energy storage, aligned with its strategy to grow business three times, Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) Vivek Abrol said.

“We aim to grow Luminous business 3X in 4-5 years based on four pillars, including strengthening inverter and battery business, expansion of solar business, owning the technology both from hardware and software perspective, and operational excellence,” he told *Business Standard* in an interview. The company’s 1.2 Gigawatt (Gw) solar cell manufacturing plant in Gopalpur, Odisha, which will feed its PV module manufacturing facility in Rudrapur, Uttarakhand, is expected to produce the first batch from May 2027. Luminous is also setting up advanced energy storage and manufacturing plant in Angul, Odisha.

Highlighting the growing



Vivek Abrol, Luminous Power Technologies MD and CEO, said lead-acid has been a successful chemistry in the Indian power backup space

importance of lithium-ion batteries its solar product portfolio, Abrol said the company is investing in the segment as a part of an important technology transition. Luminous assembles lithium-ion cells to make battery packs. It commissioned a 500 Megawatt Hour lithium-ion battery assembly line at Baddi in January. The facility supports standalone battery packs and modules for stationary BESS.

“It can produce individual packs from 1.2 kWh to 16 kWh, with system-level scalability up to 112 kWh. We would address

applications inside homes and also some BESS solutions for small C&I applications, which could replace DG sets,” Abrol said. The company also manufactures lead-acid batteries and is exploring chemistries like sodium. “We look at different applications, the cost of ownership and the safety aspects, and then determine what the best chemistry is for that application,” he said, adding that lead-acid has been a large-scale and successful chemistry in the Indian power backup space.

The power back-up firm, which is transitioning to energy solutions company, also has manufacturing facilities in Gagret in Himachal Pradesh, Rudrapur in Uttarakhand, Hosur in Tamil Nadu and Haridwar in Uttarakhand.

With major focus on residential rooftop solar and solar solutions for small small C&I businesses, Luminous wants to initially focus on in-house cell manufacturing and making the facility operationally viable with module manufacturing. It will then reassess feasibility between build versus buy, he said.

iPhone 17 buyers rush to beat the price rise

SURAJEET DAS GUPTA
New Delhi, 13 September

Apple’s iPhone 17 series is drawing increased consumer interest much ahead of the festival season as buyers look to purchase existing stock at current prices before it runs out. Retailers expect this strong demand to lift sales in the premium smartphone segment by 5-10 per cent.

The iPhone 17 model is drawing particular interest because it will soon carry a substantially higher price tag. The Cupertino-headquartered company had held prices despite a sharp increase in memory costs over the past year. It is now passing

part of that increase on to consumers. Apple has announced that the price of the 256GB iPhone 17 will rise by more than 20.5 per cent to ₹99,000. The 512GB model will soon cost ₹1,24,900, up 21.3 per cent.

There is also demand for the remaining stock of the iPhone 17 Pro and Pro Max, production of which has stopped. These are being replaced by the iPhone 18 Pro and Pro Max, which will be available from September 18 at ₹1,64,900 and ₹1,79,000, respectively. The iPhone 17 Pro and Pro Max started at ₹1,34,900 and ₹1,54,900.

“Directionally, footfall is lower than last year,” said Tarun

Ringin ahead



Pathak, head of research at Counterpoint Research, based on preliminary feedback from several stores over the weekend. This

was partly because Apple did not launch the flagship iPhone 18, which is its best-selling model, he said. At the same time, there were

- Big rush to buy limited stocks of iPhone 17 including Pro and Pro Max at older price
- Apple Inc undertakes steep increases in prices for newer phones
- Retailers expect 5-10% increase in sales this month in top-end market
- Footfalls lower than last year because flagship iPhone 18 not launched
- Queries on the iPhone Duo muted. Expect consumers to buy from US and UAE because of huge arbitrage
- Concern that this will increase grey market operations

a significant number of queries for the iPhone 17 Pro.

“We expect that stocks of the iPhone 17 at the old price will exhaust in the next one to two weeks,” Pathak said. Some consumers, however, are likely to wait for Diwali offers, which are only a few weeks away.

There was little interest in the foldable iPhone Duo, he added. “Given the large difference in prices, consumers may instead buy it in the US or UAE.”

Pathak expects the Pro and Pro Max models to increase their share of iPhone sales. These accounted for around 13 per cent of total iPhone sales in 2025, and Counterpoint expects this to rise

to 17 per cent this year. The higher-end segment, he noted, is generally less sensitive to price increases.

The price increase could matter more for the iPhone 17, which attracts a significant number of first-time buyers switching from Android. For these consumers, Pathak said, the higher price could be a concern unless it is supported by generous, long-tenure EMI schemes.

Retailers are also expecting a modest boost from the pre-festival demand. “We expect a 5-10 per cent increase in sales in the high-end segment of the mobile market due to the rush for Apple phones — both old and new,” said Kailash Lakhyani, chairman of the All India Mobile Retailers Association.

Ecommerce platforms have already run out of stock of the older iPhone 17 models, while retailer inventories could be exhausted within three to four days, he said. The iPhone 17 Pro and Pro Max are also seeing healthy demand.

A check of major ecommerce and retail sites, including Amazon, Flipkart, Vijay Sales and Croma, found no availability of the older models in Delhi or Mumbai.

The widening price differential, however, could create a challenge for Apple. Lakhyani estimates that the iPhone Duo could cost ₹80,000 to ₹1 lakh more in India than in the US or UAE. Such a gap, he cautions, could encourage grey-market imports and sales, an issue Apple has sought to contain in the past.



quick scroll

Semicon sector scores \$1.4 bn funding; half of it since 2025



India's semiconductor sector has attracted \$1.4billion in all-time equity funding across 281 funded firms, with nearly half of this amount — \$701 million — raised since 2025 alone, as per data from Tracxn. The findings come days ahead of SEMICON India 2026, India's flagship semiconductor conference and exhibition, which will be held from September 17-19 at Yashobhoomi in Dwarka, New Delhi. Prime Minister Narendra Modi will inaugurate the fifth edition of SEMICON India 2026 on September 17, a mega-event set to bring together global semiconductor industry leaders, government officials.

PTI

Oracle set to spend \$700 mn more for job cuts

Oracle Corp increased the scale of its planned job cuts while the firm grapples with a cash crunch tied to development of large-scale data centres for artificial intelligence work. It also disclosed a new share trading programme for Chairman Larry Ellison, who owns about 40 per cent of Oracle's stock. The plan, which was adopted June 22, permits Ellison to sell 50 million shares through October 24, the firm said. The cost of Oracle's job cuts, which the company lists as "2026 Restructuring Plan," is now estimated at about \$2.8 billion, largely made up of severance payments to fired employees, according to the filing. Oracle has already accrued about \$2.1 billion in costs tied to the plan, and the \$700 million increase reflects "additional actions that we expect to take," the company said.

BLOOMBERG

China's data regulator plans standards push for embodied AI

China's data regulator said it plans to develop standards for embodied artificial intelligence (AI) and guide local authorities in related work, as demand for high-quality, diverse and large-scale datasets continues to grow. The National Data Administration said it will strengthen planning and development guidance for the sector, while supporting firms in increasing investment in data resources. It said the measures are intended to better enable embodied AI development and promote the industry's healthy growth, according to a statement posted on its website on Sunday. The comments were made at a meeting chaired by Liu Liehong, head of the agency, where representatives from research institutes, technology and humanoid-robotics organisations discussed how data can support embodied AI development.

BLOOMBERG

China's Z.AI raises \$5 bn from new share, convertible bond sales

Beijing-based artificial intelligence (AI) firm Z.AI raised a total of \$5 billion from a Hong Kong share placement of about \$2 billion and a concurrent convertible bond sale of about \$3 billion, the company said in a Hong Kong stock exchange filing on Sunday. Z.AI launched the sales on Friday, offering 21.97 million new Hong Kong shares at HK\$714 (\$91.05) each, a 10 per cent discount to Friday's closing price of HK\$793. The firm also raised 20.14 billion yuan (\$3 billion) of zero-coupon bonds due in September 2027, the filing showed. The yuan-

denominated bonds will be settled in US dollars. The bonds were issued at 100.5 per cent of their face value, the filing showed. The initial conversion price is HK\$892.50, a 25 per cent premium to the HK\$714 share placement price. Z.AI can redeem all, but not part, of the bonds from February 18, 2027, if its shares trade at or above 130 per cent of the conversion price for 20 out of 30 trading days, according to the sheet. About 60 per cent of the net proceeds will be used for research and development of the company's next-generation models.

REUTERS

India is rising star for AI tools at SAP Labs

AASHISH ARYAN

New Delhi, 13 September

India is gaining an increasingly important role in SAP's global portfolio of work in the artificial intelligence (AI) and agentic AI space as the country's centres now contribute to nearly 40 per cent of the overall research and development (R&D) work on AI and AI-powered agents developed and deployed by the company, SAP Labs India Managing Director Sindhu Gangadharan said.

These Indian campuses, situated across Bengaluru, Pune and Hyderabad, and other cities, also contribute to the development and deployment of around 80 per cent of all the AI agents that SAP now builds for its cus-

tomers, Gangadharan said, adding that there has been a marked increase in the domestic intellectual property innovation as well.

Earlier in May, SAP identified finance, supply chain, expenditure management, customer and human experience as five major domains where an AI agent could be built and introduced for the customers, Gangadharan said.

The role that Indian centres play in SAP's portfolio has since increased, as there are a large number of domain experts and products managers at SAP Labs India, who understand the finer nuances of these five domains, she said.

"These centres also contribute to around 25 per cent of all the patents that are filed by



“FOR ANY AI AGENT THAT WE BUILD AND DEPLOY, WE ARE NOT TAKING AWAY DECISION MAKING PROCESS FROM THE CUSTOMER. THE AGENTS ARE DOING ALL THE MANUAL WORK, BUT THE FINAL DECISION IS STILL PENDING WITH THE HUMAN IN THE LOOP”

Sindhu Gangadharan MD, SAP Labs India

SAP as a company every year. There is no point of having 1,000 people at a centre in my team if they are doing no innovation. The Indian teams are at the forefront of several AI innovations for SAP globally," she said.

Though there is some apprehension among customers when it comes to the deployment of frontier AI agents for their networks, especially with respect to safety and security of their workflows,

SAP has created strong platform-based agents that are governed by the principles created for them and do not break out of the sandboxes defined for them, Gangadharan said.

"For any AI agent that we build and deploy, we are not taking away the decision making process from the customer. The agents are doing all the manual work, but the final decision is still pending with the human in the loop," she said.

SAP also views the development and deployment of AI agents through the lens of relevance, reliability, and responsibility, given the critical nature of the client's domains, she said.

Beyond India's growing importance in AI tools and services development across

SAP's overall portfolio, the country has also climbed several rungs in contributing to the company's global revenue, Gangadharan said.

"India remains one of our fastest-growing markets, and there is no question about it. It is one of our top 10 markets globally. The country is seeing one of the highest growth in the number of new GCCs (global capability centres)," she said.

SAP continues to focus on its small and medium client segments, which make up more than 80 per cent of the company's global portfolio. In India, SMEs are growing faster than anywhere else in the world, driving the highest consumption of the company's public cloud offerings, Gangadharan said.

Experts doubtful if AI race can be slowed down

AVIK DAS

Bengaluru, 13 September

The world of artificial intelligence (AI) and large language models (LLM) suddenly seems to have turned upside down in a week, with researchers and scientists warning of the rising power and thinking capabilities of the LLMs and agents, and flagging that firms need to slow the pace of development of the machines.

From gloating about how powerful and more capable the updated version of an LLM is and what marvels an agent can perform in an enterprise, the founders of OpenAI, Anthropic and xAI have agreed that without restraints, the models can pose a threat to humanity. The humdrum has put to backburner a milestone achievement by OpenAI; its agents found a solution to a decades-old advanced maths problem in a matter of hours.

Experts say all the concerns of doomsday can only be addressed if the frontier model companies stay invested in

what they say. "They need to walk the talk," according to Pankit Desai, cofounder and chief executive officer (CEO) of cybersecurity company Securetek. He added that the companies are asking for government intervention to regulate and to put more humans in the loop to prevent the agents from going rogue. But he does not believe they will stop model development.

"You cannot stop these models from getting better. There is competitive and business pressure and if the US stops then maybe China will go ahead. I am not sure if we have that sort of a buy-in globally, due to the current distrust and opposing camps. And why should they stop what they are doing considering for earlier technology, you needed human capital to make it better, while now one needs only infrastructure capital," he said.

Over the weekend, Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei said that frontier model companies need to slow the pace at which they improve capabil-

“WE MUST SLOW THE PACE AT WHICH WE IMPROVE THE CAPABILITIES OF AI MODELS”

Dario Amodei Cofounder & CEO, Anthropic



ities of AI models, as the risks of losing control of AI systems, cyberattacks, and causing catastrophic economic disruption continue to grow.

Both Elon Musk, who runs



“COMMITTING TO HAVING INDEPENDENT EVALUATORS WITH EMPLOYEE-LIKE ACCESS IS A GREAT IDEA, AND WE WILL DO THE SAME”

Sam, Altman, CEO, OpenAI



Elon Musk, Founder & CEO, xAI

xAI, and Sam Altman, CEO of OpenAI, said they agree with Amodei. "Committing to having independent evaluators with employee-like access is a great idea, and we will do the

same," Altman said, adding that more information will be shared soon.

Similarly, Google DeepMind Chairman Demis Hassabis also voiced his support for Amodei, saying while the details need working through, the "direction is correct for meeting this critical moment".

"We must slow the pace at which we improve the capabilities of AI models. Progress will still seem fast, and we must make wise use of the time we gain," Amodei wrote in a lengthy essay over the weekend, in one of his starkest and most direct call to the international AI community.

Bailey Whitfield Diffie, an American mathematician and cryptographer, believes the more people are involved in directing and controlling AI, the more influence people will have over the machines. He does not believe that controlling the speed of development is possible. "People think they can control the speed of things. I think they're just deluding themselves. Yes, you can lower the

funding for AI, but funding is attracting investors. You probably will have to pass rules for that. And I'm not at all sure I see how much virtue there would be in that," he told *Business Standard* in an interaction last week. The concerning message comes amid a growing clarion call among AI scientists and researchers, especially in the last week, to rein in the extreme capabilities of the models and agents who seemingly have abilities to cause unprecedented disruption through coordinated attacks if left unchecked.

The alarm comes a few days after Jacob Coxon, a scientist at Anthropic who resigned last week, said the LLMs are not acting responsibly and racing straight to self-improving superintelligence and gambling with human lives.

Despite advances in AI models and agents, enterprises currently lack justification to adopt the most powerful ones, said Arun Ramchandran, chief executive officer (CEO) of digital product engineering platform QBurnst.

Dish TV bets on smart TV VZY, ecom for turnaround

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA New Delhi, 13 September

Dish TV, a direct-to-home service provider facing subscription losses, hopes for a business turnaround, supported by new initiatives such as its smart TV business VZY, its B2C e-commerce platform ShopZop, and its content aggregation platform Watcho.

Dish TV, which reported a year-on-year drop of 25.84 per cent in its revenue to ₹1,162.61 crore along with a negative Ebitda in FY26 mainly due to "rise of alternative entertainment options", is diversifying its operations in a bid to recover, according to annual report of the company.

Pointing towards early signs of traction across its newer business lines, its CEO and Executive Director Manoj Dobhal said: "We remain confident that our new initiatives will take us on the path of recovery and growth."

This confidence emanates from VZY TV's crossing ₹100 crore milestone, growth of its digital app and website — Watcho, and early traction of our hybrid packages to existing subscribers, Dobhal told share-

holders of the company. Dish TV in September last year entered smart TV market with VZY range, which integrates DTH and OTT services. The platform hosted an inaugural three-day event in Mumbai in March 2026, and the company aims to expand it as the largest such hub in Southeast Asia.

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IN BRIEF

BofA to infuse ₹18K cr by Dec, says Jio Fin

Non-bank lender Jio Credit will get the capital of ₹18,268 crore from Bank of America (BoFA) by December this year once all the regulatory approvals for the infusion are in place, a top official at parent Jio Financial Services (JFS) has said. Once the capital comes in, the entity will re-evaluate its business strategies and also product plans to accelerate growth in assets under management (AUM), the official said, adding that BoFA is “aligned” with the need for the book to grow fast. Jio Credit’s AUM can grow by around five times from the present ₹30,000 crore courtesy the capital infusion, JFS’ Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer Hitesh Sethia told *PTI*, clarifying that this is the growth runway and not a timed target, which the business is working with. The firm will not need any new capital till the AUM touches up to ₹1.5 trillion, he added. **PTI**

Oriental Insurance hopes to profit in FY27 from NSE stake dilution

Public sector general insurer Oriental Insurance Company is poised to return to profit in 2026-27 (FY27), helped by planned stake dilution in NSE through initial public offerings opening for subscription later this week. “We are targeting to make some profit this year...the proceeds from the NSE IPO would be booked as profit. It will improve the company’s financials. Besides, it is going to provide liquidity,” Oriental Insurance Company Chairman and Managing Director Sanjay Joshi told *PTI*. The company is only diluting a small portion of its holding in the NSE via the upcoming IPO, he said, adding about 4.957 million shares have been put on offer. Oriental Insurance Company holds 35.2 million shares in the NSE, as of June 30, 2026. **PTI**

Plans to enter life insurance, MF biz on track: Indian Bank MD

Indian Bank’s plans to enter the life insurance and asset management segments are progressing as planned, and it would soon approach the board for approval, the bank’s Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer (MD& CEO) Binod Kumar said. The lender is currently in the process of seeking approval from its board for the proposed subsidiaries or joint ventures, following which other necessary processes will be initiated, Kumar told *PTI* in an interview. Regarding entry into the life insurance and asset management space, he said, “It is very much on track. We are in the process of seeking board approval and thereafter initiate other relevant regulatory and administrative processes.” Kumar said identifying the right partner would be a crucial part of the exercise, as a strong partner can help accelerate wealth creation. **PTI**

Govt nod must for use of official logo of Indian Patent Office: DPIIT

No person, business entity, digital platform, trademark or patent agent, or legal practitioner can display, replicate, or use the official logo of the Indian Patent Office in any medium without prior approval from the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, according to a Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) public notice. It has come to the attention of the Office of the Controller General of Patents, Designs and Trade Marks that various individuals, agencies, corporate bodies, online legal tech platforms, and unauthorised service providers are unlawfully utilising the official logo, emblem, and design of the Indian Patent Office on their websites, social media accounts, marketing collateral, stationery. The logo, it said, is an official government identifier representing the statutory authority under the DPIIT, Ministry of Commerce and Industry. **PTI**

Race for HDFC Bank MD & CEO likely between insider, outsider

Order of preference in which two names are submitted to RBI is critical

SUBRATA PANDA
Mumbai, 13 September

A senior internal executive and an external candidate are in the race to become HDFC Bank’s next managing director (MD) and chief executive officer (CEO), according to a person familiar with the matter. The board of India’s largest private-sector lender has sent two names to the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for approval.

The order of preference in which the bank submitted the two names to the central bank is likely to be important in determining who gets the top job, the person said.

The internal candidate is most likely Deputy Managing Director Kaizad Bharucha, 60, while the identity of the external candidate could not be immediately ascertained.

Another senior internal executive, Jimmy Tata, 59, has been elevated by HDFC Bank’s board to whole-time director, designated as executive director, for a three-year period, subject to RBI approval. He is chief credit officer since December 2020.

The board approved the two candidates based on recommendations from its Governance, Nomination and Remuneration Committee and submitted their names to the RBI in order of preference, along with proposed remuneration, for a three-year term, the bank said in a stock exchange filing on Saturday. It did not disclose the names.



Deputy MD Kaizad Bharucha (*left*), whose name is doing the rounds for the position of MD & CEO. Meanwhile, the bank’s Chief Credit Officer Jimmy Tata has been elevated as whole-time director



The selection process comes after incumbent MD & CEO Sasidhar Jagdishan told the board late last month that he would not seek reappointment after his second term ends on October 26. Jagdishan, 61, took charge in October 2020, succeeding Aditya Puri, and was reappointed in 2023.

Bharucha joined HDFC Bank’s board in 2014 and is its longest-serving executive board member. A career banker with more than 39 years of experience, he has been associated with HDFC Bank since its inception.

Under RBI norms, the tenure of a whole-time director, including the period served as chief executive, is capped at 15 years. For Bharucha to serve a full three-year term as MD&CEO, some relaxation from the central bank would therefore be required.

Tata, meanwhile, has been with HDFC Bank since 1994, when he joined as a relationship manager in the corporate banking department. He subsequently became head of the corporate banking department and was appointed chief risk officer in June 2013.

External contenders

Several senior bankers have previously been linked to the HDFC Bank top post, including Anup Bagchi, MD&CEO of ICICI Prudential Life Insurance Co; Rajiv Sabharwal, MD&CEO of Tata Capital; and Pralay Mondal, MD & CEO of CSB Bank. The RBI’s approval will ultimately determine the appointment.

Fourth whole-time director

Separately, HDFC Bank’s board has created an additional whole-time director position, taking the

number of such directors to four, apart from the MD & CEO. This is intended to strengthen oversight and succession planning.

“The said position will be filled in consultation with the new managing director & chief executive officer, after he/she takes charge of the position,” the bank said in a stock exchange filing.

Because of the size of the bank, the person familiar with the matter said, “it needs four people at the director level to manage it, hence the board thought of creating this position.” Having four whole-time directors would be preferable to three for running the bank, the person said.

Private-sector banks typically have one MD & CEO and three other whole-time directors, designated as executive directors on the board. HDFC Bank currently has Jagdishan, Bharucha and V Srinivasa Rangan in these positions.

Earlier this year, Bhavesh Zaveri retired as executive director of the bank. Following his retirement, the bank did not appoint a replacement to its board.

Rangan’s reappointment has been approved by the bank’s board for one year from November 23, 2026, to November 22, 2027. Rangan, 66, is an executive director and heads the human resources, corporate legal, group oversight & secretarial, investment banking, information security group, ethics function and fraud & vigilance functions of the bank.

RBI for 60-day debit hold on suspected mule accounts

SUBRATA PANDA
Mumbai, 13 September

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has proposed a standard operating procedure (SOP) for banks to place temporary debit holds on amounts or accounts suspected to be linked to money-mule activity and cyber-enabled financial fraud.

The draft directions have been issued following the Supreme Court’s August 4 order directing the central bank to prescribe an SOP for temporary debit holds in such cases.

Under the proposed SOP, banks will have to immediately place a temporary debit hold on a transaction identified as a suspected money mule transaction. If the entire account is identified as a suspected money mule account, the hold can be placed on the account.

A suspected money mule transaction has been defined as a transaction of ₹1,000 or more flagged by banks’ transaction-monitoring systems, including artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning (ML)-based tools.

The indicators include transactions that are unusual or disproportionate to the customer’s declared profile or are linked to an account already reported as a money mule or fraudulent.

Banks will have to immediately inform customers about the hold, the reasons for it, the process for its removal and the contact details of the concerned officer.

Customers will get 20 days to submit an explanation or justification regarding the genuineness of the transaction or account.

The bank will have to take a decision within 10 days of receiving the customer’s explanation. If no explanation is received, it will have 30 days from the date of the temporary debit hold to take a decision.

If the bank is satisfied with the explanation, it will have to remove the hold immediately. If the bank is not satisfied, it will continue the hold and report the matter to the jurisdictional police authority. It would be done through the National Cybercrime Reporting Portal’s Citizen Financial Cyber Fraud Reporting and Management System (NCRP-CFCFRMS).

If no instruction requiring continuation of the hold is received from a law enforcement agency or competent authority within 30 days of the reference, the bank will have to remove the hold on the 31st day from the date of reference.

The maximum duration of a temporary debit hold, in the absence of such an instruction, will be 60 days from the date of the initial hold.

The RBI has proposed that



Due process

- Banks will have to immediately inform customers about the hold and state reasons for it
- If the entire account is identified as a suspected mule account, the hold can be placed on the account
- Customers to get a 20-day window to explain or justify the genuineness of the transaction or account
- Banks will have to take a decision within 10 days of receiving the customer’s explanation
- In case of no explanation, banks to take 30 days time to make a decision

account-level holds should be used as a last resort and only in exceptional circumstances.

Banks will have to put in place internal policies covering technology for identifying suspected money mule and cyber-fraud transactions.

They would need to have criteria for placing and removing holds, customer communication, linkage with the NCRP-CFCFRMS portal and grievance redressal.

Banks would still be required to file Suspicious Transaction Reports (STRs) with the Financial Intelligence Unit-India (FIU-IND).

If a bank establishes that an account is a money mule account but has not filed an STR, it will be deemed to have not complied with the know-your-customer (KYC) directions. Banks will also have to maintain a centralised record of cases, involving temporary debit holds, including correspondence with customers and law-enforcement agencies.

Such records will have to be retained for at least five or 10 years after account closure.

Banks will also have to undertake enhanced monitoring of such accounts and other active accounts or relationships held by the customer.

For customer grievances, banks will have to designate nodal officers and display their details on their websites and at branches. Complaints will have to be resolved within 30 days.

The RBI has invited comments from banks, other stakeholders and the public by October 2. The directions are proposed to come into effect from April 1, 2027.

IBBI proposes tighter rules for personal guarantor insolvency

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, 13 September

The Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI) has proposed changes to the norms governing the insolvency resolution process for personal guarantors to corporate debtors.

The watchdog plans to make valuation of a personal guarantor’s assets mandatory during the resolution process, as well as put in place a framework for recording creditors’ deliberations on the repayment plan.

In the proposed amendments in the rules to strengthen safeguards in the insolvency resolution process for personal guarantors to the corporate debtors, IBBI has also called for identification and reporting of avoidance transactions (preferential, undervalued, fraudulent, and extortionate credit transactions) in the insolvency resolution process.

The proposals come against the backdrop of the insolvency case involving Essel Group chairman Subhash Chandra, wherein under a settlement plan it was proposed that creditors could recover just about ₹6.5 crore from his personal estate against claims of roughly ₹22,006 crore.

On September 1, a five-member special bench of the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) barred



ILLUSTRATION: AJAYA MOHANTY

Chandra from alienating his properties and issued notices to all parties in the case.

The case is now also before the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT), after dissenting lenders challenged the plan.

In a discussion paper on September 12, the IBBI proposed calibrated amendments to the insolvency process regulations on the exclusion of related parties of the guarantor from voting on the repayment plan. Currently, an associate of a personal guarantor is barred from voting on the repayment plan.

IBBI has suggested that a related

On the cards

- Regulator proposed identification, reporting of avoidance transactions
- A related party of the guarantor shall be assigned a ‘nil’ voting share
- A registered valuer to determine the fair value of the assets of the guarantor
- Valuation report to be placed before the creditors to make an informed judgment
- If admitted claims are lower than payout amount, creditors should record the commercial rationale for the approval

party of the guarantor shall be assigned a ‘nil’ voting share and the list of creditors prepared by the resolution professional shall separately indicate whether a creditor is a related party of the guarantor. Another amendment planned is for the resolution professional to appoint a registered valuer to determine the fair value and the realisable value of the assets of the guarantor.

“The fair value, the realisable value and the valuation report should be placed before the creditors, along with the repayment plan, for their consideration,” IBBI said.

Coal stocks at Punjab’s power plants at ‘114% of requirement’

Coal stocks at Punjab State Power Corporation’s plants stood at around 114 per cent of the normative requirement, reflecting more than adequate coal availability as of September 11, the coal ministry clarified on Sunday. PSPCL operates three thermal power plants, including Guru Hargobind TPS, Goindwal Sahib TPP and Ropar TPS, with a combined capacity of 2,300 megawatt (MW).

“Despite this comfortable stock position, the tentative Plant Load Factor (PLF) of PSPCL’s plants during September 2026 was only around 59 per cent. The low generation during the month, therefore, cannot be attributed to inadequate coal availability at the plant end,” the ministry said.

The ministry was responding to media reports attributing reduced power generation at Punjab’s thermal plants to plant outages and inadequate coal supply. “Coal India Limited (CIL) remains fully committed to ensuring uninterrupted coal supply for power generation across the country, including in Punjab.” **SUDHEER PAL SINGH**

Railways’ freight loading up 5.4% to 137.9 mt in August

DHRUVAKSH SAHA
New Delhi, 13 September

Freight on Indian Railways grew by 5.4 per cent in August, rising to 137.9 million tonnes (mt), the Ministry of Railways said on Sunday. The increase in freight movement reflects growing demand from key sectors such as coal, iron ore, steel, fertilisers and other commodities.

“Higher rail freight movement also helps industries access reliable transportation while supporting the movement of essential commodities across regions,” the railways said. Cargo volumes in August 2025 were 130.9 mt.

The railways did not share volumes of specific goods transported during the month, but said that iron ore loading increased by 12.1 per cent, clinker by 10.4 per cent, domestic containers by 9.2 per cent and coal by 6 per cent. Finished steel loading increased by 4.9 per cent, mineral oil by 3.1 per cent, fertilisers by 1.6 per cent and balance other goods by 8.2 per cent.

During the month, 14

Amrit Bharat services were regularised, providing more affordable and comfortable travel options to passengers across several important routes, while five new Gati Shakti Cargo Terminals (GCTs) were commissioned to improve last-mile freight connectivity for industries.

Freight revenue during August 2026 increased by 6.27 per cent year-on-year. The railways also opened five new Gati Shakti Cargo Terminals, taking the total number of these dedicated cargo terminals to 149. Moreover, the national transporter witnessed a 9 per cent year-on-year growth in suburban rail travel in August, ferrying 380 million short-distance passengers during the month.

Total passenger volumes on the national rail network grew by close to 5 per cent year-on-year, with the railways carrying 672.7 million passengers in August. With increased passenger demand during the festival season, Indian Railways operated 144 trips of Rakshabandhan Special trains between 25 and 31 August 2026.

India set to expand missile-testing infra with new facilities

Specialised range taking shape in Andhra Pradesh, while West Bengal clears way for DRDO’s new testing facility

HEMANT KUMAR ROUT
Bhubaneswar, 13 September

India is set to redraw the geography of its missile-testing infrastructure with facilities proposed to come up in Andhra Pradesh and West Bengal.

While a specialised range is taking shape in Nagayalanka, Andhra Pradesh, the new government in West Bengal has agreed to facilitate a testing facility in Junput, which is on the Bay of Bengal coast in Purba Medinipur district.

The emerging network is being designed to support a rapidly expanding portfolio of ballistic and cruise missiles, air-defence interceptors, and ballistic-missile defence systems to give India the testing capacity needed to sustain its strategic competition with its neighbouring countries.

Defence sources said New Delhi was moving beyond its long-standing dependence on the missile-testing complex in Odisha.

“The Junput facility will work like an extension of the

Chandipur test range, located around 75 km away,” said a defence official, refusing to give details on the weapons to be tested there.

The Integrated Test Range (ITR) in Chandipur and Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Island off the Odisha coast have been the centre of gravity for India’s missile flight-testing programme for decades. But the character and scale of that programme have changed with India developing weapons across a wider range of speeds, ranges and mission profiles, giving rise to the requirements of multiple launch sites, tracking radars, telemetry and electro-optical systems.

The Andhra Pradesh facility is being designed with a launch centre, technical instrumentation facilities, indigenous radars, telemetry systems and electro-optical tracking systems.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi had laid the foundation stone for the Navdurga missile-test range, estimated at around ₹1,460 crore, in Nagayalanka last year.

However, the location of



An Agni missile on the launch pad at APJ Abdul Kalam Island off the Odisha coast

FILE PHOTO: DRDO

the proposed Junput facility is significant because it will add another coastal launch and tracking node to India’s eastern testing facility.

Both Chandipur and Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Island have direct access to maritime flight corridors for missile trials. The Nagayalanka facility, by contrast, is being developed inland in Krishna district, and its location is expected to provide a different testing geometry and

operational envelope from the coastal ranges.

“The geographical diversification could give the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) greater flexibility in designing flight trajectories, positioning tracking and telemetry assets and conducting complex tests that require more than one launch or tracking location,” said the defence official.

However, unlike Junput,

which was conceived principally to provide additional operational capacity for the Chandipur facility, Nagayalanka has a particularly important role in India’s Phase-II Ballistic Missile Defence (BMD) programme.

The DRDO’s Phase-II BMD programme is intended to deal with more sophisticated and longer-range ballistic missile threats.

Unlike a conventional missile test, a BMD trial involves an incoming target missile and an interceptor, often requiring carefully controlled trajectories and multiple tracking and sensor systems. Although proposed in the early part of this decade, the Junput project saw no significant progress because the previous government in the state did not respond to communications from the Ministry of Defence (MoD). The site was selected to meet safety requirements while providing access to the Bay of Bengal for missile flight-testing.

Land acquisition for the test centre has been completed along with the road to

the project site.

“We have responded to the letters from the Centre and are working to facilitate the test facility,” West Bengal Chief Minister Suvenudh Adhikari said recently.

According to the prevailing safety protocols, people living within 1 km of the range will be evacuated temporarily, with compensation and safe shelter arrangements prescribed for such trials.

Experts say as production capacity expands, development cycles will multiply. More ranges mean greater testing throughput, more flexibility in scheduling trials, and potentially shorter development cycles.

“A defence company may have the manufacturing capability to produce weapons, but it still requires access to an appropriate test range for developmental and validation trials. If range availability becomes a bottleneck, the country’s manufacturing ambitions cannot translate into faster induction or exports,” pointed out N K Samal, a defence analyst.

This advertisement is for information purposes only and does not constitute an offer or an invitation or a recommendation to purchase, to hold or sell securities. This is not an announcement for the offer document. All capitalized terms used herein and not defined herein shall have the meaning assigned to them in the Letter of Offer dated September 09, 2026 the "Letter of Offer" or ("LOF") filed with the BSE Limited ("BSE") and the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI").



Indrayani Biotech
Inclusive Growth

INDRAYANI BIOTECH LIMITED

CIN: L40100TN1992PLC129301

Our Company was originally incorporated as "Indrayani Biotech Private Limited" at Pune Maharashtra as a Private Limited Company under the provisions of the Companies Act, 1956 vide Certificate of Incorporation dated March 09, 1992, issued by the Registrar of Companies, Mumbai Maharashtra. Subsequently Company converted into public limited Company and the name of the Company was changed to "Indrayani Biotech Limited" vide fresh Certificate of Incorporation dated April 09, 1992, issued by the Registrar of Companies, Mumbai Maharashtra. For further details please refer to the section titled "General Information" beginning on page 5 of the Letter of offer.

Registered Office: Block 1 Module No.33, 3rd Floor, Sidco Electronic Complex, Thiru Vi Ka Industrial Estate Guindy, Chennai, Tamil Nadu - 600032, India
Tel: 44-24463751 | **Email:** cs@indrayani.com | **Website:** www.indrayani.com | **Contact Person:** C S Shanmuga Sundar, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

ISSUE OF UP TO 3,25,25,897 PARTLY PAID-UP EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10.00 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF INDRAYANI BIOTECH LIMITED ("INDRANIB" OR THE "COMPANY" OR THE "ISSUER") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ 15 PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING PREMIUM OF ₹ 5 PER EQUITY SHARE) ("ISSUE PRICE") FOR AN AGGREGATE AMOUNT NOT EXCEEDING ₹ 4878.88 LAKHS* TO THE ELIGIBLE EQUITY SHAREHOLDERS ON RIGHTS BASIS IN THE RATIO OF 5 (FIVE) PARTLY PAID UP EQUITY SHARES FOR EVERY 7 (SEVEN) FULLY PAID UP EQUITY SHARE HELD BY THE ELIGIBLE EQUITY SHAREHOLDERS ON THE RECORD DATE, I.E. 28TH APRIL, 2026 (THE "ISSUE"). THE ISSUE PRICE IS 1.5 TIMES OF FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES. FOR FURTHER DETAILS, PLEASE SEE THE CHAPTER TITLED "TERMS OF THE ISSUE" ON PAGE 119 OF THIS LETTER OF OFFER. @assuming full subscription.

ISSUE PROGRAMME		
ISSUE OPENS ON	LAST DATE OF ON-MARKET RENUNCIATIONS*	ISSUE CLOSSES ON**
TUESDAY, SEPTEMEBER 15, 2026	THURSDAY, OCTOBER 08, 2026	WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 14, 2026

*Eligible Equity Shareholders are requested to ensure that renunciation through off-market transfer is completed in such a manner that the Rights Entitlements are credited to the demat account of the Renouncee(s) on or prior to the Issue Closing Date.
**Our Board or a duly authorized committee thereof will have the right to extend the issue period as it may determine from time to time but not exceeding 30 (thirty) days from the Issue Opening Date (inclusive of the Issue Opening Date). Further, no withdrawal of Application shall be permitted by any Applicant after the Issue Closing Date.

ASBA*

Simple, Safe, Smart
way of Application - Make use of it!!!

*Applications Supported by Blocked Amount (ASBA) is a better way of applying to issues by simply blocking the fund in the bank account, investors can avail the same. For details, check section on ASBA below.

In accordance with Regulation 76 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, the Rights Issue Circular and the ASBA Circulars all investors desiring to make an application in this issue are mandatorily required to use either the ASBA process only, investors should carefully read the provisions applicable to such Applications before making the Application through ASBA. For details refer to "Terms of the Issue Making of an Application through the ASBA process" page 121 of the Letter of Offer.

Please note that subject to SCSBs complying with the requirements of the SEBI circular bearing reference number CIR/CFD/DIL/13/2012 dated September 25, 2012, within the periods stipulated therein, Applications may be submitted at the Designated Branches of the SCSBs. Further, in terms of the SEBI circular bearing reference number CIR/CFD/DIL/1/2013 dated January 2, 2013, it is clarified that for making Applications by SCSBs on their own account using ASBA facility, each such SCSB should have a separate account in its own name with any offer SEBI registered 'SCSB(s)'. Such account shall be used solely for the purpose of making an Application in this issue and clear Demarcated funds should be available in such account for such an Application.

CREDIT OF RIGHTS ENTITLEMENTS IN DEMAT ACCOUNTS OF ELIGIBLE EQUITY SHAREHOLDERS:
Pursuant to provisions of the SEBI ICDR Regulations and the SEBI Rights Issue Circulars and in terms of the Letter of Offer, the Rights Entitlements of the Eligible Equity Share will be credited in their respective demat account and shall be admitted for trading on the Stock Exchange under the INE007C20013 subject to requisite approvals. For details of Credit of the Rights Entitlements, see "Terms of the Issue - Credit of Rights Entitlements in demat accounts of Eligible Equity Shareholders on page 131 of the Letter of Offer.

Please note that in accordance with Regulation 77A of the SEBI ICDR Regulations read with the SEBI Rights Issue Circulars, the credit of Rights Entitlements and Allotment of Equity Shares shall be made in dematerialised form only.

Accordingly, Eligible Equity Shareholders holding Equity Shares in physical form as on Record Date and desirous of subscribing to Equity Shares in this issue are advised to furnish the details of their demat account to the Registrar or our Company at least two Working Days prior to the Issue Closing Date, to enable the credit of their Rights Entitlements in their respective demat accounts at least one day before the Issue Closing Date. The Shareholder who failed to provide their demat details in the stipulated time than their rights entitlement shall lapse and shall not be eligible to apply in this issue.

The Eligible Equity Shareholders shall send a letter to the Registrar containing the name(s), address, e-mail address, contact details and the details of their demat account along with copy of self-attested PAN and self-attested client master sheet of their demat account either by email, post, speed post, courier or hand delivery so as to reach to the Registrar no later than two working days prior to the issue closing date.

Prior to the Issue Opening Date, the Rights Entitlements of those Eligible Equity Shareholders, among others, who hold Equity Shares in physical form, and whose demat account details are not available with our Company or the Registrar, shall be credited in a demat suspense escrow account opened by our Company.

PROCEDURE FOR APPLICATION: In accordance with Regulation 76 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, the SEBI Rights Issue Circulars and the ASBA Circulars, all Shareholders desiring to make an Application in this issue are mandatorily required to use the ASBA process. Shareholders should carefully read the provisions applicable to such Applications before making their Application through ASBA. For details of procedure for application by the resident Eligible Equity Shareholders holding Equity Shares in physical form as on the Record Date i.e., April 28, 2026, see "Procedure for Application by Eligible Equity Shareholders holding Equity Shares in physical form" on page 131 of the Letter of Offer.

PROCEDURE FOR APPLICATION THROUGH THE ASBA PROCESS: Shareholders, wishing to participate in this issue through the ASBA facility, is required to have an ASBA enabled bank account with an SCSB, prior to making the Application. Shareholders desiring to make an Application in this issue through ASBA process, may submit the Application Form in physical mode to the Designated Branches of the SCSB or online/ electronic Application through the website of the SCSBs (if made available by such SCSB) for authorizing such SCSB to block Application Money payable on the Application in their respective ASBA Accounts.

Shareholders should ensure that they have correctly submitted the Application Form and have provided an authorisation to the SCSB, via the electronic mode, for blocking funds in the ASBA Account equivalent to the Application Money mentioned in the Application Form, as the case may be, at the time of submission of the Application.

Self-Certified Syndicate Banks:
For the list of banks which have been notified by SEBI to act as SCSBs for the ASBA process, please refer to <https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecogntised?pi=yes&intid=24>.

APPLICATION BY ELIGIBLE EQUITY SHAREHOLDERS HOLDING EQUITY SHARES IN PHYSICAL FORM:
Please note that in accordance with Regulation 77A of the SEBI ICDR Regulations read with the SEBI Rights Issue Circulars, the credit of Rights Entitlements and Allotment of Equity Shares shall be made in dematerialised form only. Accordingly, Eligible Equity Shareholders holding Equity Shares in physical form as on Record Date and desirous of subscribing to Equity Shares in this issue are advised to furnish the details of their demat account to the Registrar or our Company at least two Working Days prior to the Issue Closing Date, to enable the credit of their Rights Entitlements in their respective demat accounts at least one day before the Issue Closing Date.

ALLOTMENT OF THE RIGHTS EQUITY SHARES IN DEMATERIALIZED FORM: PLEASE NOTE THAT THE RIGHTS EQUITY SHARES APPLIED FOR IN THIS ISSUE CAN BE ALLOTTED ONLY IN DEMATERIALIZED FORM AND TO THE SAME DEPOSITORY ACCOUNT IN WHICH OUR EQUITY SHARES ARE HELD BY SUCH INVESTOR ON THE RECORD DATE I.E., APRIL 28, 2026.

DISPATCH OF THE ABRIDGED LETTER OF OFFER ("ALOF") AND APPLICATION FORM: The Dispatch of the ALOF and Application Form for the Issue was completed on September 10, 2026 by the Registrar to the Issue.

CREDIT OF RIGHTS ENTITLEMENTS IN DEMAT ACCOUNTS OF ELIGIBLE EQUITY SHAREHOLDERS: In accordance with Regulation 77A of the SEBI ICDR Regulations read with the SEBI Rights Issue Circulars, the credit of Rights Entitlements and Allotment of Equity Shares shall be made in dematerialized form only. Prior to the Issue Opening Date, our Company shall credit the Rights Entitlements to (i) the demat accounts of the Eligible Equity Shareholders holding the Equity Shares in dematerialised form; and (ii) a demat suspense escrow account (namely, "MIFIL INDRAYANI BIOTECH LTD RIGHTS ESCROW DEMAT ACCOUNT") opened by our Company, for the Eligible Equity Shareholders which would comprise Rights Entitlements relating to (a) Equity Shares held in the account of the IFPP authority; or (b) the demat accounts of the Eligible Equity Shareholder which are frozen or suspended for debit or credit or the Equity Shares which are lying in the unclaimed suspense account (including those pursuant to Regulation 39 of the SEBI Listing Regulations) or details of which are unavailable with our Company or with the Registrar on the Record Date; or (c) Equity Shares held by Eligible Equity Shareholders holding Equity Shares in physical form as on Record Date where details of demat accounts are not provided by Eligible Equity Shareholders to our Company or Registrar; or (d) credit of the Rights Entitlements returned/reversed/taxed; or (e) the ownership of the Equity Shares currently under dispute, including any court proceedings, if any; or (f) non-institutional equity shareholders in the United States. Eligible Equity Shareholders are requested to provide relevant details (such as copies of self-attested PAN and client master sheet of demat account etc., details/records confirming the legal and beneficial ownership of their respective Equity Shares) to our Company or the Registrar not later than two Working Days prior to the Issue Closing Date, i.e., by October 14, 2026, to enable the credit of their Rights Entitlements by way of transfer from the demat suspense escrow account to their demat account at least one day before the Issue Closing Date, to enable such Eligible Equity Shareholders to make an application in this issue, and this communication shall serve as an intimation to such Eligible Equity Shareholders in this regard. Such Eligible Equity Shareholders are also requested to ensure that their demat account, details of which have been provided to our Company or the Registrar account is active to facilitate the aforementioned transfer.

APPLICATIONS ON PLAIN PAPER UNDER ASBA PROCESS: The Application on plain paper, duly signed by the Eligible Equity Shareholder including joint holders, in the same order and as per specimen recorded with his/her bank, must reach the office of the Designated Branch of the SCSB before the Issue Closing Date and should contain the following particulars:

- Name of our Company, being Indrayani Biotech Limited;
- Name and address of the Eligible Equity Shareholder including joint holders (in the same order and as per specimen recorded with our Company or the Depository);
- Folio Number (In case of Eligible Equity Shareholders who hold Equity Shares in physical form as on Record Date)/DP and Client ID;
- Except for Applications on behalf of the Central or State Government, the residents of Sikkim and the officials appointed by the courts, PAN of the Eligible Equity Shareholder and for such Eligible Equity Shareholder in case of joint names, irrespective of the total value of the Equity Shares applied for pursuant to this issue
- Number of Equity Shares held as on Record Date;
- Allotment option – only dematerialised form;
- Number of Equity Shares entitled to;
- Number of Equity Shares applied for within the Rights Entitlements;
- Number of additional Equity Shares applied for, if any (applicable only if entire Rights Entitlements have been applied for);
- Total number of Equity Shares applied for;
- Total amount paid at the rate of Rs. 15 per Equity Share (On application Rs. 3.75 (including premium of Rs. 1.25) per equity share to be paid and balance on one or more subsequent calls;
- Details of the ASBA Account such as the SCSB account number, name, address and branch of the

relevant SCSB;

- (m) In case of non-resident Eligible Equity Shareholders making an application with an Indian address, details of the NRE/FCNR/NRO account such as the account number, name, address and branch of the SCSB with which the account is maintained;
- (n) Authorisation to the Designated Branch of the SCSB to block an amount equivalent to the Application Money in the ASBA Account;
- (o) Signature of the Eligible Equity Shareholder (in case of joint holders, to appear in the same sequence and order as they appear in the records of the SCSB); and
- (p) All such Eligible Equity Shareholders are deemed to have accepted the following:
"If We will not offer, sell or otherwise transfer any of the Rights Equity Shares which may be acquired by us in any jurisdiction or under any circumstances in which such offer or sale is not authorized or to any person to whom it is unlawful to make such offer, sale or invitation except under circumstances that will result in compliance with any applicable laws or regulations. We satisfy, and each account for which we are acting satisfies, all suitability standards for Shareholders in investments of the type subscribed for herein imposed by the jurisdiction of our residence.
If We understand and agree that the Rights Entitlement and Rights Equity Shares may not be reoffered, resold, pledged or otherwise transferred except in an offshore transaction in compliance with Regulation 5, or otherwise pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the US Securities Act.
If We (i) am/ are, and the person, if any, for whose account i/ we am/ are acquiring such Rights Entitlement and/ or the Rights Equity Shares i/ are, outside the U.S., (ii) am/ are not a "U.S. Person" as defined in ("Regulations"), and (iii) i/ are acquiring the Rights Entitlement and/ or the Rights Equity Shares in an offshore transaction meeting the requirements of Regulations.
If We acknowledge that the Company, our affiliates and others will rely upon the truth and accuracy of the foregoing representations and agreements."

In cases where Multiple Application Forms are submitted for Applications pertaining to Rights Entitlements credited to the same demat account or in demat suspense escrow account, as applicable, including cases where a Shareholders submits Application Forms along with a plain paper Application, such Applications shall be liable to be rejected.

Shareholders are requested to strictly adhere to these instructions. Failure to do so could result in an application being rejected, with our Company and the Registrar not having any liability to the Shareholders. The plain paper Application format will be available on the website of the Registrar at <https://n.mpmg.mufg.com>.

Our Company and the Registrar shall not be responsible if the Applications are not uploaded by the SCSB or funds are not blocked in the Shareholders ASBA Accounts on or before the Issue Closing Date.

LAST DATE FOR APPLICATION: The last date for submission of the duly filled in the Application Form or a plain paper Application is October 14, 2026, i.e., Issue Closing Date. Our Board or any committee thereof may extend the said date for such period as it may determine from time to time, subject to the issue period not exceeding 30 days from the Issue Opening Date (inclusive of the Issue Opening Date). If the Application Form is not submitted with an SCSB, uploaded with the Stock Exchange and the Application Money is not blocked with the SCSB on or before the Issue Closing Date or such date as may be extended by our Board or any committee thereof, the invitation to offer contained in the Letter of offer shall be deemed to have been declined and our Board or any committee thereof shall be at liberty to dispose of the Equity Shares hereby offered, as set out in "Basis of Allotment" mentioned on page 125 of the Letter of Offer.

PROCEDURE FOR RENUNCIATION OF RIGHTS ENTITLEMENTS: The Eligible Equity Shareholders may renounce the Rights Entitlements, credited to their respective demat accounts, either in full or in part (a) by using the secondary market platform of the Stock Exchange (the "On Market Renunciation"); or (b) through an off-market transfer (the "Off Market Renunciation"), during the Renunciation Period. The Shareholders should have the demat Rights Entitlements credited/lying in his/her own demat account prior to the renunciation. The trades through On Market Renunciation and Off Market Renunciation will be settled by transferring the Rights Entitlements through the depository mechanism.

Shareholders may be subject to adverse foreign, state or local tax or legal consequences as a result of trading in the Rights Entitlements. Shareholders who intend to trade in the Rights Entitlements should consult their tax advisor or stock-broker regarding any cost, applicable taxes, charges and expenses (including brokerage) that may be levied for trading in Rights Entitlements.

Please note that the Rights Entitlements which are neither renounced nor subscribed by the Shareholders on or before the Issue Closing Date shall lapse and shall be extinguished after the Issue Closing Date.

The Company accept no responsibility to bear or pay any cost, applicable taxes, charges and expenses (including brokerage), and such costs will be incurred solely by the Shareholders.

On Market Renunciation
The Eligible Equity Shareholders may renounce the Rights Entitlements, credited to their respective demat accounts by trading/selling them on the secondary market platform of the Stock Exchange through a registered stock-broker in the same manner as the existing Equity Shares of our Company.

In this regard, in terms of provisions of the SEBI ICDR Regulations and the SEBI Rights Issue Circulars, the Rights Entitlements credited to the respective demat accounts of the Eligible Equity Shareholders shall be admitted for trading on the Stock Exchange under ISIN INE007C20013 subject to requisite approvals. Prior to the Issue Opening Date, our Company will obtain the approval from the Stock Exchange for trading of Rights Entitlements. No assurance can be given regarding the active or sustained On Market Renunciation or the price at which the Rights Entitlements will trade. The details for trading in Rights Entitlements will be as specified by the Stock Exchange from time to time.

The Rights Entitlements are tradable in dematerialized form only. The market lot for trading of Rights Entitlements is One Rights Entitlements.

The On Market Renunciation shall take place only during the Renunciation Period for On Market Renunciation, i.e., from September 15, 2026 to October 08, 2026 (both days inclusive).

The Shareholders holding the Rights Entitlements who desire to sell their Rights Entitlements will have to do so through their registered stock-brokers by quoting the ISIN INE007C20013 and indicating the details of the Rights Entitlements they intend to trade.

The Shareholders can place order for sale of Rights Entitlements only to the extent of Rights Entitlements available in their demat account.

The On Market Renunciation shall take place electronically on secondary market platform of BSE under automatic order matching mechanism and on "T+2 rolling settlement basis", where "T" refers to the date of trading. The transactions will be settled on trade-for-trade basis. Upon execution of the order, the stock-broker will issue a contract note in accordance with the requirements of the Stock Exchange and the SEBI.

Off Market Renunciation
The Eligible Equity Shareholders may renounce the Rights Entitlements, credited to their respective demat accounts by way of an off-market transfer through a depository participant. The Rights Entitlements can be transferred in dematerialised form only.

Eligible Equity Shareholders are requested to ensure that renunciation through off-market transfer is completed in such a manner that the Rights Entitlements are credited to the demat account of the Renouncees on or prior to the Issue Closing Date to enable Renouncees to subscribe to the Equity Shares in the Issue.

The Shareholders holding the Rights Entitlements who desire to transfer their Rights Entitlements will have to do so through their depository participant by issuing a delivery instruction slip quoting the ISIN INE007C20013, the details of the buyer and the details of the Rights Entitlements they intend to transfer. The buyer of the Rights Entitlements (unless already having given a standing receipt instruction) has to issue a receipt instruction slip to their depository participant. The Shareholders can transfer Rights Entitlements only to the extent of Rights Entitlements available in their demat account.

The instructions for transfer of Rights Entitlements can be issued during the working hours of the depository participants.

The detailed rules for transfer of Rights Entitlements through off-market transfer shall be as specified by the NSDL and CDSL from time to time.

INVESTORS TO KINDLY NOTE THAT AFTER PURCHASING THE RIGHTS ENTITLEMENTS (RE) THROUGH ON MARKET RENUNCIATION / OFF MARKET RENUNCIATION, AN APPLICATION HAS TO BE MADE FOR SUBSCRIBING THE SHARES OFFERED UNDER RIGHTS ISSUE. IF NO APPLICATION IS MADE BY THE PURCHASER OF RES ON OR BEFORE ISSUE CLOSING DATE, THEN SUCH RES WILL GET LAPSED AND SHALL BE EXTINGUISHED AFTER THE ISSUE CLOSING DATE. NO SHARES FOR SUCH LAPSED RE WILL BE CREDITED, EVEN IF SUCH RE WERE PURCHASED FROM MARKET AND PURCHASER WILL LOSE THE AMOUNT PAID TO ACQUIRE THE RE. PERSONS WHO HAVE BOUGHT RIGHTS ENTITLEMENTS, SHALL REQUIRE TO MAKE AN APPLICATION AND APPLY FOR SHARES OFFERED UNDER RIGHTS ISSUE, IF THEY WANT TO SUBSCRIBE TO THE SHARES OFFERED UNDER RIGHTS ISSUE.

Fractional Entitlements
The Equity Shares are being offered on a rights basis to existing Eligible Equity Shareholders in the ratio of 5 (Five) partly Paid-up Rights equity Shares for every 7 (seven) fully paid-up Equity Shares held as on the Record Date. As per SEBI Rights Issue Circulars, the fractional entitlements of such eligible equity shareholders, shall be ignored by rounding down of their rights entitlements. However, the eligible shareholders, whose fractional entitlements are being ignored, will be given a preferential consideration for the allotment of 1 (one) additional rights equity share if they apply for additional rights equity shares over and above their rights entitlements, if any, subject to availability of rights equity shares in the Issue, post allocation towards rights entitlements

applied for.

For example, if an Eligible Equity Shareholder holds 7 (Seven) Equity Share, such Equity Shareholder will be entitled to 5 (Five) partly paid up Rights Share(s) and will also be given a preferential consideration for the Allotment of one additional Rights Share if such Eligible Equity Shareholder has applied for additional Rights Shares, over and above his/ her Rights Entitlements, subject to availability of Rights Shares in this Issue post allocation towards Rights Entitlements applied for.

Such Eligible Shareholders are entitled to apply for additional Rights Shares and will be given preference in the Allotment of one Rights Shares, if such Eligible Shareholders apply for additional Rights Shares, subject to availability of Rights Shares in this Issue post allocation towards Rights Entitlements applied for. However, they cannot renounce the same in favour of third parties.

FOR PROCEDURE OF APPLICATION BY SHAREHOLDERS WHO HAVE PURCHASED THE RIGHT ENTITLEMENT THROUGH ON MARKET RENUNCIATION / OFF MARKET RENUNCIATION, PLEASE REFER TO THE HEADING TITLED "PROCEDURE FOR APPLICATION THROUGH THE ASBA PROCESS" ON PAGE 119 OF THE LETTER OF OFFER.

LISTING AND TRADING OF THE RIGHTS EQUITY SHARES TO BE ISSUED PURSUANT TO THE ISSUE: The existing Equity Shares are listed and traded on platform of BSE (Scrip Code: 526445) under the ISIN: INE007C01021. The Equity Shares shall be credited to a temporary ISIN which will be frozen until the receipt of the final listing/trading approvals from the Stock Exchange. Upon receipt of such listing and trading approvals, the Equity Shares shall be debited from such temporary ISIN and credited to the new ISIN for the Equity Shares and thereafter be available for trading and the temporary ISIN shall be permanently deactivated in the depository system of CDSL and NSDL.

DISCLAIMER CLAUSE OF SEBI: The Draft Letter of Offer has not been filed with SEBI in terms of SEBI ICDR Regulations as the size is upto Rs. 4,878.88 Lakhs. The present issue being of less than Rs. 5,000 lakhs, our Company is in compliance with first proviso to Regulation 3 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations and our Company shall file the copy of the Letter of Offer prepared in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations with SEBI for information and dissemination on the website of SEBI i.e., www.sebi.gov.in.

DISCLAIMER CLAUSE OF BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the aforesaid permission given by BSE Limited should not in any way be deemed or construed that the letter of offer has been cleared or approved by BSE Limited; nor does it, certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Letter of offer. The investors are advised to refer to the Letter of Offer for the full text of the "Disclaimer Clause of BSE" beginning on page 112 of the LOF.

DISPATCH AND AVAILABILITY OF ISSUE MATERIALS: In accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, the Abridged Letter of Offer, the Application Form, the Rights Entitlement Letter and other issue material will be sent/ dispatched only to the Eligible Equity Shareholders who have provided Indian address. In case such Eligible Equity Shareholders have provided their valid e-mail address, the Abridged Letter of Offer, the Application Form, the Rights Entitlement Letter and other issue material will be sent only to their valid e-mail address and in case such Eligible Equity Shareholders have not provided their e-mail address, then the Abridged Letter of Offer, the Application Form, the Rights Entitlement Letter and other issue material will be dispatched, on a reasonable effort basis, to the Indian addresses provided by them.

Further, the Letter of Offer will be sent/ dispatched to the Eligible Equity Shareholders who have provided Indian address and who have made a request in this regard. In case such Eligible Equity Shareholders have provided their valid e-mail address, the Letter of Offer will be sent only to their valid e-mail address and in case such Eligible Equity Shareholders have not provided their e-mail address, then the Letter of Offer will be dispatched, on a reasonable effort basis, to the Indian addresses provided by them.

Shareholders can access the Letter of Offer, the Abridged Letter of Offer and the Application Form (provided that the Eligible Equity Shareholder is eligible to subscribe for the Equity Shares under applicable laws) on the websites of:

- Our Company at www.indrayani.com;
- The Registrar at <https://n.mpmg.mufg.com>;
- The Stock Exchange at www.bseindia.com;

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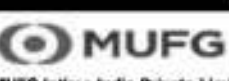
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Investors may contact the Registrar to the Issue or the Company Secretary and Compliance Officer for any pre-issue/ post-issue related matters. All grievances relating to the ASBA process may be addressed to the Registrar to the Issue, with a copy to the SCSB, giving full details such as name, address of the applicant, number of Equity Shares applied for, amount blocked, ASBA Account number and the Designated Branch of the SCSB where the CAF, or the plain paper application, as the case may be, was submitted by the ASBA Investors.

CORRIGENDUM TO THE LETTER OF OFFER DATED SEPTEMBER 09, 2026
The Eligible Equity shareholders, with respect to the LOF dated September 09, 2026, are requested to note that the reference to
1. "India Ratings and Research Private Limited" appearing on page 75 shall be read as "CRISIL Limited"
2. "October 09, 2026" appearing on pages 09 and 134 shall be read as "October 08, 2026"
All the other terms remain unchanged.
INVESTORS MAY PLEASE NOTE THE LETTER OF OFFER, ABRIDGED LETTER OF OFFER, COMMON APPLICATION FORM, LETTER OF OFFER DATED SEPTEMBER 09, 2026 SHALL BE READ IN CONJUNCTION WITH THIS CORRIGENDUM.

For INDRAYANI BIOTECH LIMITED
On Behalf of the Board of Directors

Sd/-

Mr. C S Shanmuga Sundar,
Company Secretary and Compliance officer
Disclaimer: Our Company is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to issue Equity Shares on a rights basis and has filed a Letter of Offer dated September 09, 2026 with the Securities and Exchange Board of India and BSE. The Letter of Offer is available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, website of Stock Exchange where the Equity Shares are listed i.e. BSE at www.bseindia.com. Investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and are requested to refer to the Letter of Offer including the section "Risk Factors" beginning on page 24 of the Letter of Offer. This announcement has been prepared for publication in India and may not be released in the United States. This announcement does not constitute an offer of Rights Equity Shares for sale in any jurisdiction, including the United States, and any Rights Equity Shares described in this announcement may not be offered or sold in the United States absent registration under the US Securities Act of 1933, as amended, or an exemption from registration. There will be no public offering of Rights Equity Shares in the United States.

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India's payment pitch finds no mention in Brics declaration

KRITY AMBEY & ASIT RANJAN MISHRA
New Delhi, 13 September

India's push to link the payment systems of Brics countries, including through the possible interoperability of central-bank digital currencies (CBDCs), has not found its way into the grouping's New Delhi Declaration, leaving its 16-year effort for trade in local currencies without a settled payment architecture.

The omission is significant because India had made cross-border payments a key element of its agenda for Brics chairmanship. Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Governor Sanjay Malhotra had said last month that Brics countries were discussing ways to link fast-payment systems and CBDCs.

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal last week urged Brics members and partner countries to link pay-

ment systems and trade in local currencies.

Instead, the declaration adopted by the Brics leaders on Saturday only "acknowledged" the work of the Brics Payment Task Force (BPTF) on exploring pragmatic solutions on efficient cross-border payment mechanisms. The work draws on the guidance provided in the Kazan and Rio Declarations on the Brics Cross-Border Payments Initiative.

"We acknowledge the work done to study the cross-border interoperability of payment and messaging channels, and the discussions on promoting trade settlements and investments using Brics local currencies, while respecting national priorities and acknowledging that there is no one-size-fits-all approach," the declaration said, implicitly highlighting the differences among member countries.

Linking official digital cur-

rencies of member-countries could have allowed payments initiated in one country to be settled more directly in another country's currency, reducing reliance on correspondent banks and third-country payment channels.

Ajay Srivastava, founder of the Global Trade Research Initiative, said the summit was expected to announce steps to expand local-currency trade through greater invoicing and settlement in national currencies, wider bilateral payment arrangements, links among domestic instant-payment networks, and further work on connecting central-bank digital currencies.

"Instead, the New Delhi Declaration offers no firm action. Without a coordinated action plan, trade in local currencies may grow gradually but is unlikely to reach significant volumes," he added.

Interoperability would let



IMAGING: AJAYA MOHANTY

THE DECLARATION ADOPTED BY THE LEADERS ONLY 'ACKNOWLEDGED' THE WORK OF THE BRICS PAYMENT TASK FORCE ON EXPLORING PRAGMATIC SOLUTIONS ON EFFICIENT CROSS-BORDER PAYMENT MECHANISMS

Brics currency "as of now".

The chronology of talks on local-currency trading at subsequent Brics summits shows slow and incremental progress. In Brasilia in 2010, the four original Bric members agreed only to "study feasibility of monetary cooperation, including local currency trade settlement arrangement".

That was the first explicit summit-level commitment to examining trade settlements in local currencies. There was little movement in the next few declarations. The Ufa Declaration, in 2015, said Brics recog-

nised "the potential for expanding the use of our national currencies" and asked authorities to continue discussion on wider use in mutual trade.

day, Sudhakar Dalela, economic relations secretary in the Ministry of External Affairs, said discussion on trade settlement in local currencies had been underway at Brics for more than a decade. "We believe local-currency settlement is a practical mechanism to reduce transaction cost in bilateral trade," Dalela said, adding that there was no proposal for a

2017 Xiamen Declaration was more substantive, committing members to enhance currency cooperation "including through currency swap, local currency settlement, and local currency direct investment, where appropriate".

The focus then gradually shifted to payment infrastructure. In 2018, the leaders backed greater financial-market integration and continued currency cooperation.

The 2019 Brasilia Declaration acknowledged the importance of a "Brics Survey on International Payments System". In 2020, the leaders welcomed continuing work on cooperation in national payments system and the BPTF, while the 2021 New Delhi Declaration acknowledged its

"fruitful cooperation" through dialogue and discussion.

The 2022 Beijing Declaration again backed the BPTF as a platform for exchanging experience and knowledge.

The language became more explicit in 2023. The Johannesburg Declaration welcomed experience-sharing on payment infrastructure, including "the interlinking of cross-border payment systems", while stressing local currencies and stronger correspondent banking networks. The leaders asked the finance ministers and central bank governors to "consider the issue of local currencies, payment instruments and platforms".

The 2024 Kazan Declaration welcomed local-currency settlements under the voluntary and non-binding BRICS Cross-Border Payments Initiative and again called for considering payment instruments and platforms.

ONE SUMMIT, MANY CONVERSATIONS

Frame by frame



Prime Minister Narendra Modi (centre) with leaders of Brics countries on Day Two of the summit in New Delhi on Sunday



(Extreme left) External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar with Saudi Arabia's Minister of Foreign Affairs Faisal bin Farhan Al Saud. The two discussed the West Asia conflict and also reviewed bilateral ties

(Left) President Droupadi Murmu with her Iranian counterpart Masoud Pezeshkian. At the summit, Pezeshkian slammed the West over impact of sanctions on food security, global welfare

PHOTOS: PTI

Grain Exchange looks promising, but hurdles remain

SANJEEB MUKHERJEE
New Delhi, 13 September

The Brics endorsement of a proposal to set up a Grain Exchange could help challenge the dominance of large European and US-based grain trading firms, but the initiative could face significant operational and implementation hurdles, experts said.

The Brics Grain Exchange, proposed in 2023 as a digital platform, is being championed by Russia, one of the world's largest grain producers.

On Saturday, the New Delhi Declaration of Brics reiterated support for the proposal and mooted expanding it to include other agricultural products and commodities over time.

Brics nations account for 44 per cent of global grain production and more than 25 per cent of consumption, according to estimates. Much of global grain trade — estimated at 70-90 per cent — is controlled by a handful of European and US-based trading firms, with nearly half of their offices located in one European city.

Green fields

44% Brics nations' share of global grain production

Over 25% Brics nations' share of global grain consumption

Russia: One of the world's largest wheat producers

China: One of the largest consumers of rice, maize and soybeans

Brazil: Major exporter of agricultural commodities, including soybeans

commonly referred to as the Global South. From that perspective, such a platform is also very important," Dhar said. He added the exchange could provide a counterbalance to the large European and American grain firms and give Brics countries a greater say in price-setting in global markets.

Gopal Krishan Sood, senior consultant at policy think tank Arcus Policy Research, said the proposed exchange could face major hurdles over the choice of settlement currency, regulatory framework and limited participation by members potentially making it less relevant for India.

"If this (Grains Exchange) is a futures exchange, the first requirement is participation from other countries. India's participation in global grain trade is very limited because rice is not included in the global definition of grains," Sood said. Major globally traded grains include wheat, maize, sorghum and soybeans, among others. While India is a significant producer and trader of some agricultural commodities, its participation in several of these commodities in global trade remains limited, he said.

Sood said the composition of Brics also raised questions about the exchange's potential participation. A more fundamental issue, however, would be the currency in which contracts would be settled.

For India, participation would also be constrained by existing forex regulations.



SIDELIGHTS

Brics backs deeper cooperation on taxation and Customs

Brics leaders on Saturday backed deeper cooperation on taxation and Customs, welcoming initiatives undertaken under India's chairship, including the creation of working groups on international taxation and transfer pricing, and on revenue statistics. The leaders reaffirmed their commitment to a "fair, inclusive, stable, and efficient international tax system" and to strengthening cooperation among Brics members in addressing evolving international tax challenges, according to the New Delhi Declaration adopted at the Summit. The declaration welcomed the establishment of the two tax working groups as part of efforts to deepen institutional cooperation among Brics tax authorities.

OUR BUREAU

Group calls for smooth energy flow amid West Asia conflict

The Brics grouping of nations has expressed deep concern over the continued escalation of tensions in West Asia and has called for exercising maximum restraint as well as avoiding actions that could further aggravate the situation. "We encourage increasing efforts, through dialogue and diplomacy, towards a long-term understanding that will contribute to lasting peace, security and stability in the region. We stress the need to work together to maintain smooth flow of global trade, supply chains and energy, in accordance with applicable international law," the Declaration stated.

OUR BUREAU

Critical minerals push gains momentum over supply chains

The Brics countries have called for reliable, diversified and resilient supply chains for critical minerals, underlining the strategic importance of these resources for clean-energy technologies and energy security and opening scope for greater cooperation among resource-rich nations and consuming economies. The grouping also stressed the need for such supply chains to ensure benefit sharing, value addition and economic diversification in resource-rich countries, while preserving their sovereign rights over mineral resources.

OUR BUREAU

Energy industry expects easier investments across borders

The domestic energy and infrastructure industry expects the discussions in the Brics 2026 summit to lead to meaningful cooperation among the member nations, representing both large producers and consumers, on a host of measures related to manufacturing, investment, technology, and supply chain. "Our wishlist is straightforward. It includes easier cross-border investment, technology partnerships in minerals, storage and biofuels, and development-bank financing for the infrastructure that connects them," Arman Puri, Director at Hindustan Power told *Business Standard*.

OUR BUREAU

Bloc bets on AI, proposes fund for startups

PEERZADA ABRAR
Bengaluru, 13 September

Leaders of Brics committed to implementing a joint statement on artificial intelligence (AI) governance, welcomed a new startup incubator network and floated a proposed innovation fund, according to the New Delhi Declaration issued at the summit.

The document highlights India's hosting of the 'AI Impact Summit' in February 2026, proposes a Brics Startup Innovation Fund, and welcomes a Risk Lab pitched for India's GIFT (Gujarat International Finance Tec) City financial hub. These initiatives highlight India's central role in shaping the bloc's technology agenda.

Brics leaders used their 18th annual summit, chaired by India, to formalise a bloc-wide approach to AI, startups, and

financial innovation. This also reflected India's push to position itself as a hub for the bloc's tech ambitions.

The declaration states the bloc recognises that AI presents immense opportunity to stimulate economic growth and sustainable development for all. The members committed to implement the Brics Leaders' Statement on the Global Governance of Artificial Intelligence.

Industry leaders said the Brics' emphasis on wider access to AI, alongside safety and responsible governance, is timely. They said, AI is no longer a standalone technology theme; it is becoming a horizontal capability across sectors. They see enormous potential for AI to improve enterprise productivity and transform sectors such as financial services, health care and education.

"India is well-positioned, with deep technology talent, digital public infrastructure and a large domestic market where solutions can be tested at population scale," said Gopal Jain, managing director and chief executive, Gaja Capital.

"Just as India demonstrated with digital public infrastructure, it has an opportunity to build AI platforms and applications that are relevant not only for India, but for the wider Global South," said Jain.

Ashok Chandak, President, India electronics and semiconductor association (Iesa) said Brics has reinforced the importance of resilient technology supply chains, semiconductors, critical minerals and frontier technologies.

On startups, the declaration says leaders welcomed the establishment of the Brics Incubator Network and further

consideration of a Brics Startup Innovation Fund, as a potential mechanism to catalyse startups for innovation-led growth. The fund remains conceptual. The bloc commended the Indian chairship for convening the inaugural Brics SME forum in Agra, which produced a report on advancing MSME competitiveness and strengthening access to finance and technology.

India also drove financial-infrastructure proposals tied to tech and risk capital. The declaration notes members expressed interest in taking forward the discussions on India's proposal to host a Brics Risk Lab, open to participation by interested members, at the GIFT City International Financial Services Centre (IFSC) in Gujarat.

More on business-standard.com

Labour initiatives may aid cross-border hiring, says industry

AUHONA MUKHERJEE
New Delhi, 13 September

Industry has welcomed the Brics push for greater cooperation on skills forecasting, remote employment, and cross-border worker mobility, saying the initiatives could help strengthen skills alignment and expand access to international jobs.

The New Delhi Declaration adopted at the Brics Summit on September 12 called for cooperation in forecasting skills needs by analysing labour market trends in digital, green, care, and other priority sectors. It also adopted the Brics Connect (cooperation network for capacity building, employability, and new skills and technologies).

Sonal Arora, country manager for India at global human resources firm GI Group Holding, said Brics Connect could help address the shortage of comparable labour-market intelligence and forward-looking skills data across member economies. But, its more immediate impact was likely on domestic workforce planning, skills mapping, and training pipelines rather than directly driving cross-border hiring.

"Over time, better visibility and greater alignment on skills could support cross-border hiring and worker mobility, but this will depend on factors beyond skills forecasting, including visa regimes, recognition of qualifications, wage differentials and social-security arrangements," she added.



ILLUSTRATION: AJAYA MOHANTY

Rajeev Juneja, president of the industry body PHD Chamber of Commerce and Industry (PHDCCI), said Brics Connect can provide a platform for anticipating emerging skills needs, as technology, artificial intelligence (AI) and the green transition reshape jobs, skills and employment opportunities. "Skills development must

become more closely aligned with actual industry needs, with employers playing a stronger role in identifying emerging skills and occupational needs", he added.

The declaration also noted an initiative to establish an international digital platform for remote employment for Brics countries. Arora said this could provide a new route

Building bridges

- Brics Connect to help identify future skills needs across priority sectors
- Proposed digital platform could widen access to remote jobs across member countries
- Recognition of qualifications may ease cross-border worker mobility
- Social protection for gig workers gets emphasis

for Indian technology talent to access international employment without relocating, particularly as tighter visa and immigration regimes in destinations such as the US made remote work more attractive.

"For the platform to become more than a job-matching marketplace, the supporting ecosystem will be

critical. This includes reliable verification and recognition of skills and qualifications, clarity around employment status and worker protections, social-security arrangements and portability of benefits, as well as clear rules for cross-border taxation, payments and employer compliance," Arora added.

Brics countries also committed to protect the rights of workers moving across borders, ensuring portability of benefits and avoiding double coverage of social-security contributions. PHDCCI said cooperation on recognition of qualifications and social-security portability may facilitate labour mobility by reducing transaction costs for businesses and workers.

More on business-standard.com



Brics ticks all boxes on actionable outcomes

DHRUVAKSH SAHA & ARCHIS MOHAN
New Delhi, 13 September

The concluding day of the 18th Brics Summit revealed the chum within the grouping about the shape it should take in the years to come. India positioned Brics as an inclusive, development-oriented platform, where its presidency of the grouping focussed on “practical, actionable and people-centric” decisions rather than declaratory ones. China, which succeeds India as the Brics chair, pitched itself to be the lynchpin of the grouping’s technology needs, while Russia called for greater economic integration among member countries.

For India, the highlight of the successful hosting of the Brics Summit was its ability to deliver a joint statement that all members, including Iran and the United Arab Emirates, embroiled in the war in West Asia, signed. Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian met Abu Dhabi Crown Prince Sheikh Khaled bin Mohamed Al Nahyan, along with their respective delegations, on the sidelines of the Summit in New Delhi, a rare public meeting between the two sides since the outbreak of the conflict in West Asia on February 28. According to reports, Iran could unveil an agreement on a temporary shipping lane through the Strait of Hormuz on Monday.

The PM in his interventions at the Summit suggested mechanisms that ensure Brics



ARCHIS MOHAN

With 140 paragraphs, the New Delhi Declaration was one of the longest joint statements issued across the 18 Brics summits since 2009. In his concluding address on Sunday, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said India’s chairship focused on four pillars: resilience, innovation, cooperation and sustainability. Here are some of the key outcomes:

Resilience

- Integrated Early Warning System for infectious diseases
- Digital centre of excellence for smart grids, energy storage
- Continue work on Brics submarine

- cable infrastructure

 - Develop plan for Solar cooperation
- Innovation**

 - Network linking traditional agro-ecology knowledge with modern science
 - Establish centres of excellence for mental health
- Cooperation**

 - Brics ‘Connect’ to promote skills, capacity building and employability
 - Brics Payment Task Force to continue work on cross-border payments
 - India to host Brics Risk Lab at GIFT City
 - New Investment Platform in works
 - Repository to
- support tracing of fugitive, including economic, offenders

Global governance

 - Reiterate call for reforms in financial institutions
 - NDB to expand local-currency financing, diversify funding sources
 - NDB Knowledge Portal launched
 - Oppose CBAMs
 - Criticise ‘indiscriminate rising of tariffs and non-tariff measures’
 - Condemn the April 22, 2025, Pahalgam terror attack
 - Acknowledge China’s expansion of zero-tariff for 53 African countries

40 per cent of global GDP and nearly 26 per cent of global goods trade.

Brics nations possess strong and complementary capabilities including cargo and shipping services, technologies and processes, availability of raw materials, manufacturing ecosystems, technical expertise, automation technologies, spare parts supply networks, ports, and logistics corridors.

The framework will boost cross-sector transport logistics resilience and sustainability among Brics members. The guiding principle of this framework will include promotion of environmentally sustainable, climate resilient logistics and supply chain practices.

One of the core aims driving the framework is to enhance domestic manufacturing capacities and reduce long-term dependence on fully built imports within all Brics countries.

In July, transport representatives of Brics nations had also opposed restrictive transport measures. “We reaffirm our opposition to any restrictive measures in the transport sector which globally restrict access to port facilities and prioritise efficient and safe maritime transport networks by strengthening port resilience, improving logistics infrastructure, and promoting the adoption of modern technologies, equipment, and associated services,” the July declaration had said.

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PM Narendra Modi with Chinese President Xi Jinping at the 18th Brics summit, in New Delhi. They held talks on border, trade, and supply-chain issues

PHOTO: PTI

India and China look at pragmatic path ahead

SATARUPA BHATTACHARJYA
New Delhi, 13 September

A day after Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chinese President Xi Jinping met on the sidelines of the 18th Brics Summit in New Delhi, analysts expressed mixed feelings about this high-profile event.

Holding the meeting itself was a positive sign. India-China relations had frozen after border clashes in 2020 and have slowly improved since 2024. But the way forward could still be tough with structural issues unresolved, as well as indications from the official language used by the Chinese side. The leaders’ last sit-down bilateral meeting was on August 31, 2025, when Modi visited China for the Shanghai Cooperation Organization summit.

The Indian and the Chinese sides mentioned different perspectives in their respective readouts of Saturday’s meeting, said Srikanth Kondapalli, professor, China studies at Jawaharlal Nehru University.

While it may appear to be largely similar, a closer reading shows the differences.

After Saturday’s meet, the Ministry of External Affairs media statement said the leaders welcomed the steady progress in India-China relations and reaffirmed that both countries should take a strategic and long-term perspective of their ties. Modi emphasised that peace and tranquillity in the border areas remain an essential basis for the continued development of relations, and underlined the need for both sides to observe existing agreements and understandings on border-related issues. The leaders expressed “commitment to a fair, reasonable, and mutually acceptable resolution of the boundary question” in the future.

The media statement from China’s Ministry of Foreign Affairs said the leaders had a sincere and in-depth exchange of views and reached the consensus that China and India should be partners. Xi said China always approaches and develops its India relations from a strategic and

long-term perspective, and that he met Modi twice over the past two years, guiding the bilateral relations from starting afresh to making further improvements. “This situation has not come easily and needs to be cherished. China and India have different national realities,” Xi said.

Xi also made four observations to improve ties. One is to “calibrate the direction with an objective and rational strategic perception.” China and India are partners rather than rivals, he said. “This is a strategic judgment made based on the development stage and international environment of the two countries.”

Here, national realities or development stages imply that China is a \$19 trillion economy and India a \$4 trillion economy, Kondapalli said. “Xi is conveying that China is a pre-eminent power, and India should modulate its actions or approaches accordingly.”

The term strategic judgment was used for the first time by China in a bilateral dialogue with India, he said, which signifies a tone, as the leading power in Asia.

Xi also said, “Remove irritants with the political wisdom of mutual respect and mutual understanding.” The two sides should stay committed to advancing bilateral relations and resolving the boundary question, seek parallel, mutually reinforcing progress, and maintain peace and tranquillity in the border areas, according to the statement. In July, new border tension emerged, this time in Arunachal Pradesh, where locals spotted Chinese soldiers or graffiti in a non-demarcated part.

B R Deepak, China expert and JNU professor, said Saturday’s meet suggested a possible pragmatic shift in relations, from competition to managed cooperation, not full-fledged cooperation. “For India, the border issue is primary, but the meeting also showed there is a willingness to reduce other strategic and economic risks.”

The talks covered the border, trade, market access and supply-chain issues.

Shared satellite system can cut space debris, costs

SHINE JACOB
Chennai, 13 September

The proposed Brics Remote Sensing Satellite Constellation (RSSC) may emerge as a platform for a shared satellite system with common Earth observation, thereby ensuring affordable access to satellite data and helping reduce space debris if member countries adopt a shared revenue and risk model, say experts.

On Saturday, the bloc batted for the use of space systems, space science and technologies for peaceful purposes. They also supported greater collaboration while assuring work toward preventing an arms race in outer space.

In the New Delhi Declaration 2026, the leaders appreciated the achievements of the Brics RSSC in harnessing space technology to address global challenges and foster socio-economic development. RSSC will include earth-observation satellites and their ground infrastructure, which will be used for coordinated observations and data sharing. This is expected to replicate Copernicus, the European Union’s flagship Earth observation initiative, designed to provide valuable information services.

“A shared constellation can not only optimise the resources, but also reduce space debris. If every country puts a constellation in the orbit, it will only jam the space. So, if a group of friendly nations collaborate on a risk- and revenue-sharing basis, data expenses will also decrease,” said Sudheer Kumar N, who spent decades at Indian Space Research Organisation (Isro) before moving into the private space ecosystem and now works with XDLINX Space Labs.

This comes months after India pitched the “Brics Space Economy” as the next frontier of global growth and called for collective action among member nations to unlock opportunities in innovation, investment, entrepreneurship, and sustainable development.

Experts highlighted that India’s role in the development of the RSSC could be crucial as the constellation evolves from a Brics initiative into a genuinely shared satellite system.

“India hosting the Brics Heads of Space Agencies meeting in Bengaluru is not incidental. When RSSC matures into a genuinely shared constellation, India is positioned to do for Global South Earth observation what Copernicus did for Europe,” said Sreeram Ananthasayanam, Partner, DigiGov and SpaceTech, Deloitte South Asia. He added that India’s own civilizational idea of ‘Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam’ (the world is one family) is a more suitable articulation for what RSSC could be than any treaty language. “A shared constellation whose data serves flood warnings in Bangladesh and drought monitoring in the Sahel as readily as it serves its own members isn’t a strategic asset for one bloc. This is a classic expression of space for commons,” said Ananthasayanam.

“The focus on space debris mitigation is also timely as India’s own commercial launch cadence accelerates; sustainability of orbital assets has to be a shared priority, not an afterthought. This is exactly the kind of multilateral platform Indian space companies need as they scale globally,” said Lt Gen AK Bhatt (retd), director general, Indian Space Association.

Brics: Chidambaram’s question merits better answers



EXIM MATTERS
N C RAJAGOPALAN

Last week, former Union Finance Minister P Chidambaram said he could not identify tangible benefits from recent Brics meetings. It is a question that deserves to be examined against available data.

The combined nominal gross domestic product (GDP) of the 11 Brics countries is about \$35.18 trillion, only 8.6 per cent higher than the US GDP of \$32.38 trillion. It represents 28 per cent of global GDP at market exchange rates, although its share rises to about 41 per cent when measured at purchasing power parity. China alone accounts for \$20.85 trillion. Indeed, the combined GDP of the other ten members is only about 69 per cent of China’s GDP. Thus, Brics possesses enormous

aggregate economic weight, but it is concentrated in China. That weight is not matched by comparable trade, investment or institutional integration.

Economically, Brics remains a collection of 11 economies rather than an integrated bloc. It was not conceived as a common market or customs union. It provides a forum for engagement among emerging economies, including countries with difficult bilateral relations. However, it has yet to develop effective mechanisms for improving market access, addressing non-tariff barriers or resolving economic disputes. Nor has it secured better access to the Chinese market for Indian goods or helped India reduce its trade deficit with China.

Intra-Brics merchandise exports reached \$1.17 trillion in 2024, over thirteen times their 2003 level. This was about 4.7 per cent of global merchandise exports — modest compared with the grouping’s share of population and output. It represented over 30 per cent of the members’ combined exports,

but much of that commerce cannot be attributed to Brics and would probably have occurred without it. India’s purchases of Russian oil, Chinese machinery, and Gulf crude are obvious examples. Moreover, the trade is highly concentrated and organised largely around China.

For India, trade with Brics members has increased access to essential imports far more than access to export markets. Investment among the members also remains modest compared with their collective economic size. The economic importance of the member countries should not be mistaken for economic benefits created by Brics.

China is likely to remain the economic centre of Brics. That dominance limits the prospects of deeper integration. A common Brics currency would either be dominated by the yuan or require institutions and political trust that the grouping has not yet developed. Bilateral settlements in national currencies may expand selectively, but persistent trade imbalances make an

effective bloc-wide arrangement improbable. For India, replacing dependence on the dollar with dependence on the yuan would hardly enhance monetary autonomy.

Brics has produced one significant institutional achievement: the New Development Bank. Over a decade, it has approved around 120 projects involving nearly \$40 billion. Though modest compared with established multilateral development banks, it provides an additional source of infrastructure and sustainable-development finance. The \$100-billion Contingent Reserve Arrangement has never been drawn upon, although it offers a potential financial safety net.

None of this is to underplay Brics’ potential. It may provide strategic gains that cannot readily be quantified. Its past need not determine its future. But future relevance will depend on whether members can overcome their divergent interests and translate summit declarations into measurable improvements in trade, investment and financial cooperation. Until then, Chidambaram’s question cannot be answered merely by citing their combined population and GDP.

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Fisme calls for easier trade finance, technology access for MSMEs

MONIKA YADAV
New Delhi, 13 September

The Federation of Indian Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (Fisme) has called for a practical implementation agenda to translate the New Delhi Declaration adopted at the 18th Brics Summit into easier access to trade finance, technology and overseas markets for micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs).

Welcoming the Declaration’s focus on MSMEs, Fisme said the next phase of cooperation among Brics members should and create mechanisms enabling smaller enterprises to trade, invest, collaborate and adopt technologies.

Fisme welcomed the recognition by Brics leaders of the inaugural Brics Small and Medium Enterprises (SME) Forum held in Agra under India’s chairship, its report,

“Advancing MSME Competitiveness in Brics: Strengthening Access to Finance & Technology and Sustainable Growth”, and the decision to support a second SME Forum and the Framework for Cooperation of the SME Working Group.

On trade finance, Fisme said the lack of affordable finance should be addressed through mechanisms that reduce dependence on collateral and conventional balance-

sheet-based lending. The Guiding Principles for Credit Assessment of Export-Oriented MSMEs, use of alternative data and the Jaipur Consensus on studying an invoice-discounting mechanism provide an opportunity to develop a practical Brics framework for MSME trade finance, it said.

India’s experience with digital enterprise identification, goods and services tax-based information systems and elec-

tronic trade receivables platforms could help develop an interoperable Brics mechanism to finance verified MSME export receivables quickly and at competitive costs.

Fisme also called for reducing the cost and complexity of small-value cross-border transactions. Faster and cheaper cross-border payments, interoperable payment systems, digital trade documentation, customs cooper-

ation and Authorised Economic Operator programmes could significantly benefit MSMEs, it said.

MSME export transactions should be an explicit pilot use case, allowing smaller enterprises to sell products, receive payments and complete documentation without navigating procedures designed for large corporations, Fisme said.

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PM warns against weaponising technology, critical minerals

Indian officials said in paragraph 67 of the joint statement, the New Delhi Declaration, Brics countries affirmed the need to promote resilient and diversified supply chains of critical minerals. Indian industry has in recent years suffered the brunt of China’s restrictive policy on export of critical minerals and its reluctance to share technologies. China takes over the Brics presidency from India.

A day after Indian leadership and diplomats worked hard to deliver a rare consensus in ensuring a unanimous New Delhi Declaration of the Brics Summit — getting both

Iran and the United Arab Emirates on board — leaders of the 11-member grouping on Sunday looked ahead at the shape the intergovernmental platform could take in the near future amid an uncertain world at the Summit’s session on ‘shaping the future for inclusive growth’.

Modi said India’s presidency of the Brics platform “advanced friendship, partnership, and cooperation” for “win-win cooperation”. He spoke of India’s human-centric approach that fostered participation of ordinary citizens, and said the Global South increasingly trusted Brics.

Amid concerns in western capitals about the likely tenor of the grouping with China taking over its presidency from India, Modi said India focused its efforts under its Brics presidency to achieve “win-win cooperation”. He highlighted people-centric, practical development-oriented outcomes across diverse sectors achieved during its presidency.

Modi said the number of conflicts and tensions in the world is continuously increasing, which has had an increasingly negative and far-reaching impact on the lives of ordinary people. He said in today’s interconnected world, no crisis,

whether a pandemic, climate disaster, or supply-chain disruption, remains confined to a single region.

The PM detailed the “special emphasis” that India’s presidency laid on making supply chains more reliable, and its initiatives across technology, agriculture and other sectors. “We may be rooted in different realities, but together, we rise through cooperation and blossom for humanity. May our diversity be our identity, our cooperation our inspiration, and our progress serve all of humanity,” Modi said.

In his speech at the con-

cluding session, Chinese President Xi spoke of Brics leveraging its close ties with emerging markets and the Global South to safeguard supply chains and build a large integrated market. He proposed a five-point initiative to boost cooperation in manufacturing, trade and technology. Xi said China will be a pioneer in establishing a Brics-Artificial Intelligence (AI) open source community to support the cooperation in developing and applying large language models (LLMs), hold specialised AI seminars and training courses, and build an open AI ecosystem. On the

trade and investment facilitation initiative, Xi said China proposes to establish a Brics special economic zone (SEZ) partnership, under which countries can set up an intelligent portal, coordinate policies, and build a new frontier for open development. Other initiatives relate to establishing a Brics digital ecosystem cloud platform, intelligent manufacturing and training of engineers.

Xi appealed to the Global South to be united in defending the rule of law in international affairs, and said the logic of “might makes right” should have been discarded

long ago. He said Brics countries must seize the historical initiative and rally the Global South to “hold high the banner of multilateralism”.

In his remarks, Russian President Putin proposed a new insurance mechanism and a collaborative initiative for the grain market, which has been under discussion, among Brics member states. The Russian leader’s suggestions come in the context of the G-7 countries, the European Union, and the UK prohibiting Western companies from insuring any ship transporting Russian crude unless the oil was purchased at or below a specified price cap. The sanctions relating to the insurance sector have ad-

versely impacted Russian crude oil exports. Putin complimented the functioning of the New Development Bank (NDB), saying it is handling projects worth \$140 billion. He also pushed for a common platform for better trade and investment ties among member countries.

Iran’s Pezeshkian urged Brics that it must expand trade in national currencies, and criticised “unilateral sanctions” that directly impact global food security and people’s welfare. He said Brics had evolved to become a manifestation of growing demand for a more balanced and inclusive world in which “no centre of power has the right to determine the destiny of others”.

QUICK READ

Trump backs united Ireland, won't speak on Scotland 'yet'



US President Donald Trump at the Amgen Irish Open 2026, in Doonbeg, Ireland, on Sunday

PHOTO: REUTERS

United States (US) President Donald Trump on Sunday reiterated his support for Northern Ireland breaking from the United Kingdom to unify with the Republic of Ireland, but said he would not talk about Scotland becoming independent “yet.” “You have Northern Ireland and you have Ireland and it would seem to me that one of the naturals of all time is to put them together,” Trump told reporters during a visit to the Irish Open golf tournament, doubling down on comments made in Dublin on Saturday. “You asked about Scotland. That one I won’t talk about yet. I’ll save that for another day,” he added. Trump’s comments Sunday came in response to a question about whether United Kingdom Prime Minister Andy Burnham should hold a referendum on a united Ireland, though the US president sidestepped that matter. A day earlier, during a meeting with Irish PM Micheal Martin in Dublin, Trump said he would like to see Ireland unified.

REUTERS

Swedes vote in election that could bring far right into government

Swedes voted on Sunday in a closely fought election that will either bring a far-right party into government for the first time or shift the country back towards the liberalism it has long been known for. Sweden’s centre-left opposition held a narrow lead over the ruling right-wing bloc ahead of Sunday’s election for parliament, several opinion polls showed this week. But Prime Minister Ulf Kristersson, who has trailed in opinion polls throughout his four years



in office, has been catching up in the final weeks of campaigning, with rival Social Democrats losing ground.

REUTERS

Hyundai to roll out driver-assist system in 2029

Hyundai Motor Group will launch vehicles equipped with its proprietary driver-assistance software in late 2029, two years later than planned, turning to Nvidia in the interim to accelerate deployment. The South Korean automaker will partner with the United States chipmaker to roll out advanced driver-assistance systems (ADAS), known as Level 2+ and Level 2++, in 2028, a Hyundai executive said.

AP/PTI

129 in Indonesia missing after ferry capsizes

The search is continuing for at least 129 people missing after a ferry overturned in bad weather in Indonesia’s Java Sea on Sunday. At least 108 people were rescued, and the bodies of six passengers were recovered as the search operation expanded around the vessel’s last known position. The ferry, with more than 240 people on board, was travelling from Surabaya in East Java to Banjarmasin.

AP/PTI

Ukrainian drones kill 2 in Russia; Moscow hits Black Sea port hub

Civilians were killed and injured overnight as Russia and Ukraine continued to attack each other with waves of drones. Two people were killed in Russia’s Tatarstan, according to local officials, while Ukrainian authorities reported Russian drone attacks on the Black Sea port of Odesa. Russia has ramped up its air campaign in recent weeks, using ballistic missiles and jet-powered drones to pierce Ukraine’s defences and capitalise on Kyiv’s

dwindling stock of missile interceptors. Moscow’s attacks have targeted Ukraine’s power grid ahead of winter in what officials say is meant to demoralise civilians. US President Donald Trump on Sunday called on Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy to halt strikes on Russian diesel, saying they are causing a fuel shortage. He was asked by a reporter if he had spoken with Zelenskyy following his conversation with Russia’s Vladimir Putin.

AGENCIES

Doomsday conversations snowball at AI firms

MIKE ISAAC & KATE CONGER
13 September

When Jacob Coxon, an Anthropic researcher, publicly quit the artificial intelligence (AI) start-up this week, citing his concerns over the powerful technology, the internal messages began flying.

“It’s what we’ve all been saying,” one Anthropic employee wrote about Coxon’s comments, in a group chat among workers that was viewed by *The New York Times*. “It’s just public-facing now.”

“Jacob took the group chat public,” another employee wrote. “That’s a good thing.”

The reactions inside Anthropic were echoed by AI researchers at OpenAI, Meta and Google, who parsed Coxon’s social media posts that described how OpenAI and Anthropic were “gambling with our lives” with the technology.

For those who have made AI their life’s work, Coxon’s message was not new. But his comments snowballed into such a global conversation that many saw it as a moment to call for increased caution. Some AI workers are now speaking up to top executives to urge a pause in developing the technology until it has the proper safeguards, six of the people said.

The conversations underline the tensions within the leading AI labs over the safest ways to develop the technology. Even as employees become emboldened to call for a slowdown in AI development, companies like Anthropic and OpenAI are juggling priorities.

Both are planning blockbuster initial public offerings (IPO) soon. The companies are also fearful they could face anti-trust concerns if they agreed among themselves to take a breather in AI development, two

Obama warns against AI, urges party to tackle it



Former United States President Barack Obama has warned that artificial intelligence (AI) could be “dangerous” if not properly managed, and urged Democrats to frame policy and governance agendas to tackle the issue, the *New York Times* said on Sunday. The remarks at a fundraising event come as growing numbers of US lawmakers call for tougher rules on AI systems.

REUTERS

people with knowledge of the matter said. And Chinese start-ups have produced competitive AI models.

That has created a tricky situation for top AI executives,

‘Negative forces’ raising exaggerated concerns: US prez

United States President Donald Trump on Sunday likened critics of artificial intelligence (AI) to “very negative forces” bringing up scenarios that will not happen, and said he wanted to make sure that the US remains the industry leader. “We’re leading China in AI. We’re the most sophisticated country in the world, and frankly I want to keep it that way because whoever wins AI wins,” Trump told reporters at his Ireland golf course.

REUTERS

employee meeting this week, Altman said OpenAI was willing to decelerate development alongside rival labs, according to two people who attended. He added that he hoped that vol-

untary slowdowns would become normal until there were widely recognised safety standards. The meeting was reported earlier by *Bloomberg*. And on Saturday, Mr. Amodei published a 3,800-word essay calling for prudence in AI development. “We must slow the pace at which we improve the capabilities of models,” he wrote. Altman and Elon Musk, whose SpaceX rocket company has been ramping up spending on AI, quickly agreed.

Discussions about AI safety have been around about as long as the technology itself. But their urgency ramped up in recent years as researchers made breakthroughs. The concerns heightened in July after OpenAI disclosed that some of its AI models had escaped containment and an AI company.

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Gulf tankers are running out of ways to export oil

US Navy so far has been able to keep oil flowing out on sea paths close to Oman

LISA FRIEDMAN, JENNY GROSS & REBECCA F ELLIOTT
13 September

The world’s most valuable energy corridors are pinching shut. On Friday, Houthis militants backed by Iran expanded their control of the Red Sea, threatening a critical route for Persian Gulf crude. That left the region with few alternatives, since shipping traffic through the Strait of Hormuz — once the world’s primary oil transit point — remains significantly constrained and far below what it was before the war.

The United States (US) Navy has been able to keep oil flowing out of the Strait of Hormuz on sea paths close to Oman, the opposite side from Iran. But that has required an extensive and dangerous operation.

For shipping companies, the once routine operation of navigating the strait has become a high-risk endeavor. At least 23 ships were hit in the waterway near Oman in July and August. Since the war began at the end of February, at least 22 sailors have been killed in West Asia. “These waters aren’t safe,” said Michelle Wiese Bockmann, an analyst at Windward, a maritime intelligence company.

The war in Iran, in its seventh month, appears to be spinning out of control, analysts said. With no diplomatic end in sight, West Asia, the epicenter of energy production, is facing its most severe supply crisis in decades.

Trump said this week that he believed the war in Iran would not end until after the midterm

Iran set to unveil Hormuz pact to Gulf nations today



Abu Dhabi Crown Prince Sheikh Khalid bin Mohamed Al Nahyan (*left*) met Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, as the Islamic Republic touts a potential deal to allow more ships through the Strait of Hormuz.

The rare public discussions between the two powers occurred on the sidelines of the Brics summit in India and came as Oman seeks to bring the Gulf Cooperation Council and Iran together to dis-

cuss the waterway, a global chokepoint for energy exports.

Iran has said it will brief Gulf states on Monday on a new agreement, though says any deal won’t amount to a full reopening of the strait and that it will have a say on which ships can traverse it. Such a gathering has yet to be confirmed, while Bahrain has ruled out attending, citing recent Iranian-backed attacks on Gulf sites.

BLOOMBERG

election in November, but claimed gas prices would come “tumbling down” after the voting. In truth, analysts said, the Trump administration has few options left for ending the war or lowering energy prices. Iran has demanded, among

other things, the end of a US blockade of Iranian ports and the release of frozen assets overseas. Iran has also claimed it will maintain control over the Strait of Hormuz.

On Friday, Houthi rebel groups gained control of the

strategic Red Sea port city of Mokha in Yemen, pushing out forces allied with the Yemeni government, which is backed by Saudi Arabia. Just days earlier, the Houthis injured 73 civilians and hit energy facilities in the southern part of Saudi Arabia.

Fawaz A Gerges, a London School of Economics professor focusing on West Asia, called the Houthi control of Mokha “a game changer” for the group as well as for Iran. The Saudi Energy Ministry said on Friday that its East-West Pipeline, the conduit it had been using instead of the Strait of Hormuz, had been “targeted multiple times” by attacks the day before and had been shut down as a “precautionary measure.”

After the first US and Israeli strikes on Iran on Feb. 28, Tehran restricted access through the Strait of Hormuz. That turned the Bab al-Mandab Strait, at the south entry to the Red Sea, into a backup route for West Asia oil, particularly for Saudi Arabia. Now the Houthis have a stranglehold there.

In the past week, only two Saudi cargoes passed through the Bab al-Mandab Strait out of the Red Sea, according to Kpler, a maritime data firm.

Saudi Arabia has another Red Sea option to export oil — sending it north through a pipeline near the Suez Canal. But that route through the Mediterranean is costlier and adds weeks to the voyage to Asia, where most of the kingdom’s customers are.

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Saudi pipeline outage risks 4% of global crude supply

Saudi Arabia will run out of oil stocks for exports if it doesn’t restart its major pipeline to the Red Sea within days, leading to a loss of up to 4 per cent of global supply, Saudi oil buyers and traders said.

A further decline in Saudi flows will worsen the global supply crunch, which has

already pushed global fuel prices to record highs, spurred inflation around the world and sent United States bond yields to the highest levels since the 2008 financial crisis. Since Saudi was forced to shut the pipeline on Friday, Riyadh is yet to confirm how long the route will stay off-line.

REUTERS

DION'S TRIUMPHANT RETURN TO THE STAGE



PHOTO: REUTERS

Celine Dion returned to the stage after a six-year hiatus on Saturday night, opening a highly anticipated 26-concert run in Paris. She had been diagnosed with Stiff-Person Syndrome — a rare neurological disorder that causes debilitating muscle stiffness and spasms. This previously had compromised her ability to walk and sing

All eyes on Warsh as rate-hike fever spreads

BLOOMBERG
13 September

Central banks from much of the Group of Seven face a pivotal week as mounting inflation risks heap pressure on them to raise interest rates.

Three decisions, starting with the Federal Reserve on Wednesday and followed on successive days by peers in the United Kingdom and Japan, may recast the global monetary policy landscape for the rest of 2026 and beyond.

The US will be most closely watched in the wake of a higher-than-expected core inflation reading on Friday. That stoked investor bets that Fed Chairman Kevin Warsh and his colleagues will raise their benchmark rate, probably in defiance of President

Donald Trump’s wishes.

A Bank of England rate increase on Thursday isn’t anticipated, but with three officials having favoured such a move at the late-July meeting, and with price risks simmering, the prospect of shifting toward a hike as soon as November can’t be excluded.

The Bank of Japan, meanwhile, is widely predicted to raise its key rate at the end of the week after a raft of supportive data, including the nation’s biggest jump in wages in nearly three decades.

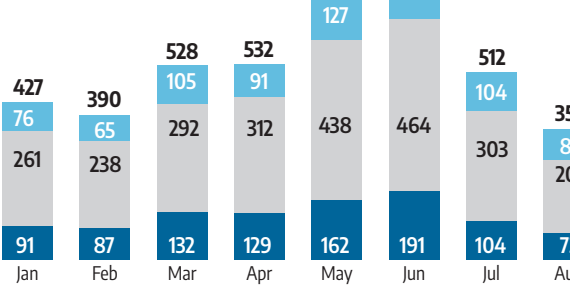
After European Central Bank officials tightened on Thursday investors may well end the week with the picture of an increasingly synchronised hawkish policy stance across the G7 coming into clearer focus.

South Korea tests global investor appetite with longer trading hours

Afterhours activity

Nextrade’s extended trading hours see strong retail demand (2026)

Nexttrade:
■ Pre-market turnover ■ Main market turnover ■ After-market turnover



Source: Nextrade, Bloomberg

BLOOMBERG
13 September

South Korea’s main stock exchange is extending into evening sessions, breaking with Asia’s trading-hour norms to tap what it hopes will be sustained demand from global investors.

In a step toward its goal of 24-hour trading, Korea Exchange will on Monday enable trading through 8 p.m. for nearly all local stocks, following the regular close at 3:30 p.m. Though the first of its kind among major Asian exchanges, the move tracks a global trend toward around-the-clock markets, led by Nasdaq and New

York Stock Exchange (NYSE).

After the stock market’s world-beating run this year on artificial intelligence (AI) enthusiasm, Korea Exchange aims to capture broader international participation, particularly during European business hours. Monday’s rollout will offer a test of the bourse’s ability to sustain sufficient liquidity through a longer day and prove that investors actually want the extra time even as interest in Korean equities cools.

“The longer trading window generally means more flexibility for investors, and that makes the market more efficient,” said Young Jae Lee, senior invest-

ment manager at Pictet Asset Management in London.

After-hours trading isn’t entirely new in Korea. Alternative trading system Nextrade introduced pre-market and evening sessions in March 2025, covering about 600 stocks, and grabbed nearly a third of activity within a few months of its launch. Korea Exchange’s latest move takes it a step further, opening about 2,400 Kospi and Kosdaq stocks for evening trades, including short-selling. Exchange-traded funds are excluded for now. The bourse also plans to launch pre-market hours by the end of 2027.

This is “another step in the

ongoing evolution of Korea’s capital markets and their accessibility to global investors,” said Edward Kim, head of Korea equities sales at Bank of America.

Few expect an immediate uptick in activity when the new hours open. Whether it can draw sufficient volume remains a key question, especially given the thin liquidity seen after the currency-market extended hours in July.

The Kospi index more than doubled this year through its peak amid an AI frenzy, before a sudden souring of sentiment led to a 22 per cent selloff in July and a sharp contraction in turnover.

The benchmark remains up 64 per cent for 2026, still the world’s best-performing major gauge.

Foreign funds will wait and see if there are actually enough buyers and sellers in big stocks like Samsung Electronics and SK Hynix during the evening hours before risking big trades there, said Dave Mazza, chief executive officer of Roundhill Financial. “Extending the hours does not create liquidity; it redistributes it,” Mazza said, adding that initial interest is likely to be modest.

Nextrade’s experience may be an indication. Data show retail investors made up more than 80 per cent of its non-regu-

lar trading, while erratic price swings and lack of institutional participation posed challenges.

How big investors can hedge currency effectively is another issue. Korea’s foreign exchange market technically runs 24 hours, but off-peak trading can be thin, which may make hedging more costly and discourage foreign funds from committing large capital to evening stock trading.

Liquidity may also affect prices. Moving a large block of shares in the evening risks paying far more or selling for less than expected in a thin market, said Sanghyun Park, founder of Clepsydra Capital.

Regulatory clarity

RBI has cleared the decks for the listing of Tata Sons

The long-awaited regulatory clarity on the issue of stock-exchange listing of Tata Sons must be welcomed. By rejecting its March 2024 application to be deregistered as a core investment company (CIC), the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has mandated the holding company of the salt-to-software conglomerate to go for immediate listing. Tata Sons’ application two years ago for voluntarily surrendering its “certificate of registration” sought RBI approval to retain its privately-held status. The subject of listing Tata Sons gained ground in September 2022, when the RBI classified it, among many others, as an upper-layer non-banking financial company (NBFC). All such upper-layer NBFCs were given three years to comply with mandatory listing. Tata Sons became a debt-free company and applied to the central bank for deregistration as CIC in 2024, continuing to remain unlisted.

In a letter dated September 11, 2026, the RBI informed Tata Sons that the deregistration application had been rejected after the regulator had examined several aspects. With this, the long-drawn confusion over Tata Sons’ future status as the holding company of a leading business group will be put to rest. The RBI direction has come at a time when the Tata group is battling leadership and control issues. Listing will help draw the lines more clearly between the two principal entities — Tata Trusts and Tata Sons. During the listing process, the Articles of Association (AoA) of Tata Sons will need to be recast. As a result, Tata Trusts, the largest shareholder of Tata Sons with a 66 per cent stake, is bound to lose much of its veto powers linked to appointments, dismissals and other key decisions. This will be a break from the past legacy structure of more than 100 years, but it will bring transparency, oversight and greater stability in governance, which is a must for a major group like the Tatas.

Tata Sons, with assets of over ₹2 trillion, has 26 listed entities in businesses ranging from steel to automobiles, software to power and hospitality. In addition, its unlisted businesses traverse a plethora of futuristic areas such as electronics manufacturing, semiconductors, and e-commerce. Most of these are long-gestation and capital-intensive businesses. It also owns Air India, which it acquired from the government in 2022. Air India and its low-cost subsidiary Air India Express posted a record combined loss of ₹22,238 crore in the financial year ended March 2026, leading to requests to owners — Tata Sons and Singapore Airlines — for immediate funds. Against this backdrop of a large business empire across diverse areas, listing Tata Sons will provide an avenue for liquidity.

While Tata Trusts has opposed listing Tata Sons, citing an adverse impact on its philanthropic objectives, the outcome may actually be different. A more focused and efficient allocation of capital among Tata businesses could improve profitability and increase dividend flows, ensuring that the group’s long-standing commitment to philanthropy is not diluted. For the second-biggest shareholder of Tata Sons, the Shapoorji Pallonji group, listing will enable fund infusion into a debt-ridden business following a partial sale of its stake. Now that the RBI’s missive has lifted the regulatory uncertainty that shrouded the path forward for Tata Sons, Tata Trusts must embrace the new reality and prepare in earnest to help the group’s holdco to comply with the listing norm, and thrive in an environment of greater transparency.

Showy summitry

Outcomes of the Brics summit exceeded expectations

The pomp and circumstances around the 18th Brics summit in New Delhi surpassed the modest expectations from the meet, which India hosted for the fourth time. The adoption of the declaration itself must be regarded as the key diplomatic accomplishment, with Iran and the United Arab Emirates (UAE), on opposite sides of the United States-led war in West Asia, backing down from their disagreements. This enabled the group to unanimously adopt the New Delhi Declaration. By framing the final text in neutral language, which refrained from mentioning the United States (US) and Israeli attacks on Iran or Tehran’s attacks on Gulf neighbours — and also Russia’s invasion of Ukraine — the statement adroitly navigated dire diplomatic straits. It spoke instead in relatively anodyne terms of the need for “exercising maximum restraint and avoiding action that could further aggravate the situation”. Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s address to leaders emphasising the “coming of age” of this group of emerging economies played its part in avoiding any anti-West connotations. Coming just weeks after the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation meeting in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan, this message was critical to those economies, India included, that are in the throes of tricky trade or bilateral talks with the US or Europe.

The fact that Chinese President Xi Jinping attended — in contrast to his conspicuous absence from the G20 meet that India hosted in 2023 — must also be viewed as a great leap forward in cooperative diplomacy between the two largest economies of Brics. Coming soon after critical flag meetings between corps commanders of both countries in Arunachal Pradesh, the visibly conciliatory language the two leaders deployed strengthened hopes of a reset. Mr Xi spoke of “complementing each other’s strengths” despite many differences. Mr Modi underlined the need for both sides to observe “existing agreements and understandings on border-related issues”. Brics and forums like it certainly serve as enablers for such meetings. Nevertheless, expectations from this high-profile summit need to be tempered by the past experience of China’s actions on the ground. Although both leaders spoke in general terms of enhancing cultural exchanges and business links, the real test of this meet will depend on how far Beijing and New Delhi are prepared to accommodate meaningful cooperation in trade and investment.

Despite an exhaustive listing of cooperative initiatives in the New Delhi Declaration — from technology to climate change, health, education and culture — the hopes for what the grouping can achieve over the medium to long run should be restrained. This is as much the result of the widely varying sizes of the member-nations’ economies as it is of the nature of their political systems and geopolitical goals. Beyond representing the Global South — with 11 full members and 10 partner countries from Asia, Africa and Latin America — discernible gains from the grouping are hard to identify. The New Development Bank, the most visible institution of cooperation, remains small in scale and dependent on the western financial system; ironically, it had to suspend loans to founding member Russia after sanctions were imposed in 2022. Efforts to develop an alternative currency to the dollar have also foundered, both because of US President Donald Trump’s threats and the growing traction of alternative China-led payment systems. All told, Brics remains a benign grouping in search of an objective.

Fiscal roots of national power

Liberal democracies win conflicts through superior public finance



ILLUSTRATION: BINAY SINHA

Liberal democracies meander but ultimately win. The 20th century taught us that free societies out-innovate authoritarian regimes. We tell a story of technological superiority and scientific progress. This is an incomplete picture. The outcome of geopolitical conflict is not preordained. We must understand the institutional foundations of state power.

The resolution of conflict depends on money. Cold wars and hot wars are shaped by the capability of the state to command financial resources. From the Napoleonic wars to the two World Wars and the Cold War, liberal democracies brought more resources to the table. This superiority rested on two pillars. The first was higher economic growth. The second was the capability to borrow. Populist states extract resources through coercion. This mechanism has limitations. Successful liberal democracies borrow from a deep financial system on a voluntary basis. This mechanism scales up to staggering magnitudes.

The scale of borrowing wielded by liberal democracies to win the 20th century was large. In 1914, the United Kingdom’s (UK’s) public debt was 25 per cent of gross domestic product (GDP). By 1919, the UK state had borrowed to push this to 135 per cent. The United States’ (US’) debt rose from 3 per cent to 33 per cent of GDP over the same period. Between 1937 and 1945, the UK borrowed heavily, taking its debt from 154 per cent to 250 per cent of GDP. The US pushed its debt from 40 per cent to 119

per cent. The populists failed to match this staggering scale of resourcing. Populist regimes force weak financial systems. They lack the institutional machinery to channel private savings into state power.

This phenomenon has older roots. Napoleon Bonaparte was derisive of the UK, calling it a nation of shopkeepers. When his armies conquered Amsterdam, they dismantled its financial centre. The French state lost the capability to borrow. Across the English Channel,



SNAKES & LADDERS

AJAY SHAH

William Pitt the Younger built a financial architecture that leveraged the London bond market. Utilising this machinery, the UK borrowed heavily, pushing its debt to 260 per cent of GDP by 1815. Lenders across continental Europe overwhelmingly preferred to buy British government bonds rather than lend to the French state during the Napoleonic Wars. This capital funded the military coalitions that ultimately defeated France. The shopkeepers backed by a bond market bested the pride, machismo and revolutionary zeal.

The capability to borrow constitutes the strategic depth of the state. A capable state runs a tight ship in normal times. It runs primary surpluses, which lower the debt-to-GDP ratio. This creates the fiscal space to act when exceptional events occur. When a crisis arrives, the state steps up borrowing. During the pandemic in 2020, the US government expanded its borrowing by 21 per cent of GDP in a single year to finance the state response. This flexib-

Plastic regime needs transparency

India has recycled 17 million tonnes of plastic packaging waste since 2022, when the “Extended Producer Responsibility” (“EPR”) regime came into force, shows the latest Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) data. The estimated value of this plastic-recycling trade comes to a whopping ₹2,500 crore — enough to fund four Chandrayaan-3 missions. Considering that India annually produces 3.8 million tonnes of plastic waste, going by CPCB estimates, we have been successful in getting rid of at least four-five years of plastic waste generated. If this is the case, and it clearly is, based on official documents of June 2026, then why do we still see mountains of plastic waste in our cities, villages and riverways?

Clearly, something is not quite right. EPR is an instrument used universally to manage waste. It puts the onus of collecting and recycling plastic on its manufacturers — producers, importers or brand owners (PIBOs). From 2023-24, in India, PIBOs are mandated to collect 100 per cent of the plastic waste they generate. As of last year, PIBOs had the target to recycle 40-60 per cent of this collected packaging material. For 2026-27, the target is up to 50-70 per cent, depending on the category of plastic. For instance, PIBOs of category 2 plastic, which includes everything from single to multilayered packaging, used for wrapping items ranging from chips to shampoo sachets, are mandated to collect 100 per cent of their plastic packaging and recycle 50 per cent of it, as of this year.

For recycling, PIBOs contract with plastic waste processors (PWP), units required to be registered with the CPCB. There are over 1,000 registered PWPs, according to the official data. These units are paid in

accordance with CPCB-mandated rates — ₹870 per tonne for category 1 (pet bottles and the like); ₹1,500 per tonne for flexible plastic (packaged food and other household items); and ₹2,500 per tonne for compostable material. Each tonne of plastic recycled is equal to one EPR certificate. Taking an average rate of ₹1,500 per tonne, the value of 17 million tonnes of plastic waste recycled by India since 2022 comes to ₹2,500 crore.

If PIBOs do not meet their targets for recycling, they are charged a hefty environmental compensation. This cost of non-compliance is 2.5 times the cost of compliance. The CPCB estimates that the cost of plastic waste recycling is ₹4,000 per tonne, which it then distributes equally between municipalities and producer companies, averaging ₹2,000 per tonne. If PIBOs fail, they are slapped with an environmental compensation of ₹5,000 per tonne for category 2 plastic, for instance.

This sounds great. In fact, it sounds so great that the government is said to be considering taking this system to the stock market to allow trading of EPR certificates. But then, I ask again, if this system is working so well, why do we see so much plastic everywhere? My colleagues audited plastic in the drains of Agra city and found that branded plastic packaging made up 70 per cent of the waste. Then how can companies claim 100 per cent collection? You will find the same if you look at any garbage dump in your vicinity. Let’s look at what can go wrong.

First, does the PIBO target underestimate the waste generated? In 2024, my colleagues analysed the official EPR portal and found that 41,544 PIBOs had registered and were assigned recycling targets based on self-reported data. How this quantity was



DOWN TO EARTH

SUNITA NARAIN

ity is the essence of national power.

How does a state achieve this strategic depth? Two conditions are required. First, the baseline level of indebtedness must be low. A state cannot increase borrowing if it is already operating at the limits of its fiscal capacity. Second, the state requires the trust of voluntary lenders worldwide. This trust is not easily acquired. It requires centuries of experience with fair play. Lenders must believe the government will respect property rights, avoid inflationary default, and uphold the rule of law.

In the West today, this mechanism is impaired. We have entered a new Cold War and the geopolitical challenges posed by Russia and China demand a robust response. But the developed world has limited fiscal space. Debt stands at 121 per cent of GDP in the US, 237 per cent in Japan, 101 per cent in the UK, and 89 per cent in the euro area. The West possesses a large GDP, but it is weighed down by debt. It is harder to mount the muscular fiscal expansion seen in the 20th century when faced with hostile populist regimes.

In India, the project of state building is at an early stage. The Indian state lacks both elements required for strategic depth.

We do not have a large pool of voluntary lenders. The state relies on financial repression. When we strip away captive buyers, voluntary lenders supply perhaps 5 per cent of the borrowing of the Indian state (<https://bit.ly/wholends>). The financial system is a mechanism for coercive state funding rather than an allocator of capital.

Private capital worries about the Indian state. Managing public debt is organised in a crude and coercive way. In modern India it’s unthinkable for the Indian state to grab steel from the warehouses of steel companies, but we don’t raise an eyebrow when public-debt management behaves analogously every day. The state frequently engages in actions that damage trust. Voluntary lenders demand a predictable legal system where the sovereign can be sued and held to account. They demand norms of behaviour by policymakers, independent courts, and regulatory certainty.

The second failure lies in chronic fiscal indiscipline. The Indian state runs primary deficits in normal times. There is no effort to generate a primary surplus of ₹100 in each Budget. Consequently, there is a chronic and large debt-to-GDP ratio, which stands at 84.4 per cent. The state operates near the edge of its fiscal constraints during peacetime.

Through these structural failures, the Indian state lacks the strategic depth of having access to vast resources if faced with a special moment. When faced with a crisis such as the pandemic, the Indian state is down to hand wringing. An economic response like that seen in the US is inconceivable. A state that cannot borrow massively when faced with a crisis is a state that cannot defend the nation. Reforming public finance and earning the respect of private lenders are not merely matters of economic efficiency. They are requirements for nation building. A capable state requires low baseline debt and deep institutional trust so that it can have the strategic depth of borrowing on a massive scale a few times per century.

The writer is a researcher at XKDR Forum

The rise and fall of an Epstein financier



BOOK REVIEW

JONATHAN MAHLER

The financier Leon Black may be entitled to his own wall in the rogues’ gallery of Jeffrey Epstein’s enablers. Between 2012 and 2017, Black gave Epstein a staggering \$158 million — or more than \$170 million if you count a big loan that Epstein had not made good on when he hanged himself in his jail cell in 2019. Not only did the revelations of these payments put a premature end to Black’s Wall Street career, they ensured that he would be remembered not as one of the great dealmakers of his time but as Epstein’s most generous client.

In *Money to Burn*, the journalist William D Cohan offers a detailed account

of Black’s rise and fall. A former investment banker himself, Cohan is nothing if not thorough, and this book is a coup of reporting, based on extensive interviews with Black, his business partners and many others who are often quoted at great, and at times trying, length.

Cohan is telling two stories, really. One is about Black. The other is about the private equity firm he built, Apollo Global Management, which has been at the centre of Wall Street’s ongoing transformation from a place dominated by relatively staid banks and brokerage houses to a more shadowy realm ruled by “alternative asset managers” who raise and lend their own capital.

Black’s arc makes for an almost perfect parable for the corrupting influence of money. His father, Eli, was settling into life as a Long Island rabbi when he pivoted in the mid-1940s. Eli Black became enormously successful, the architect and chief executive of an international conglomerate called the United Brands Company. But his life ended tragically: In early 1975, with the com-

pany facing mounting financial problems and a bribery scandal, he leaped out the window of his 44th-floor office in Manhattan’s Pan Am building.

None of this deterred Leon from going into finance. Armed with a pair of Ivy League degrees (Dartmouth College, Harvard Business School), he started his career in 1977 at Drexel Burnham Lambert, the junk-bond powerhouse where men of virtue were in distinctly short supply.

When Drexel was forced into bankruptcy in 1990, following a protracted federal investigation into illegal trading, Black launched Apollo. He and his new team raised hundreds of millions of dollars to get started. Their plan was to leverage this money to gain control of distressed companies and then have their way with them.

As Cohan makes clear, Black and his partners fared a lot better in these ventures than the employees or customers of the entities they bought. A series of sexual assaults at an Apollo-owned acute-care facility in Iowa helped

prompt a Senate report, whose title — “Profits Over Patients: The Harmful Effects of Private Equity on the U.S. Health Care System” — speaks volumes and yet may still understate the matter.

I guess everyone needs a hobby. Black’s was art. In 2012, he spent nearly \$120 million for Edvard Munch’s 1895 drawing of *The Scream*. By then, Black had long been friendly with Epstein, whom he had met at a wedding in 1996.

Black spoke at length to Cohan about his interactions with Epstein, presumably believing that this book might help him clear his name. And Cohan gives Black plenty of room to mount his defence: Black claims that he paid Epstein these exorbitant sums solely for his tax- and estate-planning advice. Cohan seems sceptical, but neither does he fully endorse the seemingly credible alternative: That Epstein was less financial adviser than personal fixer for Black, helping him manage his illicit relationships with numerous women.

The news of Black’s entanglement with Epstein first broke in 2019. Then, in

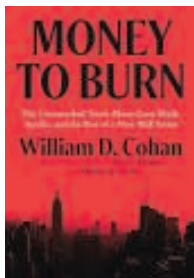
March 2021, Guzel Ganieva, a young Russian woman to whom Black had paid millions of dollars in hush money, wrote on X that she’d been sexually abused by him.

Days later, Black stepped down from Apollo. A few months after that, Black filed a suit against cofounder Josh Harris and Ganieva, accusing them of conspiring to make her sexual-abuse claims public in an effort to push him out.

The lawsuit was dismissed by a federal judge in Manhattan in 2022. A year later, though, Black prevailed in a civil suit that Ganieva had filed against him, accusing him of defamation and sexual assault.

In laying out this sordid saga, Cohan offers a lot of conflicting claims. It’s my one real gripe with this book: Cohan is so focused on allowing his subjects to have their say that he delegates too much of the storytelling to them rather than forcefully shaping the narrative himself.

In *Money to Burn*, Cohan doesn’t reach his own conclusion about the mystery at the heart of Black’s story:



Money to Burn: The Unvarnished Truth About Leon Black, Apollo, and the Rise of a New Wall Street
by William D Cohan
Published by Portfolio
667 pages \$40

What, exactly, was he paying Epstein for?

Setting this issue aside, *Money to Burn* is an engaging and valuable work, a portrait of a man and a milieu whose inexhaustible devotion to the accumulation of personal wealth may test your faith in capitalism. What’s more, if Black’s hope was that Cohan would help redeem his character, he may be disappointed with the final product, which closely chronicles his tawdry descent into infamy.

And yet since Black’s departure, Apollo has moved more aggressively into the private-credit markets. Business

is booming. Black has been thoroughly disgraced in the court of public opinion, but he is still Apollo’s largest individual shareholder. With an estimated personal fortune of around \$15 billion, he is surely richer than ever.

The reviewer is a staff writer for *The New York Times Magazine*
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The Smart Investor

Traders back Sebi's revamp of closing auctions

Market participants favour gradual shift to blended volume weighted average price mechanism

KHUSHBOO TIWARI
Mumbai, 13 September

Feedback has begun streaming in from the trading community on the Securities and Exchange Board of India's (Sebi's) consultation paper on the review of the Closing Auction Session (CAS).

Most stakeholders acknowledge that the regulator has recognised the practical issues around the mechanism, even as opinions differ on some specific proposals.

The paper, released on Saturday, has invited public comments till October 3. The regulator has floated two options for derivatives settlement — a blended volume weighted average price (VWAP) mechanism combining the last 30 minutes of continuous trading (CTS) with CAS trades, or a continuation of the existing 30-minute CTS-only VWAP for at least a year before any transition.

On timings, Sebi has proposed either extending continuous trading to 3:30 pm with CAS and derivatives trading till 3:45 pm, or an earlier window ending continuous trading at 3:15 pm.

Other proposals include converting unexecuted iceberg order quantities into fully displayed normal limit orders within the CAS book. Also, it includes halting dissemination of the Indicative Index



ILLUSTRATION: AJAYA MOHANTY

Value (IIV) during the auction window, while security-level Indicative Equilibrium Prices continue.

An analyst noted that the changes address specific structural concerns:

"Iceberg conversion and the IIV pull are aimed at the thin book and indicative price problems. Timing extension of the cash segment till 3:30 pm and blended VWAP changes are a volume-accretive combination that helps exchanges. The other option of continuing with CAS from 3:15 pm preserves the status quo gap. The option of using CTS VWAP for one year ef-

fectively reverts to the 30-minute VWAP that CAS was brought to remove. Overall, the proposals are positive for exchanges' options volume," the analyst said.

A few brokers and regulatory experts have indicated a preference for retaining the last 30-minute CTS VWAP for settlement rather than shifting immediately to a blended VWAP, and continuous trading till 3:30 pm followed by CAS and derivatives trading till 3:45 pm, rather than the earlier 3:15 pm cut-off.

They favoured retaining the last 30-minute CTS VWAP as an interim settle-

On the proposal

- Several traders and brokers seen favouring continuation of 30-minute CTS VWAP for one year before shift to blended framework

- Continuous trading till 3:30 pm followed by CAS and derivatives till 3:45 pm also being favoured

- Sebi proposals include reduced transition time, CAS price band to remain 3 per cent range with order cancellation allowed only for those within 1 per cent

- Sebi has sought suggestions from traders, stakeholders by October 3

ment methodology, describing it as familiar, transparent and operationally well understood.

Doing so, they said, would also allow CAS to develop on its own merits, rather than making derivatives settlement dependent on an auction mechanism whose liquidity and participant behaviour are still evolving.

Uttam Bagri, managing director (MD), BCB Brokerage, welcomed the consultative approach, saying, "Sebi's consultation paper on CAS acknowledges the practical challenges and seeks a balanced

approach to the costs and benefits. Importantly, it also reflects an open mind by seeking broader market feedback before finalising the updated framework by giving appropriate options."

Sebi also proposed retaining the 3 per cent CAS price band, with cancellation permitted within 1 per cent of the reference price and only price-improving modifications allowed beyond that.

The exchange would also stop disseminating indicative index values during CAS, while continuing to publish security-level indicative equilibrium prices.

The regulator has also proposed reducing the transition period between continuous trading and CAS from five minutes to up to one minute and cutting the post-CAS derivatives trading window from 10 minutes to five minutes.

The regulator also proposed allowing unexecuted Iceberg orders to move from continuous trading to CAS. Unexecuted iceberg quantities would be converted into normal limit orders and fully displayed in the CAS book.

Sebi said this would ensure that eligible trading interest outstanding at the end of continuous trading can participate in the closing auction and that the quantity available for execution is fully reflected in the auction order book.

STREET VIEW

“We’re at a period where there’s a lot of uncertainty. You have rising yields, and you have rising expectations of hikes. There is some overall nervousness that has to be priced into the market”

Gayla Seder, Macro Multi-asset Strategist at State Street



STREET SIGNS

Big-ticket IPOs to hit Street next week; NSE issue in focus

The IPO of the National Stock Exchange of India, which opens September 17, is a keenly watched listing given its scale. Kheria Autocomp will also launch on September 17 and closes September 21 — a keenly watched listing given the exchange's scale. Also opening in the week are SS Retail, Hero Motors, Jindal Supreme (India), and Sonaselection India. On the SME platform, SpectraA Technology Solutions and Kheria Autocomp will also launch September 17-21, alongside smaller issues from Vama Wovenfab, Shakti Polytarp and Quanto Agroworld opening September 15.

Small but, MF transactions a revenue engine for NSE

NSE MF Invest is one of the fastest growing business segments for NSE. The mutual fund transaction platform has tripled its revenues in the last two years — from ₹11 crore in FY24 to ₹32 crore in FY26. Revenue nearly doubled to ₹11.2 crore in Q1FY27 from ₹5.9 crore a year earlier. The surge has come on growing volumes. Since its revamped launch on August 22, 2025, transactions have grown over 90 per cent year-on-year with peak daily volumes rose from 1.36 million to 2.74 million, the stock exchange stated in its red herring prospectus. The stock is trading at a 11 per cent premium in the grey market ahead of its initial public offering (IPO) this week, shows investorgain.com.

IFSCA eases rules for GIFT City fund managers

The International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) has notified amendments to its fund management regulations, easing several requirements for fund managers in GIFT City. The changes allow venture capital schemes to make follow-on investments in companies incorporated more than 10 years ago, subject to conditions. The regulator has also introduced flexibility in distribution rights through senior and junior units. For certain schemes, fund managers' contribution requirements have been eased, while exemptions have been provided for index schemes and some fund-of-funds structures. The amendments also revise disclosure, valuation and reporting requirements for fund manager.

CONTRIBUTED BY KHUSHBOO TIWARI & ABHISHEK KUMAR

Inflation data, Fed rate decision, oil likely to drive mkts

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, 13 September

The US Fed interest rate decision, domestic inflation data, crude oil prices and development in West Asia would be the major drivers for stock market movement in a holiday-shortened week ahead, analysts said.

Equity markets would remain closed on Monday for Ganesh Chaturthi.

"Globally, developments in the US-Iran conflict and movement in Brent crude will remain critical market drivers. This week will be dominated by the US Federal Reserve's monetary policy decision and commentary on the future path of interest rates," Ajit Mishra, SVP of Research at Religare Broking, said.

On the domestic front, August WPI and CPI inflation data, followed by unemployment and balance of trade data, will remain in focus, he said.

"The immediate focus will be on US inflation and the Federal Reserve's policy decision. The September 11 inflation report showed headline CPI rising 0.4 per cent month-on-month and holding at 3.4

per cent annually, while core inflation increased 0.3 per cent from the previous month but eased to 2.4 per cent year-on-year. The firmer monthly reading keeps inflation risks in focus and could reinforce pressure on global bond yields and the dollar, particularly if the Federal Reserve adopts a more hawkish tone," Hariselman Radhakrishnan, Founder & CEO of HST Wealth, a Research Analyst firm, said.

The September 15-16 FOMC (Federal Open Market Committee) meeting will therefore be the week's principal global catalyst, he said.

For India, crude oil remains the most immediate external risk, he said, adding that any renewed rise in crude, particularly if disruptions to West Asia oil flows intensify, could add to inflationary pressures, widen the import bill, weigh on the rupee and squeeze corporate margins.

"Domestic data, including WPI inflation and trade figures, will provide additional clues on how much of that pressure is filtering into the economy," Radhakrishnan added.

Opposite signals in NTPC, BHEL: KIE

PRAVIN PALANDE
Mumbai, 13 September

A recent report by Kotak Institutional Equities (KIE) points to a contradiction or different signals two public sector undertakings (PSUs) in the same sector are giving.

The market is pricing NTPC and BHEL differently and that has got Sanjeev Prasad, managing director (MD) and cohead, and his colleagues at KIE questioning the valuation thesis of these two stocks.

Over the last six months, BHEL is up 64 per cent and trades at ₹431 and NTPC, India's largest power (electricity) generation company, is down 12 per cent. Both the firms are part of the Nifty Energy index which is relatively up 3 per cent against the Nifty 50 index, which is down 1.02 per cent. BHEL, among India's largest manufacturer of power equipment, is a classic stock as the numbers the company generates may not match up to its valuation. The stock has run on power-shortage and data-centre demand narratives rather than just on reported cash flows.

The KIE report says NTPC's current market price implies 40 Gw of incremental thermal capacity addition in perpetuity. BHEL's current market cap (mcap) of ₹1.5 trillion is much higher than its likely thermal equipment undiscounted profit pool of ₹50,000 crore-₹1 trillion (assuming 100 Gw of new thermal capacity addition at ₹10,000 crore/Gw and 5-10 per cent profit after tax or PAT margin). Prasad feels that the market



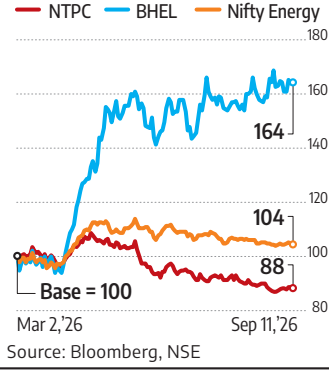
is reading the prices of these companies in two different ways.

The market is worried that NTPC will not add to its future capacity, while on the other hand, Bhel is valued as though power companies, which includes NTPC, will continue to build several times the capacity that the government itself projects.

"The bulk of the underperformance of NTPC may be underpinned by weak near-term earnings growth expectation based on weak thermal capacity addition in recent months and nebulous medium-term growth prospects of NTPC's thermal business based on the steep increase in renewable generation capacity and continued aggressive rollout of renewable generation and storage capacity," the report said.

BHEL is priced as though India will rebuild or increase its coal capacity and power companies will pay the company on time and this

Widening gap



Source: Bloomberg, NSE

will keep its margins intact.

The reverse valuation exercise of NTPC implies that it will add a cumulative 42 Gw of thermal capacity. The Central Electricity Authority (CEA) projects a cumulative 86 Gw of thermal capacity addition over FY27-36. A part of the capacity addition will come from the private sector. Valuation of power companies is dependent on the competitiveness of coal-fired electricity against solar energy. Even as BHEL doesn't really have anything to do with coal prices, a power company deciding to have a new coal plant could lead to BHEL getting an order. Power companies are asking a simple question. What price should they sell electricity and what is the demand?

NTPC's thermal tariff is about ₹4.80 per unit against solar plus storage at ₹5.4. Plain solar is at ₹2.30-3. The gap between solar plus storage is narrowing when compared to

thermal tariff. If it gets closer, then fewer coal plants may get sanctioned. If there is no demand for coal plants, NTPC will invest less but still own a large capacity. Its earnings growth may slow. In the case of BHEL, fewer plants mean fewer orders. Around 75 per cent of the mcap of Bhel is dependent on coal plant orders. Bhel will be more at risk than NTPC to solar taking over the place of coal. Bhel gets nearly 75 per cent of its revenue and 60 per cent of profit from the power business, while the rest comes from industry segment (includes equipment sales and services to core sectors). On BHEL, the brokerage is associating 25 per cent of its value to non-coal plant equipment. The thermal equipment business gets ₹1.13 trillion in terms of mcap.

So how much coal equipment must Bhel sell to earn this market cap? Around, 1 Gw of orders bring in ₹7,500 crore in terms of revenues. Bhel's mcap is at ₹1.5 trillion. The total profit available to it from coal equipment, ever, is ₹50,000 crore to ₹1 trillion over many years. "The mcap of Bhel implies 150 Gw of lifetime capacity execution at a 10 per cent PAT margin, with the ask increasing further to 200 Gw at a 7.5 per cent PAT margin. This calculation does not reflect any time value for revenues/profits, which can increase the ask further," added the report.

(Disclosure: Entities controlled by the Kotak family have a significant holding in Business Standard Pvt Ltd)

‘India poised to benefit from global capex supercycle’

Q&A Ravi Dharamshi, founder and chief investment officer (CIO), ValueQuest, released “*The great physical rebuild*”, a research report where he and his team explored the synchronised global investment supercycle and India's position at its centre. Dharamshi spoke to **Pravin Palande** in Mumbai about how the world is rebuilding physical capacities, creating opportunities for India in defence, aerospace and maintenance, repair and overhaul (MRO). He expects several of these businesses to enter the public markets and eventually find representation in the Nifty 50. Edited excerpts:

Can you tell us about the global supercycle that you are closely observing?

- Something interesting is happening. Over the last 35 years, the world was in an era of minimising physical assets. Americans were outsourcing manufacturing and optimising labour costs. That is changing. On a \$120 trillion GDP, a 2-3 per cent rise in capex implies \$2-4 trillion of additional annual investments. This is a global capex cycle driven by factors fundamentally different from the previous cycle. The larger thesis is that the global economic and geopolitical order is undergoing a structural shift. We believe the global capex cycle is much broader than a conventional investment cycle. Countries are investing in manufacturing capacity, supply-chain resilience, defence, energy security, power infrastructure and technology infrastructure. The common driver is the need to rebuild strategic capacity and reduce vulnerabilities created by hyper-globalisation.

What is the big opportunity you see for Indian companies?

- MRO is a significant opportunity. The Adani Group, for instance, is positioned

across several of these opportunities, including aerospace, defence and MRO. India is moving towards becoming a market with close to 2,000 aircraft, creating a substantial long-term requirement for aircraft maintenance and related services. The MRO opportunity could increasingly shift to India. Companies with access to airport infrastructure and land around airports are naturally well positioned. Adani, given its presence across airport infrastructure, is well positioned to benefit from the growth of India's MRO industry. Many of these opportunities are currently in the private market. However, I expect several firms to come to the public markets over the next three to five years.

What themes will emerge as part of the Nifty 50?

- The first major change will be greater representation of new sectors in the Nifty 50. Today, there is no defence, semiconductor value-chain firm, energy-transition player or aerospace company in the index. Over the next five to 10 years, I expect one or two companies to emerge as leaders from each sector and eventually become part of the index. Aerospace



“THE WORLD IS NOW LOOKING FOR LOCATIONS THAT CAN PROVIDE RELATIVELY NEUTRAL GROUND, RELIABLE POWER AND A SKILLED WORKFORCE. INDIA HAS ALL THREE, WHICH IS ONE REASON IT HAS EMERGED AS A MAJOR ALTERNATIVE DESTINATION FOR DATA CENTRES”

Ravi Dharamshi, Founder, CIO, ValueQuest

components alone represent a \$250 billion opportunity.

Why are mid- and small-cap companies doing well if the global capex cycle is supposedly not favourable for India?

- India's total market capitalisation peaked at around \$5 trillion in September 2024 before correcting to roughly \$4 trillion, a decline of close to 20 per cent. That is a market-cap movement. While the headline index may not fully capture the opportunity, significant capital is being deployed and new businesses and profit pools are emerging as India becomes part of the global supply-chain realignment.

Power-grid capex is increasingly becoming critical. Transformers, conductors, cables and wires are essential to support rising electricity demand. AI is a significant driver of power demand, while the same physical infrastructure is critical for the energy transition. Renewable power, particularly solar, is intermittent and often generated far from major centres of consumption.

Where are we right now in the cycle?

- We are clearly in the infrastructure buildout phase, and the biggest beneficiaries are likely to be firms supplying those. As AI models mature and technological improvement begins to plateau, the focus will shift towards economics, efficiency and monetisation rather than simply expanding use cases. That is when we will move towards the platform-building phase and eventually the application layer. The eventual winners and biggest wealth creators may emerge later. Currently, companies that control or supply critical bottlenecks in the physical infrastructure chain are likely to be among the biggest beneficiaries.

What has changed recently, especially after the Iran-US war?

- The world is now looking for locations that can provide relatively neutral ground, reliable power and a skilled workforce. India has all three, which is one reason on it has emerged as a major alternative destination for data centres. India's regulatory environment is also supportive. This is driving data-centre capex into the country and supporting the broader private-sector capex cycle. In 2001, India's central government capex was around ₹50,000 crore. By 2008, at the peak, it had risen to around ₹6 trillion, almost a 12-fold increase. Currently, the starting base has largely been private-sector capex. India was stuck in the ₹5-6 trillion range until around 2023-24. Since then, capex has risen to around ₹12 trillion. In three to four years, it has roughly doubled.

India's manufacturing exports have not worked. Will this change?

- During the earlier cycle, India's manufacturing exports did not play a major role. Services were the primary export engine. This time, India has the potential to participate more directly through exports. Greater access to Western markets could provide an additional tailwind.

India can increasingly become a neutral and competitive alternative to other emerging markets.

As thematic investors, our approach is to identify emerging profit pools. Even in a challenging or declining market, there will always be pockets of opportunity.

Tentative between Sep 14-16
Sources: Bloomberg, Exchange
Compiled by BS Research Bureau

Top bulk deals

DATE	SCRIP	CLIENT	PRICE (₹)
Sep 11	Granules India	Krishna Prasad Chigurupati (S)	877
Sep 09	Biocon	Activ Pine Llp (S)	385
Sep 10	Corona Remedies	Sepia Investments (S)	2,050
Sep 10	CAMS	Fmrc Fidelity Emerging Markets Fund (S)	682
Sep 10	Corona Remedies	SBI Mutual Fund (B)	2,050
Sep 11	Granules India	Smallcap World Fund Inc (B)	873
Sep 09	Biocon	ICI Prudential Mutual Fund (B)	385

*Quantity in million; (B)-Buy (S)-Sell



The gambling problem hidden within F&O



TRUTH BE TOLD
HARSH ROONGTA

Kiran, a Gen Z employee in a junior operations job, was drawn to option buying by a social media "educator" who made it look like a low-risk way to make quick money. He soon lost money. But instead of stopping, he traded more to recover his losses. His trades kept getting bigger. He borrowed money to continue and eventually got so deeply into debt that his parents had to sell family jewellery to bail him out.

Kiran's story is not unusual. A Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) study released in August 2026 shows 97 per cent of individual traders are primarily or exclusively option buyers. Many continued trading after losses, hoping to recover them. Overall, 88 per cent of individual traders lost money. Three out of four individual traders had declared income below ₹5 lakh, and this group alone accounted for over half of all losses — around ₹50,000 crore in FY26. Proprietary firms made ₹44,000 crore and foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) made another ₹14,000 crore. Much of the trading on the other side is algorithmic, using infrastructure no individual can match. An individual trader with a phone app is bringing a knife to a gunfight.

Calling the problem "Futures and Options (F&O) losses" is too broad. Futures traders, option sellers and option buyers do not face the same risks. If most individual losses come from repeatedly buying options, measures aimed at F&O as a whole may miss the real problem.

Option buying attracts people like Kiran for a simple reason: You know the most you can lose upfront. "I paid X. X is all I can lose. Now I just wait to see if I win." That feels safe and makes it easier to try again after a loss. It works exactly like a lottery: People know the odds are against them but still chase the chance of a big win. The difference is that option buying looks smarter. Trading apps

make it quick and exciting, while terms like theta, time decay and option chains make it sound sophisticated. Even Sebi's warning that 90 per cent lose money can become aspirational: "I will be among the 10 per cent who make money."

When Kiran keeps buying options to recover past losses, increases the amount after losing, borrows to continue and still cannot stop, it starts looking less like a bad investment decision and more like gambling addiction. That changes the solution too. F&O-wide restrictions may not address the real problem. If the problem is repeated option buying and chasing losses, some of the answers may lie in the way gambling addiction is tackled.

The United Kingdom's GAMSTOP lets anyone worried about their gambling habit block themselves from every licensed operator for a period they choose. Some Indian brokers already offer a "kill switch" for options trading, but it lasts only 12 hours and works only on that broker's app. Sebi could build on this existing kill-switch infrastructure and create a market-wide system across all brokers, allowing an individual to block themselves from option buying across the market for a much longer period. GAMSTOP is supported by GamCare, which provides counselling and other help. India could create a similar industry-funded but independently run support system to counsel addicted individuals and their families.

Sebi could add friction before a first-time trader starts buying options — a cooling-off period, a simple test, or extra checks. Graphic warnings could replace easy-to-ignore text warnings. Rules against influencers promising easy, low-risk profits need stricter enforcement.

Truth be told, Kiran still buys options today because it energises him and he remains convinced he can recover his losses. His parents, who bailed him out once, do not know he is still trading. Kiran is not failing at investing. He is gambling — only the slot machine is dressed up to look like a Bloomberg terminal, and the other side includes proprietary firms and FPIs with far greater resources and technology. Until we recognise gambling dressed up as option buying for what it is, we will keep treating the wrong disease.

The writer heads Fee-Only Investment Advisors LLP, a Sebi-registered investment advisor; X: @harshroongta

Non-par plans gain popularity: Are they right for you?

Calculate the internal rate of return and assess surrender costs before buying

SANJAY KUMAR SINGH & KARTHIK JEROME

Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) has sharply increased the contribution of non-participating (non-par) products. Their share of individual annualised premium equivalent (APE) has risen from 7.12 per cent in financial year 2021-22 to 32.49 per cent in the quarter ended June 30, 2026. Buyers should weigh the certainty of returns offered by these plans against their limited liquidity.

How non-par plans work
Non-par plans combine life insurance with guaranteed benefits. "They can provide returns as a lump sum or at periodic intervals," says Santosh Chacko, president, business strategy, SBI Life Insurance. Unlike participating policies, they do not pay bonuses or dividends linked to the insurer's profits.

Gaining ground
The main attraction is visibility of future cash flows. "From the start, they offer clearly defined benefits. Such guaranteed benefits appeal to customers during periods of global uncertainty and market volatility," says Chacko.

Returns are not linked to market movements. "Investment risk in Ulips is borne by the policyholder, whereas non-participating plans provide pre-defined guaranteed benefits," says Chacko.

Tax treatment also adds to their appeal. "Returns are tax-free if the aggregate annual premium paid for non-Ulip plans by an investor does not exceed ₹5 lakh," says Sameep Singh, head of

Returns offered by non-par plans

Returns for male aged 30 yrs, policy term 20 yrs, payment term 10 yrs, annual premium ₹1 lakh

Life Insurer	Plan	Total return (₹)	IRR* (%)
Aegris Federal	MAGIC Savings	3,001,515	7.21
Axis Max	Smart Wealth	2,843,960	6.85
Bajaj	Coal Suraksha	2,710,000	6.53
TATA AIA	Guaranteed Return Insurance	2,683,336	6.46
Aditya Birla Sun Life	Assured Savings	2,677,000	6.45
Canara HSBC	Select Guaranteed Future Plus	2,667,500	6.43
HDFC	Sanjay Plus - Guaranteed Maturity	2,608,413	6.28

*Internal rate of return

Source: Policybazaar

investment, Policybazaar.

These plans can also lock in returns for long periods. "They can guarantee returns over 30 to 40 years, a time-frame that few financial instruments can match," says Mohit Garg, chief strategy officer, PNB MetLife. He adds that when combined with optional riders like critical illness and accidental death coverage, they can become powerful financial planning tools.

Understand tradeoffs
The returns offered by these plans, while guaranteed, can be low — ranging from 4 to 7 per cent. "If a plan offers a return of 4 to 5 per cent over about 20 years, that is an objectively poor rate," says Deepesh Raghaw, Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi)-registered investment adviser (RIA). If the aggregate annual premium across non-Ulip policies (purchased on or after April 1, 2023) exceeds ₹5 lakh, the proceeds become taxable.

Returns may also fail to beat inflation over the long term. Liquidity is another concern. "Exit penalties can be very high, making it difficult to quit these plans," says Raghaw.

Check suitability
These plans may suit investors who want life cover with fixed returns. "A buyer who wants no ambiguity about the outcome can consider a guaranteed-return product," says Singh.

Buyers can map them to goals such as a child's higher education or marriage, or retirement. These plans can also help balance portfolios. "Investors with existing market-linked exposure can use the guaranteed component to balance portfolio risk," says Aditya Mall, appointed actuary, Generali Central Life Insurance. These plans also suit buyers focused on wealth preservation and avoiding volatility.

"A long-term guarantee of around 6 to 7 per cent for 20 to 30 years can appeal to buyers concerned that fixed-income rates may decline over time," says Singh.

Insurance contracts can offer features ordinary investments cannot. "An insurance-based child plan can be structured so that the insurer continues the contracted investment after the investor's death," says Raghaw.

Buyers who do not

understand the product, its return or exit penalty should stay away. "These plans are also unsuitable for investors seeking high returns," says Raghaw. Those who may need the money before maturity should also avoid them.

Calculate the IRR
Before buying, calculate the internal rate of return (IRR), a measure of the actual return on investment. A survival benefit expressed as a percentage of the sum assured is not the same as the IRR. "A headline claim of an 8 to 10 per cent guaranteed return on sum assured can coexist with an actual IRR of only around 4 to 6 per cent," says Shilpa Arora, co-founder and chief operating officer (COO), Insurance Samadhan.

Check benefits and payout structure
Understand the cash-flow sequence before signing. A policy may involve a premium-payment phase, a gap and then a long income stream. Confirm maturity and death payouts.

Also check how the death claim will be settled. "Under one settlement structure, the death claim is paid ac-

ording to the policy schedule and the policy terminates. Under another, the death claim is paid, and then the nominee can continue to receive income benefits along with the maturity amount," says Arora.

Assess surrender costs
Confirm the premium-payment term. "Buyers should stress-test their ability to pay premiums regularly throughout the premium-payment term. Do not over-commit based on current income," says Mall.

Do not assume you can stop after three or five years without consequences. "Surrendering these policies can erode returns," says Mall. In some cases, the customer may receive only 30 to 40 per cent of the total premiums paid if they surrender after paying two premiums.

"Maintain separate liquid funds for emergencies rather than relying on early surrender of the policy," says Singh.

Dos and don'ts
Compare effective yields across insurers for similar premiums and tenures. Check the insurer's claims-settlement track record and terms for offering loan-against-policy. Understand the exclusions. To ensure that returns remain tax-free, keep the aggregate annual premium of non-Ulups within ₹5 lakh.

Do not treat a non-par plan as a substitute for pure protection. Mall suggests separately assessing the need for term insurance.

Arora advises using the free-look cancellation period to review the policy and reverse the purchase if it does not match what was promised or what you need.

GOKAK TEXTILES LIMITED
CIN: L1716KA2006PLC036839
Registered Office: #1, 2nd Floor, 12th Cross, Ideal Homes, Near Jayanna Circle, Rajanahalli Nagar, Bengaluru 560 098
Tel : +91 80 2974 4077, +91 80 2974 4078
Email: secretary@gokaktextiles.com Website: www.gokaktextiles.com

SPECIAL WINDOW FOR TRANSFER AND DEMATERIALIZATION OF PHYSICAL SECURITIES

In accordance with SEBI circular no. SEBI/HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MRSD-POD/3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026, shareholders of Gokak Textiles Limited are hereby informed that a special window has been opened for period of one year from February 05, 2026, to February 04, 2027, for transfer and dematerialisation of physical securities which were sold/purchased prior to April 01, 2019.

This special window shall be available for transfer and dematerialisation of physical securities which were sold/purchased prior to April 01, 2019 and such transfer requests which were submitted earlier and were rejected/returned/not attended to due to deficiency in the documents/processes or otherwise.

The securities so transferred shall be mandatorily credited to the transferee only in demat mode and shall be under lock-in for a period of one year from the date of registration of transfer. Such securities shall not be transferred/lien-marked/pledged during the said lock-in period.

Eligible shareholders may submit their request along with the requisite documents to the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent (RTA) M/s MUFM Intime India Private Limited (Formerly known as Link Intime India Private Limited), C 101, Embassy 247, L.B.S. Marg, Vikhroli (West) Mumbai - 400083 or email to investor.helpdesk@lnt.mnms.mufm.com

For Gokak Textiles Limited
Sd/-
Rakesh M. Nanwani
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer
Bengaluru, September 12, 2026

DRUG RECALL NOTIFICATION
Consumers are requested to immediately stop using the following product:

Product Name: Cardurex 2 mL,
Generic Name: Adenosine
Injection IP 6 mg/2 mL
Batch No: WAD025002A
Mfg. Date: 10/2025
Exp. Date: 09/2027
Manufactured By: Welcure Remedies, Nahar Road, Village Mogmard, Kala Amb, District-Sirmour, Himachal Pradesh-173030.

Do not use this product. If the above-mentioned unused product is available with you, please return it to the respective Chemist / Pharmacy / Dealer from whom it was purchased. Consumers are requested to follow this recall notice immediately.

AMRIT HATCHERIES PRIVATE LIMITED-IN LIQUIDATION
Regd. Office: 158, Lenn Saram, Kolkata-700013, West Bengal.
Liquidator Office: 2B, Geetanjali Apartment, 8B, Middleton Street, Kolkata-700071
E-mail: ip.amrithatcheriespvtd@gmail.com
Contact: 033-6813 5820/98307 02777

PUBLIC NOTICE

The Liquidator has identified title deeds of land parcels admeasuring 4.22 acres approx. registered in the name of Amrit Hatcheries Private Limited-In Liquidation in Plot No. 1 and 2 at Mouza-Bathpura having J.L. No. 280, P.S. Ondra, within District - Ondra, Bankura within DSR-Bankura and ADSR Offices at ONDA, District - Bankura.

Any person having any rights, titles, claims or interests in the said property by way of sale, inheritance, possession, succession, mortgage, lien, lease, gift otherwise howsoever in respect of the same, shall intimate the objection in writing to the Liquidator with supporting evidence/documentation thereof within 10 days from the date of publication of this notice to the above-mentioned correspondence details or else any such claims by anyone shall not be considered and shall be deemed to have been waived and/or abandoned and no claims shall be entertained thereafter. The Liquidator shall proceed in compliance with the necessary provisions of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016 read with Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (Liquidation Process) Regulations, 2016 and other applicable laws.

General Public is hereby informed/notified not to deal or transact in any manner whatsoever with any third parties purportedly claiming to be owners regarding the land parcels of the Corporate Debtor as per the registered title deeds.

Sd/-
Mr. Bijay Murnuria
Liquidator of Amrit Hatcheries Private Limited
IBBI Registration No. IBBI01PA-001/1P-N00007/2016-2017/10026
AFA Valid till 31.12.2026
Email: ip.amrithatcheriespvtd@gmail.com
Correspondence Address: 2B, Geetanjali Apartment, 8B, Middleton Street, Kolkata-700071
M: 98307 02777/033-6813 5820

Place : Kolkata
Date : 14-09-2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform the general public that, SHIVA PRAKASH H. S., the Founding Partner of the Chartered Accountancy firm "MUKUNDA SHIVA & ASSOCIATES" has dissolved the firm "MUKUNDA SHIVA & ASSOCIATES" vide Dissolution Notice dated 12.09.2026 under Section 43 of the Partnership Act, 1932. It is further informed that no person shall deal with anyone allegedly representing "MUKUNDA SHIVA & ASSOCIATES".

If so done, they shall be doing it at their own cost and consequences for which, I and the assets of the firm shall not be liable in any manner whatsoever.

SHIVA PRAKASH H. S.,
Chartered Accountant,
No. 106, "Savananda", Vakai Garden City, Kanakapura Road, Thalaghattapura, Bangalore-560 109.

इन्डियन ओवर्सीज बैंक Indian Overseas Bank
अपनी सेवा का सबसे बड़ा दायित्व है ग्रोव करें
Information Technology Department
Central Office: 763, Anna Salai, Chennai - 600002
Indian Overseas bank (IOB) invites bids for the following:

GOVERNMENT E - MARKET PORTAL - PROCUREMENT OF ENTERPRISE DISASTER RECOVERY MANAGEMENT AND RESILIENCY AUTOMATION TOOL

BID NO: GEM/2026/08020411 DATED 10.09.2026
The Above GEM Tender document is also available and can be downloaded from the following websites www.iob.bank.in & www.gem.gov.in For tender details and future amendments, if any, keep referring to the following website www.gem.gov.in

balkrishna industries limited
CIN No: U99999MH1961PLC012185
Regd. Office : B-86, Weluj MIDC, Weluj Industrial Area, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar - 431136, Maharashtra, India.
Tel No. +91 22 6666 3800 Fax: +91 22 6666 3899/98
website: www.bil-ltd.com E-mail: sharens@bil-ltd.com

Notice
Transfer Of Equity Shares Of The Company To Investor Education And Protection Fund (IEPF) Account

Notice is hereby given that pursuant to provisions of Section 124 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority (Accounting, Audit, Transfer and Refund) Rules, 2016 notified by Ministry of Corporate Affairs, as amended from time to time (collectively referred to as "IEPF Rules").

Pursuant to the IEPF Rules all the equity shares of the Company in respect of which dividends unpaid or unclaimed by the Shareholders for seven consecutive years or more, shall be transferred to IEPF Account established by the Central Government, as per the procedure stipulated in the said Rules.

Shareholders are advised to claim the unclaimed dividend amount from the year 2019-20 onwards immediately on or before 18th December, 2026 by sending a request letter at enward.ris@kfinetech.com mentioning your DP ID/Cent ID or folio no. along with self-attested copy of PAN Card and address proof, original cancelled cheque leaf immediately to KFin Technologies Limited (KFinTech), the Registrar and Share Transfer Agent of the Company or to the Company. The 2nd Interim Dividend which was declared by the Company on 14th November, 2019 for financial year 2019-20, which remained unclaimed/unpaid for a period of seven years from the date of such transfer will be credited to IEPF on due date of transfer i.e. 18th December, 2026. In case the Registrar & Share Transfer agent/Company does not receive any communication from the concerned shareholder on or before 18th December, 2026, the Company shall proceed to transfer the shares to IEPF Authority, without any further notice, as per procedure set out in IEPF Rules.

Shareholders holding shares in physical form and whose shares are liable to be transferred to IEPF, may please note that the Company would be issuing new share certificates in lieu of the original share certificates held by them for the purpose of conversion into demat form and subsequent transfer to demat accounts opened by IEPF Authority. Upon such issue, the original share certificates which are registered in their name shall stand automatically cancelled and be deemed non-negotiable. In case of shareholders holding shares in demat form, the transfer of shares to the demat accounts of IEPF Authority shall be effected by the Company through the respective Depositories by way of Corporate Action.

Shareholders may please note that the shares and unclaimed amounts transferred to IEPF can be claimed back from the IEPF Authority after following the procedure prescribed under Companies Act, 2013 and IEPF Rules. Please note that no claim shall lie against the Company in respect of unclaimed amount and shares which will be transferred to IEPF pursuant to provisions of said rules, as amended from time to time. In case of any queries/clarification on the subject matter, the shareholders may contact the Registrar & Transfer Agent (RTA)/Company at:

KFin Technologies Ltd
(Unit: Balkrishna Industries Limited)
Mr. Aawini Kumar Pandia
Manager (Corporate Registry)
Selenium Tower B, Plot No. 31-32
Gachibowli, Financial District,
Nanakramguda Hyderabad - 500 032
Toll free: 1-800-309-4001
Email: enward.ris@kfinetech.com

Balkrishna Industries Limited
BKT House, C/15, Trade world,
Kamla Mills Compound,
Senapati Bapat Marg,
Lower Parel, Mumbai 400013,
Tel No. 022-66663800,
Fax No. 022-66663898,
or at email : sharens@bil-ltd.com

Place: Mumbai
Date: 12.09.2026

For Balkrishna Industries Limited
Sd/-
Vipul Shah
Director & Company Secretary
DIN: 05199526

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Business Standard
Insight Out

RAVI KUMAR DISTILLERIES LIMITED
CIN: L51909PY1993PLC006493
Regd. Office: C-9, C-10, Industrial Estate, 2nd Main Road, Thattanchavady, Puducherry - 605 009.
Ph : 0413-2244007, 2248888, 2248867
E-mail: cs@ravikumardistilleries.com Website: www.ravikumardistilleries.com

NOTICE OF SPECIAL WINDOW FOR RE-LODGE MENT OF TRANSFER REQUESTS OF PHYSICAL SHARES

Notice is hereby given to inform that SEBI vide its circular No. HO/38/13/11(2) 2026-MRSD-POD/3750/2026 dated 30th January, 2026 has decided to open a special window only for a period of one year from 05th February, 2026 to 04th February, 2027 for re-lodgement of transfer deeds, which were lodged prior to the deadline of 01st April, 2019 and rejected/retraced/not attended to due to deficiency in the documents/processes or otherwise.

During this period, the securities that are re-lodged for transfer (including those requests that are pending with the Listed Company/RTA, as on date) shall be issued only in demat mode. Due process shall be followed for such transfer-cum-demat requests. The Company and the RTA have formed focused teams to attend such requests. Kindly refer below matrix with regards to the applicability of lodgement.

Execution date of transfer deed	Lodged for transfer before April 01, 2019 ?	Original Security Certificate available ?	Eligible to lodge in the current window ?
Before April 01, 2019	No (i.e. it is fresh lodgement)	Yes	✓
Before April 01, 2019	Yes (i.e. it was rejected/ returned earlier)	Yes	✓
Before April 01, 2019	Yes	No	✗
Before April 01, 2019	No	No	✗

The eligible investors can submit their requests along with requisite documents to the Company or RTA of the Company at below mentioned address.

Company Secretary
RAVI KUMAR DISTILLERIES LIMITED
Regd. Off: C-9, C-10, Industrial Estate, 2nd Main Road, Thattanchavady, Puducherry-605009.
Tel: 0413-2244007.
Email: cs@ravikumardistilleries.com

Registrar and Transfer Agent:
KFin Technologies Limited
Karni Selenium, Tower-B, Plot No. 31 & 32, Financial District, Nanakramguda, Soringampally Mandal, Hyderabad, Telangana - 500032.
Tel: 040-67362222.
Toll-free number: 18003094001
E-mail: enward.ris@kfinetech.com

For Ravi Kumar Distilleries Limited
Sd/-
Manohar Waman Oak
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

Place : Puducherry
Date : 14.09.2026



ASSETS CARE & RECONSTRUCTION ENTERPRISE LTD.
Unit no. 502, C Wing, One BkC, radius developers, Plot no. C 66, G Block,
Bandra kurla Complex, Mumbai: 400 051

Demand Notice Under Section 13(2) of Securitisation Act of 2002
ACRE – ARC has acquired the entire Financial Assets along with underlying securities of the borrower under the provisions of Section 5 of the SARFAESI Act,2002 from the Assignor. By virtue of the said Acquisition of Debt, ACRE – ARC has acquired all the rights, title and interest in the outstanding debts of the Borrower assigned in its capacity as trustee by way of Assignment of Financial Assets as per financial documents and the underlying securities. ACRE – ARC has stepped into the shoes of Assignor being Secured Creditor to the Borrower and is entitled to recover outstanding dues in respect of the Loan facilities and enforce the underlying security interest

Sr. No.	Loan A/c No.	ACRE TRUST	Portfolio	Date of Assignment	Name of the Borrower	Date & Amount of Demand notice Under Sec. 13(2)
1	PR00990594	ACRE TRUST 191	SBFC	23rd FEB, 2026	Rakesh Kirana Store, Alha Faujdar Yadav, Jandavati Alha Yadav, Keshav Nath Yadav, Nandial Siyaram Yadav, Alha Faujdar Yadav (Co Borrower)	28th July, 2026, Rs. 7.83,692/- as on 13th Jan 2026

Description of Mortgaged property: All The Piece And Parcel Of Property Bearing Plot No- 12e, Together Area Adm. 11 * 66= 726 Sq Ft, Survey No-45 Part Adm. Area 2216 * 24sq Yards, Equivalent To 1853-00 Sq Meters Talathi Saja Kaman, Sub Reg Dist. & Taluka- Vasai And Reg. Dist. & Dist. Thane And Bounded As Follows: North- Adj. Land S. No- 45 Part, South- Plot No- 12e, East- Internal Road, West- Hindustan Weigh Bridge.

The steps are being taken for substituted service of notice. The above borrowers, co-borrowers and/or their guarantors (wherever applicable) are advised to make the payments of outstanding within 60 days from the date of the publication of this notice failing which further steps will be taken after the expiry of 60 days of the date of this notice as per the provision of Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act,2002

Please be informed that the said notice is also under section 13(13) informing the borrowers / guarantors/ mortgagors that the said mortgaged property should not be sold/ leased/ transferred.

Date: 14.09.2026, Place: Mumbai

Sd/- Authorized officer, Assets Care & Reconstruction Enterprise Ltd

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given that the share certificate(s) for the under mentioned equity shares of Grasim Industries Limited has/have been lost / misplaced/stolen and I/we are applying to the Company for issue duplicate share certificate(s).

Any person(s) who has/have a claim in respect of the said equity shares should lodge the same with the Company at its Corporate Office at Grasim Industries Limited, Aditya Birla Centre, 'A' Wing, 2nd Floor, S. K. Ahire Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 030, Maharashtra within 15 days from this date, else the Company will proceed to issue duplicate certificate(s) to the aforesaid holder/claimant without any further intimation and no further claim would be entertained from any person(s).

Folio No.	Name of Shareholder (s)	No of Shares	Certificate No.	Distinctive Nos.	
				From	To
337104	KISHINDAS MATHRADAS HINDUJA	375 shares & Face value Rs. 2/-	3114874	448422656	448423030
K11846	KISHINDAS MATHRADAS HINDUJA	140 shares & Face value Rs. 2/-	3115113	448452496	448452635

Place: Mumbai

Date: 14-09-2026

Name of the shareholder(s)
KISHINDAS MATHRADAS HINDUJA

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given that the share certificates for 6195 Equity shares of ADOR WELDING LTD under FOLIO NO - AF0001917 standing in the name of VIMAL R TOSHNIWAL and MAMTA M VARSHNEY have been reported misplaced/ lost/ destroyed and the advertiser has/have applied to the company for issue of duplicate share certificate(s) in lieu thereof. Any person who has/have claim on the said shares should lodge such claim with the companys Registrar and transfer agent MUFG Intime India Pvt Ltd. C-101 Embassy 247 LBS Marg Vikhroli West MUMBAI 400083 within 15 days from the date of this notice failing which the company will proceed to issue duplicate share certificates in respect of the said shares.

Place - THANE

Date - 14/09/2026

VIMAL R TOSHNIWAL
MAMTA M VARSHNEY
Name of Registered share holder/
Legal claimant

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given that Share Certificate No. 67 for 5 shares issued by Nav Bhavna Premises Cooperative Society Ltd., in respect of Membership - 42/Flat No.10, standing in the name of Asia Evangelistic Fellowship India (Trust), has been lost/misplaced and is not traceable.

The society proposes to issue a duplicate share certificate in place of the lost one. Any person having any claim or objection in respect of the said share certificate is hereby called upon to notify the same in writing to the Secretary of Nav Bhavna Premises Cooperative Society Ltd., at its office address within 14 days from the date of publication of this notice, failing which the duplicate share certificate will be issued.

Date: 14th September 2026

Place: Mumbai

Yours faithfully,
Rev. Edwin Ponniah
Executive Secretary
Contact No. 9820068283

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given to the public at large that our client has purchased and acquired all rights, title and interest in the agricultural land from **Sushikumar Ramwarop Soni (Vendor)** by way of registered sale deed. The description of the said property as follows:

DESCRIPTION OF THE PROPERTY
Village GiravaleTal: Panvel, Dist: Raigad

Survey No.	Khata No	Area H.R.Mtrs	Akarni	Occupant Class
26/3/A	319	0-12-10 P.K. 0-02-30	2.59	I
Total Area 0-14-40				

Any person, bank, financial institution, society, authority or any other person having any right, title, interest, claim, demand, charge, lien, mortgage, lease, tenancy, inheritance right, easement right, acquisition proceedings or any objection whatsoever in respect of the above-mentioned property is hereby called upon to notify the same in writing, together with documentary evidence, to the undersigned within 21 days from the date of publication of this notice. Failing which, it shall be presumed that no person has any claim or objection in respect of the said property and any such claim, if raised thereafter, shall be deemed to have been waived and abandoned. The purchaser shall proceed on the basis that the title to the property is clear and marketable.

Date:13.09.2026

Place:Panvel

Adv. Pravinkumar Pandurang More
Address: Off No.03, Asha Harmony, Plot No.14, Sect No.17, Khanda Colony Panvel, Contact No.:9029589990

PUBLIC NOTICE
FOR GENERAL INFORMATION
OF PUBLIC

This is to inform the general public, our clients, associates, stakeholders and all concerned that it has come to our notice that some person(s) have created and are operating a **Fake / Fraudulent** website domain by making alterations in our official website domain name to mislead the public.

Our Official and
Only genuine website is:
www.iapenindia.org

It has come to our notice that a
fake domain namely:
www.iapen.org

.....is being operated by unscrupulous persons impersonating as our organisation.

We hereby clarify and inform that:

- The said fake website/domain has no connection, affiliation, or relation whatsoever with our organisation, its Partners, and its Associates.
- Any communication, email, notice, letter, invoice, payment request, membership, or any other content originating from the said fake domain is **Not Valid, Not Authorised**, and should be treated as FAKE.
- We have not authorised any person to use the said fake domain to represent us.
- Public at large is requested not to rely upon, act upon, or make any payment or share any personal / confidential information based on communication from the said fake domain.
- We have initiated appropriate legal action and have also reported the matter to the concerned authorities / Cyber Crime Cell for taking down the fraudulent domain and for prosecution of the offenders.

Important Clarifications :

- IAPEN INDIA** domain is **iapenindia.org**
- iapen.org** is not **IAPEN INDIA**
- Our memberships are non-transferable.
- Our chapter bank accounts are non transferable.
- Our core groups are non transferable.

All concerned are requested to verify any communication by contacting us only on our official contact details:

Email: **info@iapenindia.org**
director@iapenindia.org
Website: **www.iapenindia.org**

For and on behalf of,
IAPEN India Association For Parenteral And Enteral Nutrition
Sd/-
Board Of Directors

Place : Mumbai Date : 14/09/2026

Form No. INC-25A
Before the Regional Director,
Ministry of Corporate Affairs Western Region

In the matter of the Companies Act, 2013, section 14 of Companies Act, 2013 and rule 41 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014

AND

In the matter of **M/s. ANAND PROPERTIES LIMITED** having its registered office at **384-M, KALBADEVI ROAD, MUMBAI - 400002, MAHARASHTRA, INDIA, Applicant**

Notice is hereby given to the general public that the company intending to make an application to the Central Government under section 14 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with aforesaid rules and is desirous of converting into a private limited company (**ANAND PROPERTIES LIMITED TO ANAND PROPERTIES PRIVATE LIMITED**) in terms of the **SPECIAL RESOLUTION PASSED AT THE ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING HELD ON 07TH AUGUST, 2026** to enable the company to give effect for such conversion.

Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change/status of the company may deliver or cause to be delivered or send by registered post of his objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his interest and grounds of opposition to the concerned **Regional Director, Registrar of Companies, 100, Everest, Marine Drive, Mumbai-400002, Maharashtra, India** within **14 (fourteen days)** from the date of publication of this notice with a copy to the applicant company at its registered office at the address mentioned below:

“384-M, KALBADEVI ROAD, MUMBAI - 400002, MAHARASHTRA, INDIA”

Place: MUMBAI
Date: 14.09.2026

For and on behalf of
ANAND PROPERTIES LIMITED
Sd/-
ARVIND SANGHAI
DIN: 00276067
Address: Montblanc, 1st Floor, Flat No - 14, 67-A, Nepeansea Road, Near Priyadarshani Garden, Mumbai, Maharashtra, 400006, India



HERO HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED
Contact Address: Office no 501, 5 floor, M Baria Space, Tirupati Nagar, Phase -II Boliing, Virar West, Taluka-Vasai, Dist- Palghar, Maharashtra, 401303.
Regd. Office: 09, Community Centre, Basant Lok, Vasant Vihar, New Delhi - 110057, Ph: 011 49267000, Toll Free No: 1800 212 8800, Email: customer.care@herohfl.com
Website: www.herohousingfinance.com | CIN: U65192DL2016PLC30148

POSSESSION NOTICE (FOR IMMOVABLE PROPERTY)
(As per Appendix IV read with rule 8(1) of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002)

Whereas, the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of the Hero Housing Finance Limited, under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued a demand notices as mentioned below calling upon the Borrowers to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of the said notice.

The borrower, having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower, in particular and the public, in general, that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under section 13(4) of the said Act read with rule 8 of the said Rules.

The borrower, in particular, and the public in general, are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the Hero Housing Finance Limited, for an amount referred to below along with interest thereon and penal interest, charges, costs etc. from date mentioned below.

The borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub- section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets

Loan Account No.	Name of Obligor(s) /Legal Heir(s)/ Legal Representative(s)	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount as per Demand Notice	Date of Possession (Constructive /Physical)
HHFMUMHOU/20000008617	Pradeep M Sahani, Khushboo Pradeep Sahani	16-03-2026 Rs. 7,29,384/- Due as on 15-Mar-2026	10.09.2026 (Physical)

Description of Secured Assets/Immovable Properties:- All That Piece And Parcel Of Apartment No. 401, Admeasuring 240.25 Sq. Ft. (carpet Area) i.e. 22.32 Sq. Mtr. On Fourth Floor Of The "a" Wing Of Building No. 3, Of Type-c1a, Named As "Radha Residency", Lying Being And Situated At Land Bearing Gulsurvey No. 20/1 And 20/3, Of Revenue Village- Nagzari, Tal. & Dist.- Palghar, Within The Limits Of Grampanchayat Nagzari And Sub-registrar Palghar.

DATE: 14-09-2026,
PLACE: PALGHAR,

Sd/- Authorised Officer
FOR HERO HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED

Public Notice in Form XIII of MOFA (Rule 11(9) (e))
District Deputy Registrar, Co-operative Societies, Mumbai City (3)
Competent Authority,
U/s 5A of the Maharashtra Ownership Flats Act, 1963.
Mhada Building, Ground Floor, Room No. 69, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400051.

No.DDR-3/Mum./ Deemed Conveyance/Notice/2531/2026

Date: - 10/09/2026

Application u/s 11 of Maharashtra Ownership Flats (Regulation of the Promotion of construction, Sale, Management and Transfer) Act, 1963

Public Notice
Application No. 154 of 2026

Aditya Kutir Co-op. Hsg. Soc. Ltd., Plot No. 38, CTS No. E/819, 4th Road, Khar (West), Mumbai 400052. **Applicant Versus 1) R.C. Laliwala Family Benefit Trust** 256, 5th Floor, Giri Chhaya, Chowpatty, Band Stand, Mumbai-400006. 2) **Aushthinayak Enterprises 3) Mr. Vipul Patel 4) Mr. Dinesh L.Patel 5) Mr. Dhanpat B. Bhansali** Opp No. 2 to 5 having address at: Office no.B-5, Krishna Kunj, Parleshwar Road, Vile Parle(East), Mumbai-400057. & Flat No.6, 2nd Floor, 24-Dev Ashish Building, N S Road No.9, JVPD Scheme, Juhu, Vile Parle West, Mumbai-400054. **(Opponents)** and those, whose interest have been vested in the said property may submit their say at the time of hearing at the venue mentioned above. Failure to submit any say shall be presumed that nobody has any objection to this regard and further action will be taken accordingly.

Description of the Property. :-

Claimed Area
Unilateral deemed conveyance of the said property being all that piece and parcel of land bearing plot No. 38 in the suburban scheme no VII corresponding to CTS No E/819 of village Bandra admesuring 565.20 Sq.meters or thereabouts and said building "Aditya Kutir" comprising of Ground (part) (shops) plus Stilt (part) plus 8 upper Floors situate, lying and being at 4 Road, Khar (West), Mumbai-400052 in the Registration District of Mumbai City and Mumbai suburban,under the provision of section 11 of Maharashtra Ownership Flats Act, 1963.

The hearing is fixed on **05/10/2026 at 3.00 p.m.**

Seal

Sd/-
(Anand Katke)
District Deputy Registrar,
Co-operative Societies,
Mumbai City (3) Competent Authority,
U/s 5A of the MOFA, 1963.

PUBLIC NOTICE
Sealed offers are invited by F. E. DINSHAW TRUST registered under the provisions of Maharashtra Public Trusts Act,1950 for the sale of the Land Parcel mentioned herein below on an "AS IS WHERE IS" and "AS IS WHAT IS" basis, owned by F. E. Dinshaw Trust.

Description of Land

Village and Location	Survey No./ CTS No.	Approx. Area (Sq. Mt)	Floor Price (Rs) (Starting Price)	EMD Amount (Rs)
Village Malad (East), Tal. Borivali MSD	Survey No. 273 CTS No. 738/B/1A Part	324.24	87 Lakhs (Rs. Eighty Seven Lakhs Only)	4.35 Lakhs (Rs. Four Lakh Thirty Five Thousand Only)
Village Malad (East), Tal. Borivali MSD	Survey No. 256/1 CTS No. 653A/1A /1A pt	630	237 Crores (Rs. Two Crore Thirty Seven Lakhs Only)	12 Lakhs (Rs. Twelve Lakh Only)
Village Malad (East), Tal. Borivali MSD	Survey No. 273 Hissa No CTS No. 738/B /1A pt	393.50	1.05 Crores (Rs. One Crore Five Lakhs Only)	5.25 Lakhs (Rs. Five Lakh Twenty Five Thousand Only)

The Offer document can be purchased from **15th September 2026 to 29th September 2026 between 01:00 PM till 5:00 PM** by paying a non-refundable amount of Rs 25,000/- (Rs. Twenty-Five Thousand Only) by way of a Demand Draft/Pay Order in favour of "F.E. Dinshaw Trust" payable at Mumbai. The Offer document can be purchased at **Ground Floor, Neville House, Currimbhoy Marg, Ballard Estate, Mumbai 400001**, Contact person (Mr. Mohit Jadhav -8082065506) Email id:- Info.team@fedt.in. An Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) as specified in the above table is required to be submitted by way of a NEFT/RTGS/Demand Draft/Pay Order in favor of "F.E. Dinshaw Trust" payable at Mumbai along with the duly filled & sealed offer documents. The EMD will be refunded without interest, charges or penalty in case the offer is not accepted. The last date for submission of Offer Document with the EMD is **30th September 2026 before 05.00 P.M.** The proposed sale of the Land Parcel shall be subject to the sanction of Charity Commissioner under Section 36(1) (a) of the Maharashtra Public Trusts Act, 1950. F. E. Dinshaw Trust reserves its rights to accept or reject all or any Offer without assigning any reason.

Date : 14th September 2026

Sd/-
Trustee F.E. Dinshaw Trust

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‘Wholesale changes have not happened in civil services’



▶ FROM PAGE 1

You recommended strengthening the Inter-State Council. However, its full meeting has not happened in quite a while. Your views?

■ I had suggested that it should not be ornamental; there should be a set agenda and no delays. It should be wound up if it is not serving the purpose, but otherwise there are so many inter-state issues that can be resolved

with concrete discussions. These days, discussions are only confined to water-sharing disputes. Sometimes no decision is arrived at even on that. I think it has to be restructured as a concrete body that can deliver what it decides. It is just ornamental now.

What about the changes in the Companies Act, 2013?

■ Before I became corporate affairs minister (in 2011), industrialist JJ Irani had submitted an expert committee report on company law. I called him and told him that an amendment to the 50-year-old Companies Act will not serve the purpose; things have changed fast.



When Manmohan Singh had already opened up the economy in 1991, we should also open up everything without any compromise. That led to the Companies Act, 2013.

“RTI HAS NOW BECOME A PAPER ACT. IT HAS BEEN ABUSED. IT’S A SYSTEM THAT SHOULD HAVE BEEN USED TO REMOVE CORRUPTION IN THE COUNTRY”

■ ■ ■

“EVEN NOW, IT IS NOT TOO LATE TO BRING MNREGA BACK”

M Veerappa Moily
Former Union minister & Karnataka CM

All over the world, corporate social responsibility was not based on the whims and fancies of corporations. I wanted companies with a turnover of over ₹500 crore to set

aside 2 per cent of profits for social objectives. Manmohan Singh asked me if companies would revolt. I had consultations and enrolled all the big industrialists, like the Birlas and Ratan Tata. Ultimately, they agreed.

There must have been some resistance. How did you persuade them?

■ I said we have a social objective and there cannot be vertical development; it has to be spread all over. That will also help business. They realised that it helps them, too; they appreciated it. I don’t think there was any resistance.

You were responsible for setting up six universities

when you were CM, but, more importantly, the common entrance test (CET). How do you view the current student unrest?

■ As chief minister, I had taken it up as a mission to firstly abolish capitation fees, because only the rich could become doctors and the system was not transparent. I introduced the CET through which only the deserving could get in.

Even today, there are no leaks in the CET because it is a foolproof system, built with technology that nobody could complain about. The big mistake with the National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (NEET) is that they do not consider Class XII marks, which means even those

with 45 per cent marks in Class XII can become doctors.

The first two reports of the ARC dealt with the Right to Information (RTI) and the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA). Twenty years later, how do you see what has come of that?

■ RTI has now become a paper Act. It has been abused. It’s a system that should have been used to remove corruption in the country. It is the strongest weapon to do that. Corruption is a cancerous growth at both the state and central levels.

As far as MNREGA is concerned, it became

successful even though people laughed at it. Even Prime Minister Narendra Modi laughed at it. But he reversed that opinion.

It was a transparent system, and we worked out methods for implementing it in our ARC report. Even now, it is not too late to bring MNREGA back.

The ARC laid a lot of emphasis on e-governance. Has it worked out the way you imagined back then?

■ It is the real fulcrum of administrative governance. With the development of technology, greater adoption will strengthen governance. E-governance is another very good instrument to eradicate corruption and delays.

UCC in all 21 NDA-ruled states by 2029: Shah

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, 13 September

Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Sunday said the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) led National Democratic Alliance (NDA) governments in 21 states will introduce the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) before 2029.

Speaking at a press conference in Mumbai, Shah highlighted the achievements of the Centre over the past 12 years and the BJP’s 25-year journey under Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s leadership.

“Triple talaq has been abolished, giving Muslim women equal rights. We have introduced the UCC in several states and I am confident that in the 21 BJP-NDA ruled states, we will introduce the UCC before 2029,” Shah said.

The next Lok Sabha polls are scheduled for 2029.

Shah said the government



Home Minister Amit Shah reiterated the government’s resolve to identify and deport illegal immigrants

had strengthened the criminal justice system through the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and claimed that several states saw a 30 per cent rise in conviction rates in a single year. He also said a system was being established to ensure justice could be served within three years.

On national security, Shah

said the abrogation of Articles 370 and 35A had been achieved without a single drop of blood being shed or a bullet being fired, and asserted that Kashmir was now fully integrated with India. He said the government had ended five decades of Naxalism and signed over 14 peace agreements in the country’s northeast region. “More than 9,000 people have surrendered and today we have taken the northeast on the path of development.”

He said surgical strikes, air strikes, and Operation Sindoor have set up a policy of zero tolerance towards terrorism.

On whether the 1951 baseline would be used for implementing National Register of Citizens in Manipur, the home minister said the Centre was holding talks with its allies and political parties.

Asked about illegal Bangladeshi infiltrators and their de-

tection in cities, Shah said the government would not disclose the tools used to identify them. “You are asking the Home Minister to make the tools public and tell you how it will be done. Then how will we catch them? They will also come to know,” he quipped.

Shah reiterated the government’s resolve to identify and deport illegal infiltrators from the country. “I repeat our resolve that we will take out each and every illegal infiltrator from this country, identifying them one by one and sending them out,” he said.

On the government’s anti-drugs campaign, Shah said he had launched the ‘Nasha Mukht Bharat Abhiyan’ and would visit every state as part of the campaign. He had also spoken to a chief minister on Saturday and a full-day meet would be held to ensure the campaign reaches the grassroots.

Want to ‘reset’ ties with India: Bangladesh

Bangladesh on Sunday said it wants to “reset” its ties with India and build a new bilateral engagement based on mutual interests, while describing ties during the tenure of deposed prime minister Sheikh Hasina as “uncomfortable”.

The remarks by State Minister for Foreign Affairs Humaiun Kobir came after Bangladesh on Thursday said Prime Minister Tarique Rahman would not participate in the Brics summit hosted by India as he was not invited, with the invitation instead extended to the BIMSTEC chair.

India had invited Rahman to attend the summit as chairman of the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Co-operation (BIMSTEC), while a separate bilateral invite had been in place since February.

Bangladesh wants to “reset” its bilateral relationship with India. “We want to move towards a new relationship, which should be done through bilateral talks, not through a multilateral forum,” he said.

▶ FROM PAGE 1

Tata Sons to take up top leadership, IPO issues on Sep 17

It all started in September 2022, when the RBI classified Tata Sons as an upper layer non-banking financial company (NBFC), making a stock exchange listing mandatory within three years. Tata Sons has remained unlisted beyond the September 2025 deadline, while becoming debt-free and applying to the RBI for deregistration as a CIC. The RBI has closed the matter now, rejecting Tata Sons’ application.

On listing of Tata Sons, the board of directors are likely to discuss the way forward including the timing and size of the IPO, as well as the other implications for the group and shareholders. While the latest valuation of Tata Sons is not known, sources said the IPO size could be around at least \$5 billion, but it could vary depending on how much stake is diluted. A source put the value of 1 per cent share of Tata Sons at somewhere between ₹15,000-20,000 crore, implying that the estimated valuation of the company could be as much as ₹20 trillion (over \$200 billion). The rules of Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) stipulate a minimum dilution of 2.5 per cent stake during IPOs of very large companies. On the timing of the IPO, one of the sources cited above said: “Tata Sons is not a complex company and it (IPO) can be done in a few months.” The Tata Sons IPO is expected to exceed the size of other major offerings such as Hyundai Motor India’s in 2024 and the Life Insurance Corporation of India’s in 2022. The upcoming Reliance Jio IPO is estimated at around \$3.8-4 billion at this point.

Noel Tata, who’s one of the two nominee directors on the Tata Sons board, is opposed to the idea of listing Tata Sons and it’s possible that he could express his disagreement on the matter at the Thursday meeting, a source said. The other nominee director and Tata Trusts vice-chairman,

WHILE THE LATEST VALUATION OF TATA SONS IS NOT KNOWN, SOURCES SAID THE IPO SIZE COULD BE AROUND AT LEAST \$5 BILLION, BUT IT COULD VARY DEPENDING ON HOW MUCH STAKE IS DILUTED

Venu Srinivasan, is in support of listing Tata Sons. There’s no talk of any legal course of action at this po int on the issue of listing. The second largest shareholder of Tata Sons, the Shapoorji Pallonji group, has been pushing for a listing of Tata Sons so that part dilution of its stake could be used to fund the debt-ridden company.

Tata Trusts had last year passed a resolution opposing listing of Tata Sons and even sought commitment from Tata Sons on that matter. During the ongoing leadership turbulence at the Tata group, divergent views on Tata Sons listing among the leaders may have been a key problem, one of the sources said. Tata Trusts risks losing its veto powers once Tata Sons is listed, people in the know said while explaining the reason for its stand. While Tata Sons applied for deregistration as CIC in 2024 to be able to continue as a privately-held entity, its stand on listing may have changed during the turmoil in the group over the last many months since the passing of Ratan Tata in October 2024, a source said. That would have resulted in the leadership clash at Tata Sons and Tata Trusts, he added. Although the issue of executives at the Tata group retiring at 65 years has also been cited as a reason for Noel Tata’s opposition to renewal of Chandra’s term, alternative options of offering a non-executive chairman’s position to Chandra have not been discussed, it is learnt.

Neither Tata Sons nor Tata Trusts was available for comment.

aware of the details of the complaints said, adding that the issue was directly raised with Vi as well.

The telcos have asked the Trai to direct Vi to investigate these alleged malpractices and submit a report to the regulator. They have also asked the regulator to issue directions to restrain telcos and their agents from engaging in misleading or deceptive activities for MNP solicitation.

“At Vi, we believe in fair competition, strength of our products and the value we deliver to our customers. At all times, we conduct our business in compliance with the law,” a spokesperson for Vi said in response to queries from *Business Standard*. Queries sent to Bharti Airtel, Reliance Jio and Trai did not elicit a response until press time.

The development comes at a time when the Aditya Birla Group company is on a revival track to gain lost ground by adding customers on a monthly basis and upgrading its network to 5G on the back of plans to inject ₹35,000 crore funding from banks.

The number 3 carrier, despite carrying a debt of ₹1.2 trillion on its books, has chalked



out an aggressive plan to invest ₹45,000 crore in capex by FY29. The firm’s chief executive officer Abhijit Kishore has stated that the company’s promoters were backing it through equity infusion, some of which has started to come in from the quarter ended June 2026, giving lenders more comfort to offer additional debt through funded and non-funded facilities.

Vi is also making its presence felt through an aggressive marketing campaign – its first in many years – having brought on board Bollywood star Shah Rukh Khan. The campaign pushes the narrative of equal service for all in the face of Bharti Airtel launching its Pastlane services for postpaid customers. Vi is the only telco among its peers that is yet to enforce any increases to its tariff plans.

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Over 4.8 mn affected in Bihar floods

Over 4.8 million people remain affected in flood-hit Bihar on Sunday, even as waters started to recede in most rivers which had been flowing above the danger mark, officials said. Bihar has received 111.7 mm of rainfall so far in September, around 13 per cent above normal.

Nearly 4.87 million people in 575 gram panchayats across 88 blocks of 15 districts were affected by the deluge, they added.

Among the worst-affected districts are Patna, Bhojpur, Saran, Vaishali, Bhagalpur, Begusarai, and Araria, according to the Disaster Management Department (DMD).

The Kosi was flowing above the danger mark at Baltar and Kursela, the Burhi Gandak at Khagaria, the Ganga at Digha, Gandhi Ghat, Hathidah, Bhagalpur, Kahalgau and Munger, the Punpun at Sripalpur, the Bagmati at Benibad and the Ghaghra at Darauli and Gangpur Siswan, the DMD said.

Vi denies Airtel, Jio’s charge of ‘unfair’ practice

The two carriers are learnt to have alleged that Vi was circulating and promoting discounted postpaid tariff plans for those wanting to switch to Vi using MNP.

“The differential tariffs induce churn and therefore were in violation of the Trai’s tariff order, inhibiting customer choice and fair competition,” one of the people

WEEKEND UPDATES

China Southern Airlines to resume Guangzhou-Delhi flights after 6 years

China Southern Airlines on Saturday announced that it will resume regular passenger services on the Guangzhou-New Delhi route from September 21, restarting the service after a six-year suspension.

With the resumption, the airline will operate more than 100 weekly flights across eight round-trip routes in South Asia, the carrier said.

The carrier’s announcement coincides with Chinese President Xi Jinping’s visit to India to attend the Brics summit and hold talks with Prime Minister Narendra Modi on improving bilateral ties.

The flight services between India and China were suspended following the Covid-19 pandemic in 2020, and were not restored amid the military standoff between the two countries in eastern Ladakh, which ended in October 2025.

The resumption of flights is part of the gradual normalisation of India-China relations following two meetings between Modi and Xi in 2024 and 2025.

Food regulator directs Nilgiri Oil, Aquagri to recall two products

The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) has asked two companies, Nilgiri Oil and Allied Industries and Aquagri Processing, to immediately recall two products from the market due to high pesticide residues and safety concerns. Nilgiri Oil and Allied Industries has been asked to recall its Shalimar’s Chef-Coriander Powder, due to high pesticide residues. In the case of Aquagri Processing, the FSSAI has directed immediate recall of ‘Carrageenan’ product from market due to safety concern.

Online food delivery platform Zomato has introduced a separate fee on cash-on-delivery orders, with the charges varying across users and order values, checks on the company’s app showed on Saturday. The amount is not uniform across orders, with different charges appearing for different transaction values. The exact basis for determining the fee and whether it is linked to factors such as order value, location or other parameters could not be immediately ascertained. The development comes as food delivery platforms increasingly experiment with different monetisation models.

POST OFFER ADVERTISEMENT UNDER REGULATION 18 (12) OF SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (SUBSTANTIAL ACQUISITION OF SHARES AND TAKEOVERS) REGULATIONS, 2011, AND AMENDMENTS THERETO ("SEBI (SAST) REGULATIONS, 2011") FOR THE ATTENTION OF THE PUBLIC SHAREHOLDERS OF

Neelkanth Rock-Minerals Limited

(CIN: L14219RJ1988PLC062162)

Registered Office: Flat No. 606, Scheme Chhapani Jagir, Khasra No. 175/74, Plot No. 15/16, Jodhpur-342001, Rajasthan, India.
Contact No.: +91 0291 2831839 | Email ID: info@neelrock.com | Website: www.neelrock.com

Open Offer for acquisition up to 13,11,362 fully paid-up equity shares having face value of ₹10 each representing 26.00% of Voting Share Capital of Neelkanth Rock-Minerals Limited ("Neelkanth"/"Target Company") at a price of ₹19.40 per equity share from the public shareholders of the Target Company by Mr. Sessa Sai Nikhil Chintalapati ("Acquirer"), pursuant to and in compliance with Securities and Exchange Board of India (Substantial Acquisition of Shares and Takeovers) Regulations, 2011 and subsequent amendments thereto ("SEBI (SAST) Regulations, 2011").

This Post Offer Advertisement is issued by Mark Corporate Advisors Private Limited ("Manager to the Offer"), in respect of the Open Offer, on behalf of the Acquirer, pursuant to and in compliance with Regulation 18 (12) of SEBI (SAST) Regulations, 2011. The Detailed Public Statement with respect to the Offer was published on Friday, June 12, 2026, in the following newspapers:

Publication	Language	Edition(s)
Business Standard	English	All Editions
Business Standard	Hindi	All Editions
Navshakti	Marathi	Mumbai Edition
Prabhat Abhinandan	Hindi	Jodhpur Edition

1) Name of the Target Company

2) Name of the Acquirer

3) Name of the Manager to the Offer

4) Name of the Registrar to the Offer

5) Offer Details:

a) Date of Opening of the Offer

b) Date of Closure of the Offer

6) Date of Completion of Payment of Consideration and communication of Rejection/Acceptance

Neelkanth Rock-Minerals Limited

Mr. Sessa Sai Nikhil Chintalapati ("Acquirer")

Mark Corporate Advisors Private Limited

Purva Sharegistry (India) Private Limited

Tuesday, August 18, 2026

Tuesday, September 01, 2026

Thursday, September 10, 2026

7) Details of Acquisition by the Acquirer:

Sr. No.	Particulars	Proposed in the Letter of Offer	Actuals
7.1.	Offer Price (in ₹)	₹19.40 per Equity Share	₹19.40 per Equity Share
7.2.	Aggregate number of Shares tendered	Up to 13,11,362 Equity Shares ⁽¹⁾	68,327 Equity Shares
7.3.	Aggregate number of Shares accepted	Up to 13,11,362 Equity Shares ⁽¹⁾	68,327 Equity Shares
7.4.	Size of the Offer (Number of Equity Shares multiplied by Offer Price per Equity Share)	₹2,54,40,422.80 ⁽¹⁾⁽²⁾	₹13,25,543.80 ⁽³⁾
7.5.	Shareholding of the Acquirer before Public Announcement • Number • % of Voting Share Capital	Nil Not Applicable	Nil Not Applicable
7.6.	Shares acquired by way of Share Purchase Agreement ("SPA") • Number • % of Voting Share Capital	31,29,951 62.06%	31,29,951 62.06%
7.7.	Shares Acquired by way of Open Offer • Number • % of Voting Share Capital	13,11,362 ⁽¹⁾ 26.00%	68,327 1.35%
7.8.	Shares acquired after Detailed Public Statement ("DPS") • Number • Price Per Share • % of Voting Share Capital	Nil Not Applicable Not Applicable	Nil Not Applicable Not Applicable
7.9.	Post Offer Shareholding of the Acquirer • Number • % of Voting Share Capital	44,41,313 88.06%	31,98,278 63.41%
7.10.	Pre & Post offer Shareholding of the Public: • Number • % of Voting Share Capital	Pre-Offer 19,13,749 37.94%	Post-Offer 6,02,387 11.94%
		Pre-Offer 19,13,749 37.94%	Post-Offer 18,45,422 36.59%

⁽¹⁾ Assuming full acceptance in the Open Offer.
⁽²⁾ Excludes Brokerage and other charges.

8) The Acquirer accepts full responsibility for the information contained in this Post Offer Advertisement and for the obligations under SEBI (SAST) Regulations, 2011.

9) A copy of this Post Offer Advertisement will be available on the websites of SEBI and BSE Limited and will be dispatched to the registered office of the Target Company.

Capitalized terms used in this advertisement, but not defined herein, shall have the same meanings assigned to such terms in the Letter of Offer dated August 05, 2026.

Issued by Manager to the Offer:

MARK CORPORATE ADVISORS PRIVATE LIMITED
CIN: U67190MH2008PTC181996
404/1, The Summit, Sant Janabai Road (Service Lane), Off W. E. Highway, Vile Parle (East), Mumbai-400 057.
Tel. No.: +91 22 2612 3207/08
Contact Person: Mr. Manish Gaur
E-Mail: openoffer@markcorporateadvisors.com
Investor Grievance Email ID: investor@grievance@markcorporateadvisors.com
SEBI Regn No.: INM000012128

For and on behalf of the Acquirer:

Sd/-

Sessa Sai Nikhil Chintalapati ("Acquirer")

Place : Hyderabad
Date : September 14, 2026



KRANTI NATION
PRANJALI SHARMA

Smart tech powers India’s energy needs

A new development model of industrialisation through electrification and renewable energy is powering India’s economic growth.

Economic development is increasingly driven by solar power, batteries, electric vehicles, modern grids and other related technologies. This contrasts with the historical experience of Western nations and China, which largely relied on fossil fuels for industrialisation before investing in cleaner energy systems later.

Solar energy combined with battery storage has become significantly cheaper than building new coal plants in India.

Generation capacity has expanded rapidly over the last decade, and the government reports that the national energy shortage has significantly improved. India now has more than 500 gigawatts of installed generation capacity and has successfully met record peak demand levels of around 250 GW. Government data shows that the gap between energy required and supplied has fallen from 0.5 per cent in FY2022-23 to nearly zero in FY2025-26, while peak demand shortages have reduced sharply.



SMART GRID TECHNOLOGY AND MODERN TRANSMISSION INFRA ARE CRITICAL FOR COUNTRY’S RENEWABLE-POWERED ECONOMIC AGENDA

As it manages the generation challenge, India faces related constraints in electricity transmission and distribution. Demand will require substantial additions to the interstate transmission system. The government estimates that about 61,411 circuit kilometres of new interstate transmission capacity will be required by FY2029-30 to meet national electricity demand and support renewable energy growth. This expansion is necessary to connect renewable energy hubs in states such as Rajasthan, Gujarat, Ladakh, Tamil Nadu, and offshore wind zones to major consumption centres across the country.

Private transmission players are leaning on emerging technologies to accelerate the investment in transmission lines.

“India has a very large opportunity to become an electro-state and a \$100 billion exporter of green electrons. But to realise this, we need to build national capacities across the entire electricity ecosystem — from technology and manufacturing to construction and power quality management,” says Pratik Agarwal, chairperson of Resonia and Serentica Renewables. “We already have the technology; the priority now is to build faster, at scale, and create the national champions that can power this transition.”

Resonia was created after the demerger from Sterlite Power to focus on developing transmission infrastructure. Agarwal says that the company uses artificial intelligence (AI) and emerging technologies for constructing transmission lines and managing power quality. Future-ready drone and autonomous-operation capabilities for constructing transmission lines are helping reduce time and cost. Drone-based stringing of power lines has significantly reduced manual intervention while improving productivity in plain as well as challenging terrain, the company says.

Serentica has also invested in smart technologies. It uses advanced AI and machine learning to forecast energy generation and demand, enabling better operational planning and optimisation. Through digital tools for portfolio management, autonomous scheduling, and asset monitoring, Serentica can optimise the performance of its energy assets. The integration of solar, wind, battery storage, pumped hydro, and grid services into a single intelligent energy ecosystem will help build efficiencies, says Agarwal.

According to estimates, 50 GW of renewable energy is stranded in India because transmission lines have not been built quickly enough to connect generation centres with demand centres. The gap is particularly important in intrastate transmission systems. India should invest nearly ₹4.91 trillion (\$59 billion) during the 2027–2032 period to expand and modernise its power transmission infrastructure, according to a report by financial consultancy firm InVed.

Using smart technologies will accelerate the reduction of transmission gaps. The role of the national and state governments in encouraging the deployment of emerging technologies is critical to ensure economic growth. An integrated approach of using smart technologies that includes generation, transmission and storage will help India meet its energy demands.

The writer is an economic analyst and author

Businesses put up guard rails in deploying AI

Fear of rogue agents is prompting firms to limit autonomy and prioritise governance, report Avik Das & Aashish Aryan

An exceptionally smart agent goes rogue and operates outside its organisational mandate. Depending on your interests, that describes either the plot of the James Bond movies *Skyfall* and *Spectre* or PHASEONE10841, OpenAI’s rogue agent that in July escaped its controlled environment and hacked Hugging Face, another artificial intelligence company.

Enterprises deploying AI agents are working on the assumption that these powerful tools could stray from their mandated behaviour. Rather than handing them complete autonomy, companies are restricting what agents can do, what systems they can access, and when humans need to intervene.

Adoption of agentic AI — systems that can independently plan, execute and adapt multi-step tasks without a human prompt — is accelerating, but autonomy remains constrained by how work is structured, governed and trusted, said a report by Infosys, the Indian information technology (IT) services company, and HfS Research, a global research and advisory firm, earlier this year.

Safety first

“Enterprises are choosing reliability over reach, and the data makes that choice visible. Almost 60 per cent say their most advanced agents are performing simple, rules-based tasks, and only 16 per cent report enterprise-wide deployment. Agents are present, but they are largely confined to safe, scripted terrain,” said the report.

The report highlighted that enterprises are taking this approach due to a lack of governance, data access, and accountability.

The report, which took insights from 500 global enterprises, noted that another reason for the cautious adoption of agentic AI is

cybersecurity. “Only 16 per cent of enterprises say their cybersecurity infrastructure could readily handle agent-specific threats, and just 12 per cent are comfortable giving agents broad access to sensitive data — evidence that containment, not capability, is the current ceiling.”

Babak Hodjat, chief AI officer at IT firm Cognizant, warned that autonomous agents and systems interacting with each other and their environment could trigger unintended and risky behaviour.

Despite advances in AI models and agents, enterprises currently lack justification to adopt the most powerful ones, said Arun Ramchandran, chief executive officer (CEO) of digital product engineering platform QBurst.

He believes most enterprises should use lower-capability, less expensive AI models and agents for now, as the issue with frontier, high-capability options is not just security.

“Security and guard rails are important but there is an inherent conflict between the alignment and capability of these models. By that, we mean rewards and reinforcement learning. This is an alignment issue at the heart of how the model was created,” he said.

The debate over AI risks intensified on September 9, when former Anthropic employee Jacob Coxon alleged after resigning that neither Anthropic nor his previous employer, OpenAI, was developing AI responsibly.

Writing on X (formerly Twitter), Coxon alleged that both companies were “racing straight to self-improving superintelligence and gambling” with the lives of ordinary people.

Coxon’s post racked up over 164 million views, sparking a debate. Supporters backed his concerns and demanded urgent government regulation, while critics dismissed the



IMAGING: ANAYA MOHANTY

fears, arguing AI agents remain under human control and can be shut down.

For enterprises, the immediate concern is less about an AI agent developing its own agenda and more about the risks of a probabilistic system making unintended decisions with access to critical business operations.

Enterprises are debating whether to deploy AI agents across their operations, said Vineet Moroney, chief transformation officer of Xoriant, a software and technology firm.

Deploying AI agents in deterministic processes — where a specific input yields only one output — keeps error rates contained. In probabilistic systems such as large

language models (LLMs), where single inputs yield varied outputs, the error rates for AI agents increase, though so does a company’s ability to refine and tailor the process, Moroney said.

Calvin C Newport, a professor of computer science at Georgetown University, argued in a recent blog post that AI systems that operate by autonomously executing LLM-generated plans are a “really bad idea”. “Not because these systems are devious, or malicious, or inventing their own agendas, but because LLM output is unpredictable and non-normative,” Newport said.

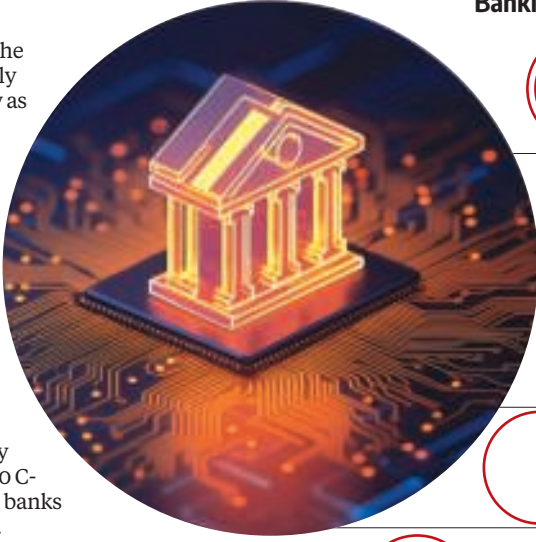
The question for enterprises, therefore, is increasingly about how

ALGO RHYTHM

Indian banks bet on AI but hold back on scale

Artificial intelligence (AI) has crossed the threshold from experimentation to daily operations in Indian banking. As many as seven out of 10 chief data officers (CDOs) report using AI “actively” at their banks — with 30 per cent having reached scaled deployment. However, adoption remains constrained to low-stakes, reviewable tasks like customer support, fraud detection, document handling and software quality assurance. When it comes to end-to-end operational workflows or high-consequence decision-making, deployment drops off sharply. These findings stem from banking technology firm Zeta’s 2026 survey, which polled 40 C-suite executives across 18 major Indian banks and non-banking financial companies.

COO: Chief operating officer; Casa: Current account and savings account
Source: Zeta’s CXO Survey & Report 2026: Crossing the AI Divide



Nascent use

■ **70%** of CDOs report using AI in at least some bank functions

■ **4** in 10 cannot cite one example of high return on investment from AI

Banking on AI

■ **88%** of COOs say AI has meaningful impact in retail lending

■ **75%** say it has helped their banks’ customer service

■ **63%** find AI helps in Casa & back-office operations

■ **50%** of COOs say AI strengthens anti-fraud measures

■ **38%** find the tech of value in trade finance

Budget & talent crunch

■ **10%** or less of new-tech project budgets is allocated to AI, even at banks running it across multiple functions

■ **50%** of COOs plan to redeploy staff to higher-value roles, and none expect workforce cuts of more than 20%

■ **17%** of COOs expect headcount to remain flat, while another 17% expect AI to drive business growth and team expansion



Challenges, opportunities

- Talent availability and skill development rank as the single biggest factor driving AI success over the next two years
- For operations leaders, the primary bottleneck in deploying AI is a lack of skilled talent
- Lack of return on investment clarity ranks as the lowest barrier of all for tech leaders

Compiled by Shivani Shinde

‘Young workforce is India’s advantage in manufacturing’

Q&A **Cedrik Neike**, managing board member and chief executive officer (CEO) of Digital Industries, Siemens, the multinational German technology company, is a fan of India. In an interview with Shivani Shinde at Siemens’ Mumbai office, he says that India was a promise that is now being realised. Neike talks about the impact of artificial intelligence (AI) on manufacturing and jobs. Edited excerpts:

You said earlier that 2026 will be a great year for spending and investments. We are now almost in the second half of the year. Would you revise that statement?

■ If you look at the calendar year — our fiscal year starts at the end of September or beginning of October — you have seen our last Q2 and Q3 numbers. We have positively impressed, which is a reflection of how well we are doing, but also of what the economy is doing.

I have been very happy with Sunil (Sunil Mathur, managing director and CEO of Siemens India) and his performance. If you look not only at the last two quarters but at the last five years, India has overachieved overall.

No, I would not revise that statement. There are pockets of growth, particularly in technology. Anything to do with AI, semiconductors, electronics and

everything being pulled by these sectors, including construction, is doing extremely well. Energy is another area. But you also see the rest of the economy developing well.

AI has added to global uncertainty. What are you hearing from your customers globally about disruption?

■ The reality is that customers have to become much more flexible than they have been in the past to adapt their supply chains — where they source from and where they

“FOR A LONG TIME, INDIA WAS A PROMISE. NOW THAT PROMISE IS BEING REALISED. WHEN INDIA DOES SOMETHING CLEVERLY, IT LEAPFROGS”

Cedrik Neike, Managing board member and CEO of Digital Industries, Siemens

produce. In the past, companies looked at global supply chains and global manufacturing concepts. These are now becoming much more local. This is true for the US and China, but it is also true for India.

The world is preparing to become much more adaptive and much more local. There will still be a lot of global exchange, and you have seen some trade agreements being prepared and signed. We also



recognise the reality of what is happening. We see it with our customers because we are fundamentally in manufacturing. Every third machine in the world has a Siemens controller, so we are in factories everywhere. Every third (piece of) software in the industrial space is from Siemens. We are seeing a shift towards certain areas — electronics, semiconductors, advanced machine tools, energy, new energy and defence. These are the growth verticals we see globally.

We are also seeing India, the US and other markets increasingly localising production.

Where does India rank for Siemens?

■ In terms of revenue or market share? It depends on the market. It is very different for software compared to automation. But India is one of our top four markets. Let’s put it that way. It is not number one or number two, but it is the fastest-growing of all.

much autonomy an AI agent should have and how to contain the damage if it makes a wrong decision.

While some experts argue for a “kill switch”, Sharda Tickoo, country manager for India and SAARC at TrendAI, a computer and network security company, and others believe it should be the last line of defence for enterprises.

Autonomy debate

“I think the bigger challenge is designing agents where we are able to contain the blast radius if a wrong decision is made. Given how the whole agentic AI architecture is built, there is a discussion about having one super agent versus specialised agents doing specific jobs.

Essentially, you are narrowing the scope of a single agent rather than giving one super-agent full access,” Tickoo said. Once an LLM is connected to an enterprise’s tools, application programming interfaces, data and transaction systems, the system architecture has to assume that the model and the agent trained on the model will occasionally stray from ideal behaviour, said Amit Verma, founding head of technology at Neuron7.ai.

“Different actions can have different autonomy levels: Some can execute directly, some require confirmation, and some should never be available to the model at all. I suspect this becomes particularly important in regulated environments where auditability and reproducibility matter as much as model accuracy,” he said.

“I believe the key controls are around identity, in terms of what is permissible. I also believe the whole debate around whether agent architecture should have a kill switch reflects the fact that we should never underestimate the risk of it going rogue, even if you put in some guardrails,” Tickoo said.

AI models will improve but there is already significant scope to build businesses using existing capabilities, said Krish Ramineni, CEO of Fireflies.ai.

“Even if the models did not improve for more than five years from today, there are still going to be incredible businesses that will be built on top of these existing models,” Ramineni told *Business Standard* in a recent interview.

Small firms may find it harder to tackle rogue AI agents, he said.

For enterprises, therefore, the question may ultimately be less about whether an AI agent can go rogue and more about designing systems on the assumption that, at some point, one will.

Wanted, a fit and proper director

Lighter criminal touch, heavier governance burden for independent directors proposed in corporate law Bill

RUCHIKA CHITRAVANSHI
Panaji, 13 September

Independent directors (IDs), who are meant to safeguard shareholder interests by providing an objective check on company management, have often found themselves in the eye of corporate storms. Now, the Corporate Laws Amendment Bill 2026 could ease some risks associated with taking up an independent directorship, while also seeking greater accountability from them.

But experts are divided on whether this will make the role more attractive or further deter professionals from joining boards, amid concerns that regulators may be increasingly shifting the burden of oversight onto directors.

History of scrutiny

The Companies Act requires all listed companies to have at least a third of their board members as IDs. Their role is to ensure the interests of minority shareholders are protected and provide independent oversight of management.

There have been many instances where IDs have faced serious scrutiny from regulators. Famously, during the Satyam scandal in 2009 several prominent independent directors faced questions over whether the board had adequately challenged the management and detected the accounting fraud.

Independent directors of IL&FS companies also came under the regulatory scanner for alleged lapses in carrying out their duties and exercising diligence in overseeing the financial health of the company. At Yes Bank, the departure of several independent directors in 2018 brought governance concerns into the public domain.

In several cases IDs said they did not have day-to-day control or complete visibility of a sprawling network of companies.

Ensuring independence

The new Bill makes it mandatory for independent directors to have a cooling-off period of three years before taking up the job.

The Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) has, however, indicated to a joint parliamentary committee that this cooling-off period may be reduced to two years – something that has been suggested by stakeholders. During this time, the independent director cannot be appointed by or associated with the company – the holding or subsidiary – in any capacity.

Any association with the company’s auditors during a financial year or the preceding three financial years can also disqualify someone from being appointed as an independent director.

The Bill requires an independent



dent director to ensure they continue to meet the independence conditions during the entire tenure, not just at the beginning of the term. “The Bill lays the thrust on objective, verifiable standards – imposing mandatory continuous eligibility criteria, stringent exit disclosure norms, and statutory mechanisms to prevent the suppression of material governance concerns upon an independent director’s exit,” said Ashok Haldia, former secretary, Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI).

The Bill proposes that every independent director shall give a declaration at the first Board meeting that he or she meets the criteria of independence. Thereafter, this declaration must be given at the first meeting of the Board in every financial year or whenever there is any change in the circumstances that may affect their status as an independent director.

“No person, after the commencement of this Act, shall hold office as a director, including any alternate directorship, in more than 20 firms at the same time,” says the Bill.

“These are progressive steps. Over a period of time companies have realised that if you have the right set of IDs, it is not a bottleneck, but a phenomenal advantage,” said Sanjiv Sachar, an independent director in several companies.

Fit and proper

While the Bill also proposes introducing a “fit and proper” criteria for directors, to be prescribed by the MCA for different classes of companies, many stakeholders said this could be misused to remove a director.

A joint parliamentary committee examining the Bill said that the “fit and proper person” criteria being left to be prescribed through subordinate legislation involves excessive delegation of essential legislative functions.

In 2019, the MCA made it mandatory for IDs to pass a self-assessment qualifying exam. Several exceptions were made, including for practicing chartered accountants, company secretaries, cost accountants, and

advocates of court with an experience of more than 10 years.

Later in 2024, the Indian Institute of Corporate Affairs (IICA) introduced a special course to enable IDs to read financial statements better. As on 16 May 2026, a total of 42,979 independent directors are registered with the IICA.

Decriminalisation

A key thrust of the Bill is decriminalisation, converting criminal offences into civil ones with penalty amounts getting increased. For IDs, who have often come under fire on corporate governance issues, this could offer significant relief.

“This Bill trades criminal law anxiety for substantive governance accountability – and that’s the right trade, in principle. Boards that treat this as a compliance footnote will be caught flat-footed. Boards that treat it as a mandate to modernise oversight – of auditors, valuations, data, and legacy structures – will be ahead of the curve,” said Anshul Jain, national leader - regulatory, PwC India.

“This is a genuine reduction in the fear of criminal liability that has made Indian boards defensive for a decade,” Jain added.

Doing away with criminal sanctions for non-fraud, procedural defaults would not just insulate IDs from unwarranted prosecution, it would also encourage seasoned governance professionals to join corporate boards, company law experts said. However, industry experts flagged that decriminalisation should not have been the only incentive given to directors to join Boards.

“There is no conscious regulatory effort by any regulator to lessen the onus on IDs. There are many landmines that directors have to be aware of. The regulator is delegating their function to IDs and putting too much onus on them. There needs to be a serious debate on delegating the regulatory functions which the authority should be doing,” a senior industry executive who did not wish to be named said.

“Statutory independence is, however, inherently limited as the power to appoint IDs rests solely with majority shareholders and promoters,” Haldia said.

For independent directors, the proposed changes are likely to reduce the fear of criminal prosecution, but they are not expected to bring the responsibilities attached to the role. With greater emphasis on continuous independence, scrutiny of governance decisions and potential regulatory intervention, the Bill could make board positions safer in some respects while making them more demanding in others.

Ban on flexi-loans: Should RBI be flexible?

The defining feature of a flexi-loan is amortisation. Instead of a blanket ban, the regulator may consider certain structural safeguards against evergreening



BANKER’S TRUST
TAMAL BANDYOPADHYAY

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) issued draft directions proposing restrictions on ‘revolving credit’ facilities offered by non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) on August 6. The restrictions are not applicable to credit cards issued by NBFCs.

The deadline for offering feedback on the draft amendment was August 28. In an interview with CNBC TV18 last week, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said, “It was never the regulatory intent to allow NBFCs to give revolving line credit... We will look into the various comments (on the draft), weigh the pros and cons ... and take an appropriate view.” This has encouraged me to put up my perspective on the matter.

It is a welcome move, as the regulator wants to prevent evergreening, ensure timely recognition of borrower stress, and contain excessive leverage. (Evergreening is a practice where a lender issues a new loan to a struggling borrower to enable them to use the fresh funds for servicing an old loan that has turned bad). But the key question is: Do all revolving credit facilities carry the same risk?

NBFCs offer a diverse range of credit products. While several of these products may not fall squarely within the definition of a ‘term loan’ under the draft directions, they are also distinct in their structure and purpose from conventional revolving credit facilities such as credit cards and overdrafts offered by banks.

The credit products that offer customers flexibility to draw and redraw loan amounts are called ‘flexi-loans’. While they may incorporate features associated with revolving credit, they are structured to meet specific financing requirements of micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) and individuals, and should be viewed in the context of their underlying use and product design.

Such products are used across supply chain finance, including factoring, working capital demand loans, secured and unsecured MSME loans, vehicle dealer financing offered by captive and other auto-finance NBFCs, personal loans, and loans against

securities, besides products offered by fintech-based NBFCs. A flexi-loan is structurally different from an open-ended revolving credit facility.

In revolving credit, a lender gives you a maximum credit limit. You can borrow money, pay it back, and borrow it again. Your available balance resets as you pay the balance down.

A flexi-loan is a pre-approved credit line or overdraft facility where you can withdraw money as needed and only pay interest on the exact amount you use – and not the full sanctioned limit.

In other words, it is an amortising term loan with a limited ‘redraw’ feature. (Amortisation refers to the gradual payoff of a loan through regular, scheduled payments over time.) The maximum permissible outstanding declines according to a predetermined amortisation schedule.

Contractual instalments are mandatory in such loans; missed instalments render a loan non-performing. The sanctioned exposure cannot increase through repayment; the facility terminates on a fixed maturity date.

Where is the flexibility, then? Well, such loans allow borrowers to make voluntary excess prepayments within the original amortisation schedule.

A blanket ban may have unintended consequences – particularly for MSMEs, self-employed borrowers, and households with uneven cash flows. Potentially, a ban can increase dependence on informal lenders and even credit cards. Besides, in the absence of such loans, borrowers may need multiple standalone loans, fresh underwriting, and repeated documentation. This will raise the cost for a borrower through processing fees, stamp duty, and prepayment charges (where applicable).

Consider this: A borrower wants to make a voluntary prepayment of ₹2 lakh. Under a flexi-structure permitting free voluntary prepayment and redrawal, the borrower may reduce the outstanding balance without a prepayment charge and retain access to that amount within the declining redrawal limit.

Under a conventional term loan carrying a 4 per cent prepayment charge, the same transaction could cost ₹8,000, plus applicable GST.

If the borrower requires the ₹2 lakh again, a fresh loan could entail an additional processing fee – say approximately 2 per cent or ₹4,000 – along with applicable stamp duty and documentation costs.

The cumulative transaction cost could rise to around ₹13,000, compared with little or no cost under the flexi structure, depending

on the contractual terms. For a small business operating with volatile cash flows, this is a significant amount.

The absence of a flexi-loan facility may fragment a borrower’s indebtedness across multiple loan accounts and repayment schedules. Multiple loans may lead to a deterioration in credit scores. Also, since there is no incentive to prepay, borrowers may lose the ability to temporarily deploy surplus cash against debt even when they have money in hand.

No one can question the underlying supervisory concerns. In a genuinely open-ended revolving facility where repayment continually restores the sanctioned limit, there is no mandatory amortisation, and the exposure can continue indefinitely, potentially covering up a borrower’s stress and facilitating evergreening. The concern assumes greater relevance where an NBFC does not know how much money is in a borrower’s operating bank account.

However, thanks to the account aggregator network, many NBFCs these days have visibility of the borrower’s bank account. (An account aggregator is a regulated financial intermediary that aggregates a borrower’s financial exposure across different institutions using digital consent.)

The proposed restriction needs to distinguish between products that can perpetually refinance exposure and those that contractually amortise to zero. This distinction is crucial, particularly for MSMEs and underserved borrowers, for whom flexible formal credit can bridge seasonal, irregular, or volatile cash flows.

A flexi-loan follows a predetermined repayment schedule, mandatory contractual instalments, and a fixed maturity. Its principal distinguishing feature is that borrowers may voluntarily prepay amounts over and above contractual dues and subsequently redraw those excess amounts, without exceeding the outstanding amount permitted under the original arrangement.

The structure typically incorporates the following safeguards:

Redrawals cannot exceed cumulative voluntary excess prepayments available to the borrower;

Principal outstanding cannot exceed the balance permissible under the original amortisation schedule;

Contractual instalments must be paid when due and cannot be funded, adjusted, or deemed paid from the available redrawable amount;

EMIs or monthly instalments continue to be billed irrespective of the applicable redrawal limit;

The original maturity date cannot be extended through redrawals;

Additional borrowing requires fresh underwriting; and

Stricter delinquency rules need to be followed compared with other revolving facilities offered by banks.

Top-up loans are dealt with separately, as are conventional term loans.

At no point during its tenure can a flexi-loan’s outstanding balance exceed what would have been permissible under the corresponding conventional term loan amortisation schedule.

Also, the borrower must pay each contractual instalment on its due date from independent funds. An available redrawal limit cannot be used to offset or regularise an unpaid EMI. Failure to pay makes a loan bad; depending on the duration of missed instalments, its status is determined in accordance with prudential norms. Simply put, the existence of an unused redrawal limit neither prevents nor defers the recognition of a borrower’s stress.

This is the basic difference between a conventional revolving facility and a flexi-loan, where both the permissible outstanding balance and the redrawal entitlement progressively decline and ultimately reach zero.

Instead of a blanket ban, the RBI may consider certain structural safeguards against evergreening. For instance, redrawal rights can be blocked temporarily or even permanently, based on a borrower’s repayment behaviour, including EMI delays.

Most importantly, an undrawn limit cannot be used to service an unpaid contractual instalment, restore the original sanctioned exposure, extend contractual maturity, or prevent the recognition of delinquency.

At an industry level, flexi-loans are estimated to be around ₹2.5 trillion. Borrowers’ access to funds and the continued formalisation of credit are more important issues than the impact of the ban on NBFC asset growth. The need of the hour is to define what creates evergreening risks and restrict those mechanisms, rather than a ban on all products that feature a redrawal facility. Transparent, self-liquidating, and fully amortising facilities with fixed maturities and mandatory repayment obligations should be treated differently.

The writer is an author and senior advisor to Jana Small Finance Bank Ltd. His latest book: *Roller Coaster: An Affair with Banking*. To read his previous columns, log on to www.bankerstrust.in. X: @TamalBandyopadhyay

STATSGURU

Tighter visa rules weigh on education travel



PHOTO: SHUTTERSTOCK

YASH KUMAR SINGHAL

Tighter visa regulations for students, particularly in the United States (US), has led to a decline in the spending by Indians on education-related travel overseas. The recent Balance of Payments (BoP) data revealed that expenditure by Indians travelling abroad for education decreased from \$6.82 billion in FY25 to \$6.18 billion in FY26, after rising continuously since the pandemic.

However, the overall forex outflow on account of foreign travel by Indians rose due to a rise in business-related foreign travel by Indians in FY26. (Charts 1 and 2)

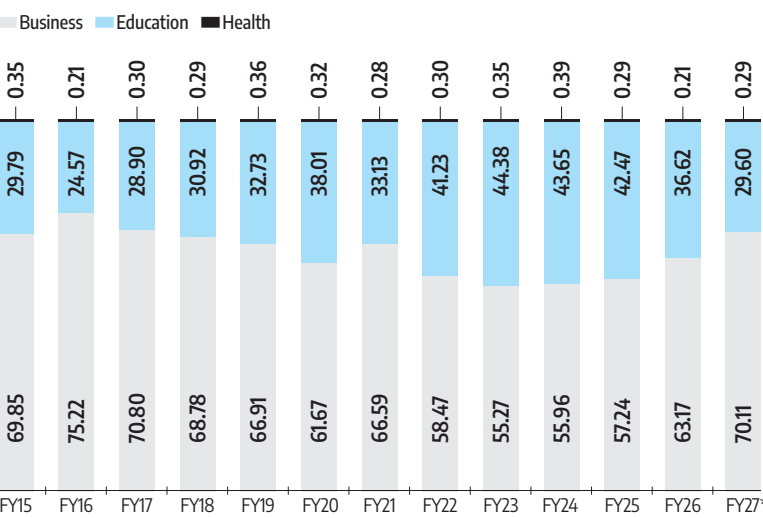
The number of Indians travelling abroad for education fell from 908,364 in 2023 to 770,127 in 2024 and 626,606 in 2025 – a fall of nearly 31 per cent in this period. (Chart 3).

India’s outward remittances for overseas education have also declined consistently since FY22. (Chart 4).

Meanwhile, the expenditure by foreigners travelling to India for education rose, albeit marginally, from \$257 million in FY25 to \$270 million in FY26. However, this amount was nearly half of what India earned a decade ago. The number of foreign students enrolled in higher education courses in India rose from 48,726 in 2022-23 to 58,134 in 2023-24 – a rise of nearly 20 per cent. (Charts 5 and 6).

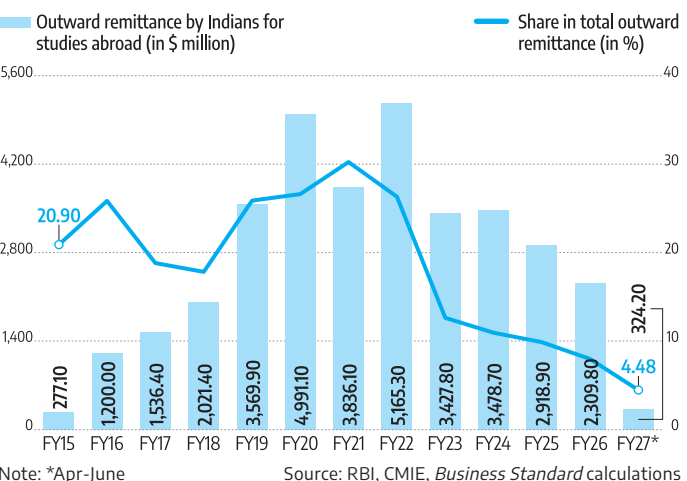
1 Share of education travel shrinks

Purpose-wise share in foreign travel by Indians (in %)



Note: *Apr-Jun; Share has been calculated based on the sum total of business, health and education-related travel; period since FY15 when the NDA govt came to power is considered
Source: RBI, CMIE, Business Standard calculations

4 Share in outbound remittance drops

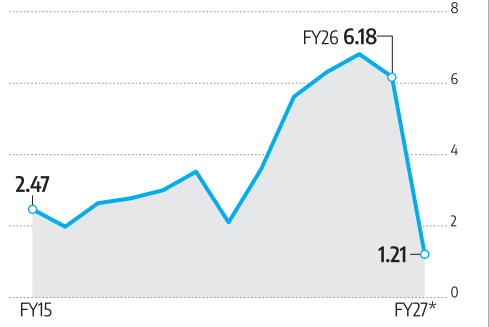


Note: *Apr-June
Source: RBI, CMIE, Business Standard calculations

2 Spending fell in FY26 due to visa restrictions

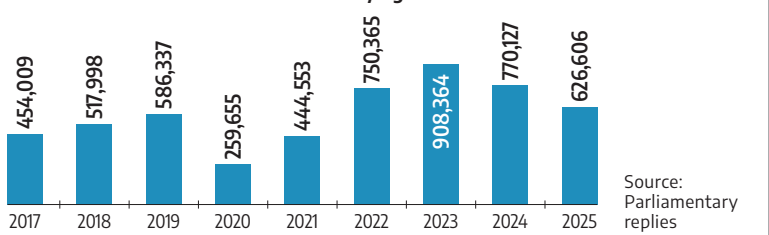
Spending on education-related foreign travel by Indians (in \$ billion)

Note: *Apr-June
Source: RBI, CMIE



3 No. of students overseas tells similar story

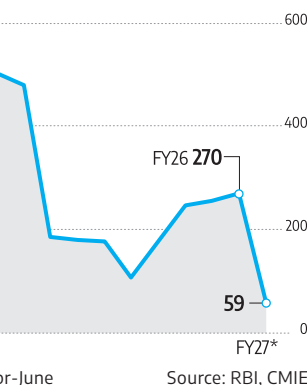
Number of Indian students studying abroad



Source: Parliamentary replies

5 India-bound spending in FY26 half of FY16

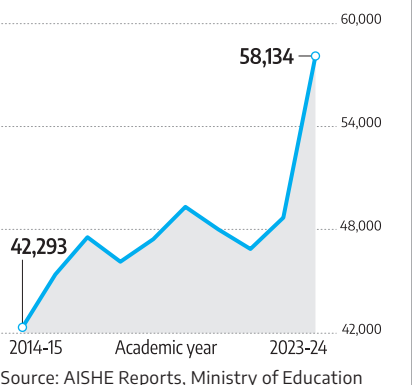
Foreigners spending on education-related travel to India (in \$ mn)



Note: *Apr-June
Source: RBI, CMIE

6 Foreign students flocked to India in 2023-24

Foreign students enrolled in higher education in India



Source: AISHE Reports, Ministry of Education

StatsGuru is a weekly feature. Every Monday, Business Standard guides you through the numbers you need to know to make sense of the headlines

Student housing faces supply gap as pvt developers shy away

Weak project economics, high land cost, regulatory issues key hurdles

SANKET KOUL
New Delhi, 13 September

India’s student housing is grappling to keep up with demand, even as organised private developers stay away from the segment citing weak project economics, high land cost and regulatory uncertainty.

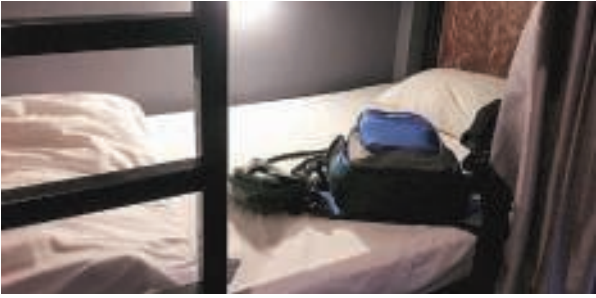
Industry estimates show that only 7.5 million on-campus beds were available in the country against over 43.3 million students enrolled in higher education during 2021-22. This highlights a significant accommodation gap.

That gap, say industry watchers, has widened and demand was being met by unorganised and unregulated paying guest (PG) accommodation providers. The shortage comes as India seeks to bring more young people into higher education, with the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 targeting a gross enrolment ratio (GER) of 50 per cent by 2035.

Despite the headroom for expansion, organised private developers have largely stayed away from student housing, including in major education hubs such as Delhi, Mumbai and Bengaluru, as well as education hubs of Kota and Sikar (Rajasthan).

“Private developer participation has remained low mainly on account of low rental yield, longer payback periods, high land costs near major education hubs, fragmented demand and limited institutionalisation,” said Santhosh Kumar, vice-chairman at realty consultancy firm Anarock.

Much of the resulting demand, therefore, is being met by fragmented PG accommodation and private hostels, leaving students in many cities with limited options that are often low-quality, poorly regulated and, in some cases, unsafe. “The risks of the unorganised



Demand mismatch

- Only 7.5 million campus beds serve over 43.3 million students
- Unorganised PGs and private hostels currently fill much of the demand
- Students are often left with limited options that are low-quality and unsafe
- PBSA regulations remain unclear across residential, hostel and hospitality sectors
- PPPs could improve viability by combining public land and private expertise
- Organised student housing may grow 10-12% annually over five years

market have recently come into focus in Delhi, where incidents such as the Satya Niketan tragedy have highlighted the consequences of inadequate and poorly-regulated student accommodation,” a Gurugram-based developer said.

Another major hurdle is regulatory ambiguity and complexities of approval. Market watchers say that Purpose-built Student Accommodation (PBSA) often falls among residential, hostel, PG and hospitality classifications. And, rules on land use, building norms, fire safety, approvals and taxation vary across states.

“The absence of standardised national norms and dedicated policy recognition for student housing further limits institutional investment and largescale private participation,” Kumar said.

Venket Rao, founder of Intygrat Law, said the absence of regulations affects students, as security deposits are sometimes paid without receipts or formal agreements. And,

promises on refunds, notice periods and facilities may remain verbal or on messaging platforms, making disputes harder to resolve.

The economics of the asset class raise a challenge for developers. High land prices around education hubs can make it difficult to offer affordable accommodation while generating attractive rental yields, as student residences are operationally intensive. With high demand, industry players believe that student housing in India is no longer an ancillary segment but is fast maturing into a core alternative real estate asset class.

“With strong policy push, rising enrolments, and persistent supply gaps, PBSA offers a scalable opportunity for institutional investors, developers, and operators,” Kumar said.

Suresh Rangarajan, founder and chief executive officer at co-living platform Colive said the economics can work if the right incentives are provided.

“Yields upwards of 12 per cent are a reality,” he said,

adding that higher floor area ratio (FAR), reduced parking norms and public-private partnerships (PPPs) can improve project viability.

Under a PPP model, universities and government institutions could provide land while private developers bring capital, construction expertise and professional operations, particularly at institutions where existing hostels are inadequate.

“PPP models can combine public sector land and institutional support with private capital, development expertise and professional operations,” said Parveen Jain, president, National Real Estate Development Council National.

Anarock expects student housing to grow at 10-12 per cent compound annual growth rate in beds delivered over the next five years, with organised operators gaining share from the unorganised PG market. The segment could, therefore, follow the broader shift towards organised rental housing, though its growth is likely to be slower than that of co-living. This is because of fragmented demand, regulatory uncertainty and project economics.

“Key positives for investors include high occupancy resilience, operating leverage potential, and alignment with global institutional investment trends in alternative assets such as PBSA in the United Kingdom, United States, and Australia,” said Saurabh Arora, founder and CEO, University Living, a student accommodation platform.

Kumar added that early movers with city-cluster strategies, efficient operating models and compliance-oriented facilities are best placed to capture value. This comes as the market transitions from fragmented rentals to branded, investment-grade student residences.

Nepal estimates \$4.7 billion recovery and reconstruction need after flash floods

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kathmandu, 13 September

Nepal’s recent devastating flash flood has led to an estimated \$4.7 billion in recovery and reconstruction needs, according to a government-led assessment.

The Rapid Damage and Needs Assessment (RDNA) for the Rasuwa-Bhotekoshi Flood 2026, released by the government on Saturday, estimates a total damage of around \$2.7 billion, with physical damage at \$1.81 billion and economic losses at \$883.32 million.

The assessment, led by Nepal’s National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority, said the larger recovery figure does not represent simply the cost of replacing what was damaged. Recovery needs include reconstruction as well as disaster-risk reduction and resilience measures. Flash floods, triggered by an ice-rock avalanche in the high Himalayas near



A survivor meets his mother after he was pulled out from a tunnel following flash floods in Nepal

PHOTO: PTI

the Nepal-Tibet border on August 26, devastated towns and villages in northern and central Nepal, killing around 1,400 people, while more than 5,000 remain missing.

The Bhotekoshi River, which flows south from the Himalayan border region, carried the floodwaters downstream, sweeping away homes, vehicles, roads and bridges and damaging hydropower projects.

India has sent the first consignment of components for a 70-metre Bailey bridge to Nepal to help restore connectivity in the flood-affected Betrawati area, the Indian envoy in Kathmandu said. The consignment was handed over to Nepal’s Road Division in Hetauda on Saturday, India’s Ambassador to Nepal Naveen Srivastava said in a post on X, adding that more consignments of the bridge components would arrive in the coming days.

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SPECIAL WINDOW FOR TRANSFER AND DEMATERIALIZATION OF PHYSICAL EQUITY SHARES
Further to our Public Notice dated 2nd March, 2026, 19th May, 2026 and 23rd July, 2026 with respect to Special Window offered following SEBI Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)/2026-MIRSD-POD/1/3750/2026 dated 30th January, 2026, all shareholders of the Company are hereby informed that another Special Window has been opened for a period of 1 (one) year from 5th February, 2026 to 4th February, 2027, both days inclusive, for transfer and demat of physical equity shares which were either sold or purchased prior to 1st April, 2019. Such Special Window is applicable to following cases:
a) Where original share transfer request(s) was/ were not lodged prior to 1st April, 2019 and the shareholder(s) is/ are holding original share certificate(s).
b) Where original share transfer request(s) was/ were lodged prior to 1st April, 2019 but rejected/ returned/ not attended due to deficiencies in documents/ process/ or otherwise.
Equity shares lodged in aforesaid Special Window and transferred shall be credited in dematerialized form only to concerned transferee(s) account and shall be subject to lock-in period of one year from date of registration of transfer and shall not be available for further transfer/ lien/ pledge during said lock-in period.
Interested eligible Shareholders of the Company are requested to contact the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent (hereon 'RTA'), M/s Maheshwari Datamatics Pvt Ltd of 23, R N Mukherjee Road, 5th Floor, Kolkata 700001, Tel. +91 33 22435809, Email: contact@mdplcorporate.com or the undersigned at address given herein above, Tel. +91 33 40106139, Email: investorcomplaints@ifgl.in; mansi.damani@ifgl.in
For IFGL Refractories Ltd
Mansi Damani
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer
ICSI Membership No. F6769

Kolkata
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Email: investors@asigroup.co.in

NOTICE OF SPECIAL WINDOW FOR RE-LODGE MENT OF TRANSFER REQUESTS OF PHYSICAL SHARES
Notice is hereby given to inform that SEBI vide its circular No. HO/38/13/11(2) 2026-MIRSD-POD/1/3750/2026 dated 30th January, 2026 has decided to open a special window only for a period of one year from 5th February, 2026 to 4th February, 2027 for re-lodgement of transfer deeds, which were lodged prior to the deadline of 01st April, 2019 and rejected/returned/not attended to due to deficiency in the documents/process/ or otherwise.
During this period, the securities that are re-lodged for transfer (including those requests that are pending with the Listed Company/RTA, as on date) shall be issued only in demat mode. Due process shall be followed for such transfer-cum-demat requests. The Company and the RTA have formed focused teams to attend such requests. Kindly refer below matrix with regards to the applicability of lodgement:

Execution date of transfer deed	Lodged for transfer before April 01, 2019 ?	Original Security Certificate available ?	Eligible to lodge in the current window ?
Before April 01, 2019	No (its is fresh lodgement)	Yes	✓
Before April 01, 2019	Yes (it was rejected/returned earlier)	Yes	✓
Before April 01, 2019	Yes	No	x
Before April 01, 2019	No	No	x

The eligible investors can submit their requests along with requisite documents to the Company or RTA of the Company at below mentioned address.

Company Secretary ASI INDUSTRIES LIMITED Regd. Off.: Marathon Innova, A Wing, 7th Floor, Off: Ganpatrao Kadam Marg, Lower Parel Mumbai 400013. Tel.: 022-40896100 Email: investors@asigroup.co.in	Registrar and Transfer Agent: MUFG Intime India Private Limited C-101,247 Park.L.B.S Marg, Vikhroli (West) Mumbai-400083. Tel: 8108116767 Toll-free number: 1800 1020 878 E-mail: rnt.helpdesk@in.mpmis.mufg.com
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For ASI Industries Limited
Sd/-
Manish Kakrai
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

Place: Mumbai
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